

Oedipus at Colonus

Sophocles · -406

Francis Storr translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks (not yet in the app)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

12 scene lessons plus 1 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 17 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 4 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–12), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Sections follow the Greek structure (prologue, parodos, episodes, stasima, exodos). Line numbers are Storr's English lines, not Greek. Lines 99 and 403–404 (text/speaker problems) are cited by number only; the play has no suicide-method lines.

Grades: Grades 7–12 (scales to graduate via rigor levels). Scaffolded-support track (grade-9 floor): students work from teacher-selected passages with scaffolds, sentence starters and partial-credit probes. **Weeks:** 4. **Class days:** 17 × 90 minutes (12 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about refuge and hospitality?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about guilt and intent?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about curse and mercy?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about law against force?
- What does Oedipus at Colonus suggest about death and blessing?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the play in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the scene quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: Common Core

RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily scene quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Scene lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	We do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Prologue (lines 1–114) Parodos (lines 115–248) Episode 1 (lines 249–694) Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*refuge and hospitality* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) *Socratic seminar on refuge and hospitality* Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*guilt and intent* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on refuge and hospitality • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) Exodos (lines 1626–1831) *Whole-book test (90 minutes)* *Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework)*	6 × 90 min (540 min)	*curse and mercy* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Final paper writing workshop (drafting in class; finish the draft as homework) • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay
4	*Final paper: peer review, revision and submission*	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*law against force* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Scene quizzes in the app • Final paper: peer review, revision and	Whole-book test and final essay

			submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Oedipus at Colonus

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about Sophocles's life or times connects to refuge and hospitality in “Oedipus at Colonus”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (refuge and hospitality, guilt and intent, curse and mercy).

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2

Author biography

Sophocles wrote his tragedies for the festivals of Dionysus at Athens in the fifth century B.C.E. An ancient summary of Antigone says he was chosen as one of Athens' generals for the war against Samos in 440 B.C.E.; Jebb treats the tradition with care and takes it to show that Antigone was known before the summer of 441 (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 20). He wrote Oedipus at Colonus in his last years, about 406 B.C.E., and it was brought out after his death by his grandson and namesake (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). His three Theban plays were not written in story order: Antigone came first and Oedipus at Colonus last (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). This app uses Francis Storr's English verse translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks; line numbers are Storr's English lines, not the Greek.

Historical and cultural context

Jebb dates the writing to Sophocles' final years, about 406 B.C.E., and reports the ancient notice that the play was brought out after the poet's death by his grandson and namesake, Sophocles son of Ariston (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). The play is set at Colonus, near Athens; the connection of Oedipus with Colonus was no invention of Sophocles (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city, which is why Thebes now wants Oedipus back. Slavery was legal; Creon and Theseus use slave as an insult (lines 869, 963), and owning people was wrong.

Publication and reception, then and now

The play was staged after Sophocles' death (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 verse translation; the Standard Ebooks text has transcription errors, corrected in the app against Storr's 1912 edition (Sophocles, 1912/2026).

Then: Jebb reads the play as a sequel that meets Oedipus again after the lapse of several years: in the earlier play he sees only his guilt, while here he insists on his moral innocence because he acted without knowing (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3).

Now: Taught as the middle of the story, it explains how Oedipus' curse on his sons and Polyneices' request for burial (lines 1457–1463) lead into Antigone, and it ends with Antigone resolving to go back to Thebes (line 1822).

Overview (spoiler-free)

Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with his daughter Antigone at a sacred grove at Colonus, near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground and that he must leave, but Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that this would be his last resting place, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Main themes

- refuge and hospitality
- guilt and intent
- curse and mercy
- law against force
- death and blessing

Why it matters

The play asks what a community owes a stranger it fears, and whether a person is defined by acts done in ignorance. It also completes the story: the cursed king becomes a protector of the city that welcomed him.

Spoilers · teacher only

Creon seizes the daughters; Theseus rescues them. Oedipus curses Polyneices. At the thunder Oedipus leads Theseus to the place of his passing, which only Theseus sees; it is a mystery, an end most marvellous (line 1705). Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Before we open Oedipus at Colonus: which matters more, refuge and hospitality or guilt and intent? Write for five minutes.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Oedipus at Colonus: which matters more, refuge and hospitality or guilt and intent? Write for five minutes.

> **8–18 min · Key terms · We do (10 min)**
> Key literary terms for the unit.
> *Key terms for Oedipus at Colonus: refuge and hospitality, guilt and intent, curse and mercy, law against force, death and blessing.*

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).

About the author. Sophocles wrote his tragedies for the festivals of Dionysus at Athens in the fifth century B.C.E. An ancient summary of Antigone says he was chosen as one of Athens' generals for the war against Samos in 440 B.C.E.; Jebb treats the tradition with care and takes it to show that Antigone was known before the summer of 441 (Jebb, 1891, Introduction, § 20). He wrote Oedipus at Colonus in his last years, about 406 B.C.E., and it was brought out after his death by his grandson and namesake (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). His three Theban plays were not written in story order: Antigone came first and Oedipus at Colonus last (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). This app uses Francis Storr's English verse translation (1912) as edited by Standard Ebooks; line numbers are Storr's English lines, not the Greek. The world of the play. Jebb dates the writing to Sophocles' final years, about 406 B.C.E., and reports the ancient notice that the play was brought out after the poet's death by his grandson and namesake, Sophocles son of Ariston (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). The play is set at Colonus, near Athens; the connection of Oedipus with Colonus was no invention of Sophocles (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city, which is why Thebes now wants Oedipus back. Slavery was legal; Creon and Theseus use slave as an insult (lines 869, 963), and owning people was wrong. Publication and reception. The play was staged after Sophocles' death (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18). This app uses Francis Storr's 1912 verse translation; the Standard Ebooks text has transcription errors, corrected in the app against Storr's 1912 edition (Sophocles, 1912/2026). Jebb reads the play as a sequel that meets Oedipus again after the lapse of several years: in the earlier play he sees only his guilt, while here he insists on his moral innocence because he acted without knowing (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3). Taught as the middle of the story, it explains how Oedipus' curse on his sons and Polyneices' request for burial (lines 1457–1463) lead into Antigone, and it ends with Antigone resolving to go back to Thebes (line 1822).

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.

First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the beggar at the sacred grove. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use setting, characterization to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "Antigone": the word "Antigone" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–2 reveal about the beggar at the sacred grove? My answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. These lines show the beggar at the sacred grove, and that matters for what follows in the play.

> *Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached* (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" slowly and put it in my own words: In these lines Oedipus speaks at a turning point of the section, which is about the beggar at the sacred grove. Next, craft. I notice how the lines use setting, characterization to make the audience feel the pressure of the moment on Oedipus. The strongest word is "Antigone": the word "Antigone" carries the weight of the lines and points to the section's big idea. Then, effect. What do lines 1–2 reveal about the beggar at the sacred grove? My answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. These lines show the beggar at the sacred grove, and that matters for what follows in the play.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Years after his fall, the blind exile Oedipus arrives with his daughter Antigone at a sacred grove at Colonus near Athens. An oracle once told him that he would find rest there, and that his grave would bless the land that took him in. Themes to track: refuge and hospitality: guilt and intent: curse and mercy: law against force: death and blessing:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page, refuge and hospitality: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.
Task: Set up a reading journal for Oedipus at Colonus: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page, refuge and hospitality: my prediction is that the play will test this idea against a hard choice, and my question is whether anyone in it can see the whole truth before it is too late to act on it.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does Oedipus at Colonus still matter? The play is about how a ruined person can claim dignity, how a city treats refugees and suppliants, and how families carry old wrongs. It completes the story of Oedipus with mercy and a death that is a blessing rather than a punishment.
Anchor question: Why might Oedipus at Colonus still be taught today?
Facilitation: The play is about how a ruined person can claim dignity, how a city treats refugees and suppliants, and how families carry old wrongs. It completes the story of Oedipus with mercy and a death that is a blessing rather than a punishment.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
Jebb notes that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was no invention of Sophocles and that the play was staged after his death. Why might Athenians have valued a play in which Oedipus' grave protects their city? Answer: Accept answers such as: the play turns a cursed outsider into a protector of Athens, so it honours the city's own ground and its welcome of a suppliant.
Exit ticket: Jebb notes that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was no invention of Sophocles and that the play was staged after his death. Why might Athenians have valued a play in which Oedipus' grave protects their city?
Answer: Accept answers such as: the play turns a cursed outsider into a protector of Athens, so it honours the city's own ground and its welcome of a suppliant.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: Prologue (lines 1–114).

Teacher notes · sources: Jebb, R. C. (1889). Sophocles: The plays and fragments, with critical notes, commentary, and translation in English prose: Part II. The Oedipus Coloneus (2nd ed.). Cambridge University Press. https://archive.org/details/sophocles02soph_0 (Original work published 1885) (https://archive.org/details/sophocles02soph_0); Sophocles. (2025). Oedipus at Colonus (F. Storr, Trans.). Standard Ebooks. https://standardebooks.org/ebooks/sophocles/oedipus-at-colonus/francis-storr (Original work written ca. 406 B.C.E.; translation published 1912) (https://standardebooks.org/ebooks/sophocles/oedipus-at-colonus/francis-storr); Sophocles. (2026). Oedipus at Colonus (F. Storr, Trans.). In Sophocles (Vol. 1). Wikisource. Retrieved October 22, 2026, from https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Sophocles_(Storr_1912)/Oedipus_at_Colonus (Original work published 1912, Loeb Classical Library) (https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/Sophocles_(Storr_1912)/Oedipus_at_Colonus)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The posthumous production rests on an ancient notice reported by Jebb.
- The app uses the Standard Ebooks text with its 44 transcription errors corrected against Storr's 1912 edition (for example lines 99, 263, 400, 403–404, 1325 and 1705); the list is in studio-plan/units/colonus-errata-standard-ebooks.md.

Lesson 2: Prologue (lines 1–114)

Focus: the beggar at the sacred grove

Objective: Students will analyze how setting develops in "Prologue (lines 1–114)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Background: Jebb notes that the play was brought out after Sophocles' death by his grandson (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18), and that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was not Sophocles' invention (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8).

Significance: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does a community owe a stranger it fears? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the beggar at the sacred grove.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Three key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: suppliant — a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar; wanderer — a person who travels without a settled home; hospitality — (concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers.
Words: suppliant: a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar · wanderer: a person who travels without a settled home · hospitality: (concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Jebb notes that the play was brought out after Sophocles' death by his grandson (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18), and that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was not Sophocles' invention (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Look closely: Jebb notes that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was not Sophocles' invention (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8), and that the play was staged after Sophocles' death by his grandson (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached?" slowly and put it in my own words: Blind and old, Oedipus asks his daughter Antigone what land and whose city they have come to. Next, craft. I notice the opening line names his blindness and his dependence on her before he names anything else. The strongest word is "blind": the man who once saw clearly and knew nothing now sees nothing and will come to know much. Then, effect. Why does the play open with Oedipus asking where he is? My answer: The play opens with Oedipus asking where he is because the king who once answered the Sphinx now needs his daughter to answer even this; finding the right place, the grove Apollo promised (lines 91–93), is what the play is about.

> *Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached?* (*Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus*)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached?" slowly and put it in my own words: Blind and old, Oedipus asks his daughter Antigone what land and whose city they have come to. Next, craft. I notice the opening line names his blindness and his dependence on her before he names anything else. The strongest word is "blind": the man who once saw clearly and knew nothing now sees nothing and will come to know much. Then, effect. Why does the play open with Oedipus asking where he is? My answer: The play opens with Oedipus asking where he is because the king who once answered the Sphinx now needs his daughter to answer even this; finding the right place, the grove Apollo promised (lines 91–93), is what the play is about.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Jebb notes that the play was brought out after Sophocles' death by his grandson (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18), and that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was not Sophocles' invention (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Read closely: "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight." (Oedipus, lines 74). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: The beggar at the sacred grove. (Oedipus, lines 74.)

> *The blind man's words will be instinct with sight (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Jebb notes that the play was brought out after Sophocles' death by his grandson (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 18), and that the link between Oedipus and Colonus was not Sophocles' invention (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Read closely: "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight." (Oedipus, lines 74).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: The beggar at the sacred grove. (Oedipus, lines 74.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–114) develops the idea of the beggar at the sacred grove. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. When the text says "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
Task: Annotate the scene for setting, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–114) develops the idea of the beggar at the sacred grove. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. When the text says "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does a community owe a stranger it fears? Ask: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?
Anchor question: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?
Facilitation: Ask: What does a community owe a stranger it fears?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. ("Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached", Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. ("Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached", Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes the beggar at the sacred grove. Key takeaway: the beggar at the sacred grove.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
- **Characterization:** Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
- **Irony:** Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the beggar at the sacred grove.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the beggar at the sacred grove.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1–2.
- "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 74.
- "There," said he, "shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 91–93.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest.
Evidence: "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus)
Reasoning: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 1
1 **Oedipus:** Child of an old blind sire, Antigone,

Lines 1–2
1 **Oedipus:** Child of an old blind sire, Antigone,
2 **Oedipus:** What region, say, whose city have we reached?

Line 23
23 **Oedipus:** Say, prithee, if thou knowest, where we are.

Lines 31–32
31 **Antigone:** Say rather, here already. Ask him straight
32 **Antigone:** The needful questions, for the man is here.

Line 38
38 **Oedipus:** What is the site, to what god dedicate?

Lines 42–43
42 **Stranger:** The Gracious Ones, All-seeing, so our people
43 **Stranger:** Call them, but elsewhere other names are rife.

Line 52

52 **Stranger:** Ask; your request shall not be scorned by me.

Lines 54–63

54 **Stranger:** Whate'er I know thou too shalt know; the place
55 **Stranger:** Is all to great Poseidon consecrate.
56 **Stranger:** Hard by, the Titan, he who bears the torch,
57 **Stranger:** Prometheus, has his worship; but the spot
58 **Stranger:** Thou treadest, the Brass-footed Threshold named,
59 **Stranger:** Is Athens' bastion, and the neighbouring lands
60 **Stranger:** Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight
61 **Stranger:** Colonus, and in common bear his name.
62 **Stranger:** Such, stranger, is the spot, to fame unknown,
63 **Stranger:** But dear to us its native worshippers.

Lines 56–61

56 **Stranger:** Hard by, the Titan, he who bears the torch,
57 **Stranger:** Prometheus, has his worship; but the spot
58 **Stranger:** Thou treadest, the Brass-footed Threshold named,
59 **Stranger:** Is Athens' bastion, and the neighbouring lands
60 **Stranger:** Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight
61 **Stranger:** Colonus, and in common bear his name.

Line 65

65 **Stranger:** Surely; they bear the name of yonder god.

Line 68

68 **Oedipus:** Who is this monarch, great in word and might?

Line 71

71 **Stranger:** Wherefore? To tell him aught or urge his coming?

Line 72

72 **Oedipus:** Say a slight service may avail him much.

Line 74

74 **Oedipus:** The blind man's words will be instinct with sight.

Lines 91–93

91 **Oedipus:** "There," said he, "shalt thou round thy weary life,
92 **Oedipus:** A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st,
93 **Oedipus:** But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse."

Lines 109–110

109 **Antigone:** Hush! for I see some grey-beards on their way,
110 **Antigone:** Their errand to spy out our resting-place.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
suppliant (noun)	a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar	*Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart.*	
wanderer (noun)	a person who travels without a settled home	*Who will provide today with scanted dole / This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves,*	
hospitality (noun)	(concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers	*He appeals to the world-famed hospitality of Athens and hints at the blessings that his coming will confer on the State.*	

Discussion questions

1. What does a community owe a stranger it fears?
2. Where does setting appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with refuge and hospitality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Oedipus ask Antigone in lines 1–2? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: What region and whose city they have reached.
2. Who guides the blind Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Antigone
3. Why must Oedipus leave his seat, according to the stranger? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It is holy ground
4. What did Apollo foretell about this place? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Oedipus would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts
5. What is ironic about "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight"? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The blind man claims a kind of sight the seeing lack
6. What will Oedipus be to the land that cast him out? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A curse

7. Retell the three most important events of "Prologue (lines 1–114)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
8. Who is on stage in "Prologue (lines 1–114)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Prologue (lines 1–114)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart." What does "suppliant" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: suppliant: a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus refuse to leave the grove? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He recognizes it as the resting place Apollo foretold.
2. What does "Prologue (lines 1–114)" suggest about the beggar at the sacred grove? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest.
3. Find one example of setting in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the beggar at the sacred grove? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–2. On characterization: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, What region, say, whose city have we reached?", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

6. What causes the main turn in "Prologue (lines 1–114)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
7. As the opening scene, what does "Prologue (lines 1–114)" set up that the rest of Oedipus at Colonus will need? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 74. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "There," said he, "shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 91–93. On characterization: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "What does a community owe a stranger it fears?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with refuge and hospitality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–2. On irony: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus a helpless beggar or a man in control in the Prologue? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look

for: A defended position.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 74. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: “The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: “There,” said he, “shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 91–93. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–2. On characterization: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Prologue (lines 1–114)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the beggar at the sacred grove. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 74. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Prologue (lines 1–114)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: “There,” said he, “shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 91–93. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred

grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and intent: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–2. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the setting in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 74. On setting: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Prologue (lines 1–114)" treats the beggar at the sacred grove with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "There," said he, "shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 91–93. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Parodos (lines 115–248)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1–2. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the beggar at the sacred grove? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Useful evidence: "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 74. Theme link: the beggar at the sacred grove. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "He appeals to the world-famed hospitality of Athens and hints at the blessings that his coming will confer on the State.", what does "hospitality" most nearly mean?

   A. repays, especially a wrong with a wrong

   B. (concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers

   C. a pirate or plunderer

   D. (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force

   Key: B ((concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Who will provide today with scanted dole / This _____? 'Tis little that he craves," Word bank: wanderer, suppliant, hospitality

   Key: wanderer

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What will Oedipus be to the land that cast him out?

   A. A king

   B. A curse

   C. A guest

   D. A blessing

   Key: B (A curse)

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Then may they show their _____ grace, for I From this your sanctuary will ne'er depart." Word bank: suppliant, hospitality, wanderer

   Key: suppliant

5. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus ask Antigone in lines 1–2?

   Sample answer: What region and whose city they have reached.

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why must Oedipus leave his seat, according to the stranger?

   A. It is a market

   B. It is holy ground

   C. It belongs to Creon

D. It is a battlefield

Key: B (It is holy ground)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who guides the blind Oedipus?

   A. Creon

   B. Antigone

   C. Theseus

   D. Ismene

   Key: B (Antigone)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What did Apollo foretell about this place?

   A. Thebes would be destroyed tomorrow

   B. Oedipus would become king of Athens

   C. Oedipus would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts

   D. Oedipus would regain his sight

   Key: C (Oedipus would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is ironic about "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight"?

   A. The blind man claims a kind of sight the seeing lack

   B. He is not really blind

   C. He is quoting Teiresias by mistake

   D. He is joking about his eyes

   Key: A (The blind man claims a kind of sight the seeing lack)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus: “The blind man’s words will be _____ with sight”

    Key: instinct

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus refuse to leave the grove?

    Sample answer: He recognizes it as the resting place Apollo foretold. The evidence is “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth,…” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 91–93.

12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The beggar at the sacred grove.

    A. Guilt and intent

    B. Curse and mercy

    C. Law against force

    D. Refuge and hospitality

    Key: D (Refuge and hospitality)

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 91–93. The evidence is “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth,…” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge

and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. The words "blessing" and "wherein" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) supports it: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. But "There,' said he, 'shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 91–93) shows the same issue from another side, and its "But" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.
15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–2. The evidence is "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. The words "reached" and "region" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus a helpless beggar or a man in control in the Prologue? Defend your view.
    Sample answer: A defended position: Oedipus, lines 74. The evidence is "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), lines 42–43: "The Gracious Ones, All-seeing, so our people Call them, but _____ other names are rife." Word bank: questions, stranger, reigning, elsewhere
    Key: elsewhere
18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), line 71: "To tell him aught or urge his _____?" Word bank: coming, questions, neighbouring, goddesses
    Key: coming
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), stage direction before line 1: "Creon, brother of Jocasta, now _____ at Thebes" Word bank: daughter, reigning, neighbouring, stranger
    Key: reigning
20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Prologue (lines 1–114), stage direction before line 1 reveal about the character or situation? "Scene: In front of the grove of the Eumenides." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Prologue (lines 1–114), stage direction before line 1) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. The words its wording are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Prologue (lines 1–114), line 72 reveal about the character or situation? "Say a slight service may avail him much." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Prologue (lines 1–114), line 72) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "service" and "slight" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Prologue (lines 1–114), lines 109–110 shapes its tone: "Hush! for I see some grey-beards on their way, Their errand to spy out our resting-place." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "resting" and "beards" (Prologue (lines 1–114), lines 109–110) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Prologue (lines 1–114), line 23 shapes its tone: "Say, prithee, if thou knowest, where we are." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "prithee" and "knowest" (Prologue (lines 1–114), line 23) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from the opening of "Prologue (lines 1–114)" to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
    Sample answer: Near the start, "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–2. Later, "There,' said he, 'shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth,…" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 91–93. The beggar at the sacred grove.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Prologue (lines 1–114), lines 31–32? "Ask him straight The needful _____, for the man is here."

    A. stranger
    B. questions
    C. travelled
    D. reigning

    Key: B (questions)

26. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Prologue (lines 1–114), lines 56–61? "Hard by, the Titan, he who bears the torch, Prometheus, has his worship; but the spot Thou treadest, the Brass-footed Threshold named, Is Athens' bastion, and the _____ lands Claim as their chief and patron yonder knight Colonus, and in common bear his name."

    A. stranger
    B. goddesses
    C. neighbouring
    D. elsewhere

Key: C (neighbouring)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Prologue (lines 1–114), line 52 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Ask; your request shall not be scorned by me.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Prologue (lines 1–114), line 52) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “scorned” and “request” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Such, stranger, is the spot, to fame unknown, But dear to us its native worshippers.” (Prologue (lines 1–114), line 52), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Prologue (lines 1–114), line 65 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Surely; they bear the name of yonder god.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Prologue (lines 1–114), line 65) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “yonder” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Who is this monarch, great in word and might?” (Prologue (lines 1–114), line 65), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 74. The evidence is “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Prologue (lines 1–114), line 38 shapes its tone: “What is the site, to what god dedicate?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “dedicate” (Prologue (lines 1–114), line 38) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus: “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A _____ to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse”

    Key: blessing

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–2. The evidence is “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove.

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Prologue (lines 1–114)”?

    A. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome
    B. The mysterious passing
    C. The beggar at the sacred grove
    D. Polyneices and the father's curse

    Key: C (The beggar at the sacred grove)

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus).

    Sample answer: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. The evidence is “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–2. This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I From this your sanctuary will ne’er depart.”, what does “suppliant” most nearly mean?

    A. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

    B. (concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers

    C. a high point of land jutting into the sea

    D. a person who travels without a settled home

    Key: A (a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar)

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus: “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we _____”

    Key: reached

37. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Prologue (lines 1–114)”? Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts…

    A. Imagery

    B. Characterization

    C. Personification

    D. Diction / vocabulary

    Key: B (Characterization)

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 74. The evidence is “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. The words “instinct” and “sight” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	17, 10, 9, 18, 5, 8, 6, 4, 19, 20, 21, 11, 12, 22, 23, 24	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	7, 25, 5, 10, 2, 8, 26, 3, 21, 20, 11, 22, 23, 12, 27, 28	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	7, 2, 6, 18, 9, 4, 20, 21, 11, 29, 12, 22, 23, 30, 28, 14	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	7, 31, 2, 25, 1, 20, 32, 11, 21, 12, 30, 23, 22, 14, 28, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 7, 8, 4, 6, 33, 20, 13, 30, 34, 23, 22, 27, 28, 16, 14	recall 5, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	1, 9, 35, 36, 10, 21, 22, 30, 12, 13, 23, 27, 24, 28, 14, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	19, 2, 7, 6, 29, 21, 13, 30, 22, 23, 12, 37, 28, 16, 14, 27	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 4
College Junior	18, 8, 4, 7, 21, 20, 22, 13, 37, 12, 30, 23, 14, 27, 16, 28	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 4
College Senior	7, 4, 2, 6, 12, 23, 22, 37, 13, 30, 34, 14, 38, 16, 28, 27	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	3, 31, 19, 8, 33, 11, 20, 30, 22, 12, 34, 23, 27, 14, 28, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Prologue (lines 1–114)," how does Sophocles show the beggar at the sacred grove? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Prologue (lines 1–114), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the beggar at the sacred grove? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Prologue (lines 1–114) develops the idea of the beggar at the sacred grove. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Prologue (lines 1–114) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of the beggar at the sacred grove. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Prologue (lines 1–114) suggests about the beggar at the sacred grove. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's setting and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses setting in Prologue (lines 1–114) to complicate the reader's understanding of the beggar at the sacred grove. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Prologue (lines

1–114) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the beggar at the sacred grove responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Prologue (lines 1–114) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the beggar at the sacred grove follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Prologue (lines 1–114) and its treatment of the beggar at the sacred grove. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's setting and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Prologue (lines 1–114) as evidence for a larger claim about the beggar at the sacred grove in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Prologue (lines 1–114) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the beggar at the sacred grove. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, What region, say, whose city have we reached? Who will provide today with scanted dole This wanderer? 'Tis little that he craves, And less obtains—that less enough for me; For I am taught by suffering to endure, And the long years that have grown old with me, And last not least, by true nobility. My daughter, if thou seest a resting place On common ground or by some sacred grove, Stay me and set me down. Let us discover Where we have come, for strangers must inquire Of denizens, and do as they are bid.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–114)"?

   A. The beggar at the sacred grove

   B. The Colonus ode

   C. Polyneices and the father's curse

   D. The summons

SAT key: 1. A (The beggar at the sacred grove)

Lesson 3: Parodos (lines 115–248)

Focus: the elders' fear

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “Parodos (lines 115–248)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

Background: The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) here is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn.

Significance: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the elders' fear.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: requites — repays, especially a wrong with a wrong; perdition — ruin; in religion, eternal punishment.
Words: requites: repays, especially a wrong with a wrong · perdition: ruin; in religion, eternal punishment

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) here is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn. A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Look closely: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Antigone's plea (lines 243–244) models speaking up for someone judged by reputation.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say that the gods do not punish a person who repays wrong with wrong. Next, craft. I notice a rhymed saying that sounds like a proverb, spoken just after Oedipus asks how they will keep their troth (line 221). The strongest word is "requites": repays. Then, effect. How does the elders' saying answer Oedipus' question about their troth? My answer: The saying answers Oedipus' question about their troth by turning the blame on him: the elders claim that repaying ill with ill is no sin, and in the next lines they call his hidden name guile, so they think their promise no longer binds them.

> *Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites.* *(Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders say that the gods do not punish a person who repays wrong with wrong. Next, craft. I notice a rhymed saying that sounds like a proverb, spoken just after Oedipus asks how they will keep their troth (line 221). The strongest word is "requites": repays. Then, effect. How does the elders' saying answer Oedipus' question about their troth? My answer: The saying answers Oedipus' question about their troth by turning the blame on him: the elders claim that repaying ill with ill is no sin, and in the next lines they call his hidden name guile, so they think their promise no longer binds them.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) here is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn. Read closely: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!" (Antigone, lines 243–244). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: The elders' fear. (Antigone, lines 243–244.)

> *Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel* *(Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The Chorus's entrance song (parodos) here is a search and a confrontation, not a hymn. Read closely: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!" (Antigone, lines 243–244).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: The elders' fear. (Antigone, lines 243–244.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 115–248) develops the idea of the elders' fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. When the text says "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone), it shows this directly. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.
Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Parodos (lines 115–248) develops the idea of the elders' fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. When the text says "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone), it shows this directly. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them? Ask: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?
Anchor question: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?
Facilitation: Ask: Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. ("Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel", Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the elders' fear? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. ("Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel", Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how conflict shapes the elders' fear. Key takeaway: the elders' fear.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.
- **Characterization:** The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.
- **Theme:** The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the elders' fear.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the elders' fear.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus) Chorus, lines 222–223.
- "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone) Antigone, lines 243–244.
- "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him.
Evidence: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone)
Reasoning: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1–2

1 **Oedipus:** Child of an old blind sire, Antigone,
2 **Oedipus:** What region, say, whose city have we reached?

Line 137

137 **Oedipus:** Oh sirs, I am no outlaw under ban.

Line 138

138 **Chorus:** Who can he be—Zeus save us!—this old man?

Lines 144–158

144 **Chorus:** Wast thou then sightless from thy birth?
145 **Chorus:** Evil, methinks, and long
146 **Chorus:** Thy pilgrimage on earth.
147 **Chorus:** Yet add not curse to curse and wrong to wrong.
148 **Chorus:** I warn thee, trespass not
149 **Chorus:** Within this hallowed spot,
150 **Chorus:** Lest thou shouldst find the silent grassy glade
151 **Chorus:** Where offerings are laid,
152 **Chorus:** Bowls of spring water mingled with sweet mead.
153 **Chorus:** Thou must not stay,
154 **Chorus:** Come, come away,
155 **Chorus:** Tired wanderer, dost thou heed?
156 **Chorus:** (We are far off, but sure our voice can reach.)
157 **Chorus:** If aught thou would'st beseech,
158 **Chorus:** Speak where 'tis right; till then refrain from speech.

Line 147

147 **Chorus:** Yet add not curse to curse and wrong to wrong.

Lines 148–152

148 **Chorus:** I warn thee, trespass not
149 **Chorus:** Within this hallowed spot,
150 **Chorus:** Lest thou shouldst find the silent grassy glade
151 **Chorus:** Where offerings are laid,
152 **Chorus:** Bowls of spring water mingled with sweet mead.

Lines 163–164

163 **Oedipus:** O Sirs, if I come forth at your command,
164 **Oedipus:** Let me not suffer for my confidence.

Lines 179–182

179 **Oedipus:** Guide me child, where we may range
180 **Oedipus:** Safe within the paths of right;

181 **Oedipus:** Counsel freely may exchange
182 **Oedipus:** Nor with fate and fortune fight.

Line 191
191 **Antigone:** Thy steps to my steps, lean thine aged frame on mine.

Lines 193–196
193 **Chorus:** Wanderer, now thou art at rest,
194 **Chorus:** Tell me of thy birth and home,
195 **Chorus:** From what far country art thou come,
196 **Chorus:** Led on thy weary way, declare!

Line 205
205 **Oedipus:** Ah me, my daughter, now we are undone!

Lines 222–223
222 **Chorus:** Heaven's justice never smites
223 **Chorus:** Him who ill with ill requites.

Lines 243–244
243 **Antigone:** Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well,
244 **Antigone:** Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
requites (verb)	repays, especially a wrong with a wrong	*Heaven's justice never smites Him who ill with ill requites.*	
perdition (noun)	ruin; in religion, eternal punishment	*Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!*	

Discussion questions

1. Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and intent?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Antigone ask the elders to consider? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: That no one escapes ruin when a god impels him.
2. What do the elders do when they learn who Oedipus is? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Order him to leave
3. Who pleads for Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Antigone
4. What do the elders say about requiting ill with ill? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Heaven's justice does not punish it
5. What is Antigone's argument in lines 243–244? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: No one escapes ruin if a god drives him
6. Why do the elders fear Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: His name and story are known and feared
7. Retell the three most important events of "Parodos (lines 115–248)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.
8. Who is on stage in "Parodos (lines 115–248)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Parodos (lines 115–248)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Heaven's justice never smites Him who ill with ill requites." What does "requites" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: requites: repays, especially a wrong with a wrong.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does the Chorus break its promise of safety? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Fear of pollution once they hear his name.
2. What does "Parodos (lines 115–248)" suggest about the elders' fear? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about the elders' fear? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, lines 222–223. On characterization: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “O sirs!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Parodos (lines 115–248)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.
7. How does “Parodos (lines 115–248)” build on “Prologue (lines 1–114)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone): Antigone, lines 243–244. Theme link: the elders' fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On characterization: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Is it fair to judge someone by what we have heard about them?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and intent? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, lines 222–223. On theme: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Are the elders right to fear Oedipus? Defend your view with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone): Antigone, lines 243–244. On theme: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, lines 222–223. On characterization: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Parodos (lines 115–248)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the elders' fear. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone): Antigone, lines 243–244. Theme link: the elders' fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about "Parodos (lines 115–248)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders of Colonus search for the

trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to curse and mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, lines 222–223. On theme: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone): Antigone, lines 243–244. On conflict: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Parodos (lines 115–248)” treats the elders' fear with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus): Chorus, lines 222–223. Theme link: the elders' fear. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the elders' fear? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Useful evidence: “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god

impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone): Antigone, lines 243–244. On theme: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who pleads for Oedipus?

   A. Polyneices

   B. Theseus

   C. Ismene

   D. Antigone

   Key: D (Antigone)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders say about requiting ill with ill?

   A. It is always a crime

   B. It brings plague

   C. Heaven's justice does not punish it

   D. Only kings may do it

   Key: C (Heaven's justice does not punish it)

3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 148–152? "I warn thee, trespass not Within this hallowed spot, Lest thou shouldst find the silent grassy glade Where _____ are laid, Bowls of spring water mingled with sweet mead."

   A. comest

   B. crouching

   C. outlaw

   D. offerings

   Key: D (offerings)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders do when they learn who Oedipus is?

   A. Ignore him

   B. Send for Creon

   C. Order him to leave

   D. Crown him

   Key: C (Order him to leave)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus: "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill _____"

   Key: requites

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus: "Ha! Where is he? Look _____! / Every nook and corner scan"

   Key: around

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes _____ if a god impel"

   Key: perdition

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 193–196: "Wanderer, now thou art at rest, Tell me of thy birth and home, From what far _____ art thou come, Led on thy weary way, declare!" Word bank: comest, offerings, standest, country

   Key: country

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Antigone's argument in lines 243–244?

   A. No one escapes ruin if a god drives him

   B. The elders are cruel

   C. Oedipus is innocent of everything

   D. Athens must obey Thebes

   Key: A (No one escapes ruin if a god drives him)

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Antigone ask the elders to consider?

    Sample answer: That no one escapes ruin when a god impels him.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Parodos (lines 115–248)?

    A. "I am that man; I know you near Ears to the blind, they say, are eyes."

    B. "Who can he be—Zeus save us!—this old man?"

    C. "Oh sirs, I am no outlaw under ban."

    D. "O dread to see and dread to hear!"

    Key: A ("I am that man; I know you near Ears to the blind, they say, are eyes.")

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does the Chorus break its promise of safety?

    Sample answer: Fear of pollution once they hear his name. The evidence is "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus) — Chorus, in this part of the section.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 205 reveal about the character or situation? "Ah me, my daughter, now we are undone!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 205) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "daughter" and "undone" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and

corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear. The words "corner" and "around" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Parodos (lines 115–248)"? The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

    A. Simile

    B. Conflict

    C. Alliteration

    D. Allusion

    Key: B (Conflict)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Prologue (lines 1–114) to Parodos (lines 115–248). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus, the text reads "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" — Oedipus, lines 1–2. In Parodos (lines 115–248), "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 222–223. The elders' fear.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why do the elders fear Oedipus?

    A. He is a spy

    B. He is armed

    C. His name and story are known and feared

    D. He carries plague

    Key: C (His name and story are known and feared)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 137: "Oh sirs, I am no _____ under ban." Word bank: outlaw, crouching, pilgrimage, strange

    Key: outlaw

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Heaven's justice never smites Him who ill with ill _____." Word bank: perdition, requites

    Key: requites

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Antigone, lines 243–244. The evidence is "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear.

21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 138 shapes its tone: "Who can he be—Zeus save us!—this old man?" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words its wording (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 138) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

22. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Are the elders right to fear Oedipus? Defend your view with evidence.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 222–223. The evidence is "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill

with ill requites" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

23. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The elders' fear.

    A. Curse and mercy

    B. Law against force

    C. Refuge and hospitality

    D. Guilt and intent

    Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 179–182 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: "Guide me child, where we may range Safe within the paths of right; Counsel freely may exchange Nor with fate and fortune fight." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 179–182) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words "exchange" and "fortune" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Thy steps to my steps, lean thine aged frame on mine." (Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 179–182), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 147 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: "Yet add not curse to curse and wrong to wrong." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 147) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "O Sirs, if I come forth at your command, Let me not suffer for my confidence." (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 147), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, Who 'scapes _____ if a god impel!" Word bank: requites, perdition
    Key: perdition

27. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 115–248)"?

    A. The rescue imagined

    B. The mysterious passing

    C. The daughters return; a suppliant son

    D. The elders' fear

    Key: D (The elders' fear)

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 222–223. The evidence is "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear. The words "requites" and "justice" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

29. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus)

    A. His critique: their escape is no different from a drunkard's.

    B. The diagnosis of everything he has tried so far: every discipline was a flight from the self.

    C. The dream that wakes him.

    D. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    Key: D (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Claim: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone).

    Sample answer: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him. The evidence is “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone) — Antigone, lines 243–244. This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	6, 17, 3, 18, 4, 8, 19, 2, 12, 20, 13, 11, 15, 21, 14, 22	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 7, 5, 1, 10, 18, 6, 4, 13, 12, 11, 21, 23, 15, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 9, 2, 6, 10, 4, 11, 12, 20, 13, 23, 14, 15, 21, 22, 24	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 17, 6, 1, 26, 8, 13, 12, 11, 23, 14, 21, 15, 25, 16, 24	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	6, 5, 3, 17, 9, 12, 13, 11, 23, 14, 15, 21, 24, 25, 22, 16	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Freshman	7, 18, 3, 10, 13, 11, 12, 27, 21, 23, 14, 22, 25, 28, 24, 16	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	6, 3, 2, 7, 12, 13, 27, 11, 14, 23, 21, 24, 22, 16, 28, 25	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 5
College Junior	4, 6, 17, 18, 2, 12, 13, 11, 14, 15, 21, 23, 16, 24, 22, 25	recall 5, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Senior	18, 1, 8, 9, 13, 11, 29, 12, 30, 15, 21, 23, 22, 25, 24, 16	recall 4, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	19, 9, 6, 10, 13, 27, 12, 29, 11, 23, 30, 21, 24, 22, 16, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Parodos (lines 115–248),” how does Sophocles show the elders' fear? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Parodos (lines 115–248), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the elders' fear? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Parodos (lines 115–248) develops the idea of the elders' fear. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Parodos (lines 115–248) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of the elders' fear. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Parodos (lines 115–248) suggests about the elders' fear. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Parodos (lines 115–248) to complicate the reader's understanding of the elders' fear. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Parodos (lines 115–248) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the elders' fear responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Parodos (lines 115–248) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the elders' fear follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Parodos (lines 115–248) and its treatment of the elders' fear. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Parodos (lines 115–248) as evidence for a larger claim about the elders' fear in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Parodos (lines 115–248) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the elders' fear. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist

or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *O sirs! ye suffered not my father blind, Albeit gracious and to ruth inclined, Knowing the deeds he wrought, not innocent, But with no ill intent; Yet heed a maiden's moan Who pleads for him alone; My eyes, not reft of sight, Plead with you as a daughter's might You are our providence, O make us not go hence! O with a gracious nod Grant us the nigh despaired-of boon we crave? Hear us, O hear, By all that ye hold dear, Wife, children, homestead, hearth and God! Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 115–248)"?

   A. A prayer for an easy death

   B. The elders' fear

   C. The mysterious passing

   D. "Not to be born"

SAT key: 1. B (The elders' fear)

Lesson 4: Episode 1 (lines 249–694)

Focus: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported), alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Read the framing announcement aloud before this reading; cite method lines by number only. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…This too tell. With water and with honey; add no wine. And when the embowered earth hath drun…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: In the next part, Oedipus remembers that in his first grief he wanted to die (lines 434–435).
Suggested language: "What does the play show about the cost of this loss?"
Safe messaging: In the next part, Oedipus remembers that in his first grief he wanted to die (lines 434–435). Later in the play, the elders sing that it would be best never to have been born (lines 1284–1287), and after their father's death Ismene and Antigone say they wish they could die too (lines 1734–1737, 1778). These are the words of people overwhelmed by loss. The play does not agree with them: Oedipus lives on, wins a home and friends, and is called "blessèd" at his end (line 1764), and his daughters are promised care (lines 1826–1829). In real life, hurting yourself is wrong and is never the answer. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or talk to a school counselor or a trusted adult. You don't have to handle it alone. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.); talk with a school counselor; or tell a trusted adult. Let a counselor know in advance that this scene is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

Background: Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city. Jebb notes that in this play Oedipus insists on his moral innocence (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3).

Significance: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Teacher reads aloud before the reading. What happens: In the next part, Oedipus remembers that in his first grief he wanted to die (lines 434–435). Context: Oedipus at Colonus presents this as part of the story's tragedy, so readers can understand the character's despair and its cost. Self-harm is wrong, and it is never the answer to pain; the story shows its cost, not a solution. If you or someone you know is struggling, call or text 988, or chat at 988lifeline.org (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.); talk with a school counselor; or tell a trusted adult. When has your own experience helped you understand someone else? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because.... Content note before we start: In the next part, Oedipus remembers that in his first grief he wanted to die (lines 434–435).
Prompt: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: impious — lacking respect for the gods or for duty.
Words: impious: lacking respect for the gods or for duty

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city. Jebb notes that in this play Oedipus insists on his moral innocence (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3). The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Look closely: Teacher erratum note: the Standard Ebooks text misprints line 263 as Striken; the app text now reads Stricken, as in Storr's 1912 edition.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again?" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus asks whether he is a villain by nature because, when he was struck, he struck back in self-defence. Next, craft. I notice the repeated sounds of stricken, struck and striker make the act sound like a reflex, not a plan. The strongest word is "villain": a person evil by nature, which is the charge he rejects. Then, effect. How does Oedipus' question about being a villain change the way he judges his past? My answer: Oedipus' question about being a villain shows him judging his past by intent: in Oedipus Rex he saw only his guilt, but here he argues that a man who acted in self-defence and without knowledge is not a villain (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3).

> *Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again?* (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again?" slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus asks whether he is a villain by nature because, when he was struck, he struck back in self-defence. Next, craft. I notice the repeated sounds of stricken, struck and striker make the act sound like a reflex, not a plan. The strongest word is "villain": a person evil by nature, which is the charge he rejects. Then, effect. How does Oedipus' question about being a villain change the way he judges his past? My answer: Oedipus' question about being a villain shows him judging his past by intent: in Oedipus Rex he saw only his guilt, but here he argues that a man who acted in self-defence and without knowledge is not a villain (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3).

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city. Jebb notes that in this play Oedipus insists on his moral innocence (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3). Read closely: "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins." (Oedipus, lines 393). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. (Oedipus, lines 393.)

> *So, when I cease to be, my worth begins* (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Greeks believed a hero's grave could protect a city. Jebb notes that in this play Oedipus insists on his moral innocence (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 3). Read closely: "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins." (Oedipus, lines 393).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. (Oedipus, lines 393.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 249–694) develops the idea of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. When the text says "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 249–694) develops the idea of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. When the text says "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else? Ask: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?

Anchor question: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?

Facilitation: Ask: When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. ("Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again", Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. ("Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again", Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Key takeaway: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.
- **Theme:** Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.
- **Conflict:** Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 261–263.
- "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 393.
- "The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene) Ismene, lines 394.
- "I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus) Theseus, lines 583–585.
- "Earth's might decays, the might of men decays, / Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes, / There is no constancy 'twixt friend and friend, / Or city and city; be it soon or late, / Sweet turns to bitter, hate once more to love" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 632–636.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes.
Evidence: "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus)
Reasoning: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 222–223
222 **Chorus:** Heaven's justice never smites
223 **Chorus:** Him who ill with ill requites.

Lines 261–263
261 **Oedipus:** The cause of this your fear. Yet am I then
262 **Oedipus:** A villain born because in self-defence,
263 **Oedipus:** Stricken, I struck the striker back again?

Line 263
263 **Oedipus:** Stricken, I struck the striker back again?

Lines 288–289
288 **Chorus:** In his ancestral seat; a messenger,
289 **Chorus:** The same who sent us here, is gone for him.

Lines 316–318

316 **Ismene:** Father and sister, names to me most sweet,
317 **Ismene:** How hardly have I found you, hardly now
318 **Ismene:** When found at last can see you through my tears!

Line 335

335 **Oedipus:** Thy valiant brothers, where are they at need?

Lines 385–386

385 **Oedipus:** Hast thou indeed then entertained a hope
386 **Oedipus:** The gods at last will turn and rescue me?

Line 393

393 **Oedipus:** So, when I cease to be, my worth begins.

Line 394

394 **Ismene:** The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now.

Line 412

412 **Oedipus:** When what conjunction comes to pass, my child?

Line 418

418 **Oedipus:** And can a son of mine have heard of this?

Lines 420–421

420 **Oedipus:** They knew it, yet the ignoble greed of rule
421 **Oedipus:** Outweighed all longing for their sire's return.

Lines 423–459

423 **Oedipus:** Then may the gods ne'er quench their fatal feud,
424 **Oedipus:** And mine be the arbitrament of the fight,
425 **Oedipus:** For which they now are arming, spear to spear;
426 **Oedipus:** That neither he who holds the scepter now
427 **Oedipus:** May keep his throne, nor he who fled the realm
428 **Oedipus:** Return again. They never raised a hand,
429 **Oedipus:** When I their sire was thrust from hearth and home;
430 **Oedipus:** When I was banned and banished, what recked they?
431 **Oedipus:** Say you 'twas done at my desire, a grace
432 **Oedipus:** Which the State, yielding to my wish, allowed?
433 **Oedipus:** Not so; for, mark you, on that very day
434 **Oedipus:** When in the tempest of my soul I craved
435 **Oedipus:** Death, even death by stoning, none appeared
436 **Oedipus:** To further that wild longing, but anon,
437 **Oedipus:** When time had numbed my anguish and I felt
438 **Oedipus:** My wrath had all outrun those errors past,
439 **Oedipus:** Then, then it was the city went about

Oedipus: By force to oust me, respited for years;
Oedipus: And they my sons, who should as sons have helped,
Oedipus: Did nothing: and, one little word from them
Oedipus: Was all I needed, and they spoke no word,
Oedipus: But let me wander on forevermore,
Oedipus: A banished man, a beggar. These two maids
Oedipus: Their sisters, girls, gave all their sex could give,
Oedipus: Food and safe harbourage and filial care;
Oedipus: While their two brethren sacrificed their sire
Oedipus: For lust of power and sceptred sovereignty.
Oedipus: No! me they ne'er shall win for an ally,
Oedipus: Nor will this Theban kingship bring them gain;
Oedipus: That know I from this maiden's oracles,
Oedipus: And those old prophecies concerning me,
Oedipus: Which Phoebus now at length has brought to pass.
Oedipus: Come Creon then, come all the mightiest
Oedipus: In Thebes to seek me; for if ye my friends,
Oedipus: Championed by those dread Powers indigenous,
Oedipus: Espouse my cause; then for the State ye gain
Oedipus: A great deliverer, for my foemen bane.

Lines 455–459

Oedipus: Come Creon then, come all the mightiest
Oedipus: In Thebes to seek me; for if ye my friends,
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Lines 468–469

Chorus: Make a libation first of water fetched
Chorus: With undefilèd hands from living spring.

Line 477

Oedipus: Pouring it from the urns whereof ye spake?

Lines 480–481

Oedipus: And wherewith shall I fill it,
Oedipus: Ere in its place I set it? This too tell.

Lines 506–507

Chorus: Beyond this grove; if thou hast need of aught,
Chorus: The guardian of the close will lend his aid.

Lines 547–548

Oedipus: Horrors from the boundless deep
Oedipus: Back on my soul in refluent surges sweep.

Lines 583–585

583 **Theseus:** Whereat I should recoil. I too was reared,
584 **Theseus:** Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands
585 **Theseus:** Wrestled with many perils, no man more.

Line 602

602 **Theseus:** When may we hope to reap the benefit?

Line 607

607 **Theseus:** The grace thou cravest then is small indeed.

Line 617

617 **Oedipus:** O Theseus, I have suffered wrongs on wrongs.

Lines 621–623

621 **Oedipus:** My case stands thus; by my own flesh and blood
622 **Oedipus:** I was expelled my country, and can ne'er
623 **Oedipus:** Thither return again, a parricide.

Lines 632–636

632 **Oedipus:** Earth's might decays, the might of men decays,
633 **Oedipus:** Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes,
634 **Oedipus:** There is no constancy 'twixt friend and friend,
635 **Oedipus:** Or city and city; be it soon or late,
636 **Oedipus:** Sweet turns to bitter, hate once more to love.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
impious (adjective)	lacking respect for the gods or for duty	*The State around An all unwitting bridegroom bound An impious marriage chain; That was my bane.*	

Discussion questions

1. When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with curse and mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Ismene say in line 394? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The gods who once brought him low now raise him up.
2. What news does Ismene bring? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The sons are fighting over Thebes and Creon is coming for Oedipus
3. Why do the Thebans now want Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: An oracle says whoever holds his grave will prosper
4. How does Oedipus defend himself? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He acted in self-defence and without knowledge
5. Why does Theseus understand Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He too was raised in exile
6. What does Theseus grant Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Protection in Athens
7. Retell the three most important events of "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an…
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "The State around An all unwitting bridegroom bound An impious marriage chain; That was my bane." What does "impious" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: impious: lacking respect for the gods or for duty.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" mean? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: His grave will be valuable after his death.
2. What does "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)" suggest about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes.

3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 261–263. On theme: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “The way is long, And many travellers pass to speed the news.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers…
7. How does “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)” build on “Parodos (lines 115–248)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 393. Theme link: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene): Ismene, lines 394. On characterization: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "When has your own experience helped you understand someone else?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with curse and mercy? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: "I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus): Theseus, lines 583–585. On conflict: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus innocent? Evaluate his argument in lines 261–263 against the play's other evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: "Earth's might decays, the might of men decays, / Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes, / There is no constancy 'twixt friend and friend, / Or city and city; be it soon or late, / Sweet turns to bit" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 632–636. On theme: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 261–263. On theme: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and

answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 393. On characterization: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene): Ismene, lines 394. Theme link: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus): Theseus, lines 583–585. On theme: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to law against force: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “Earth’s might decays, the might of men decays, / Honour grows cold, dishonour flourishes, / There is no constancy ’twixt friend and friend, / Or city and city; be it soon or late, / Sweet turns to bit” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 632–636.

On theme: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 261–263. On characterization: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)” treats Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 393. On theme: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene): Ismene, lines 394. Theme link: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome

reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Useful evidence: “I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus): Theseus, lines 583–585. On theme: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why do the Thebans now want Oedipus?

   A. They need his money

   B. An oracle says whoever holds his grave will prosper

   C. They want to punish him again

   D. They want him as king

   Key: B (An oracle says whoever holds his grave will prosper)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene: “The gods, who once _____, uplift thee now”

   Key: abased

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus: “I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in _____ lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more”

   Key: foreign

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Theseus understand Oedipus?

   A. He is from Thebes

   B. He is blind

   C. He too was raised in exile

   D. He is his son

   Key: C (He too was raised in exile)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What news does Ismene bring?

   A. Theseus is dead

   B. Thebes has fallen

   C. The sons are fighting over Thebes and Creon is coming for Oedipus

   D. Jocasta is alive

   Key: C (The sons are fighting over Thebes and Creon is coming for Oedipus)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus: “So, when I cease to be, my worth _____”

   Key: begins

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus defend himself?

   A. He says Creon did it

   B. He denies everything

   C. He blames Antigone

   D. He acted in self-defence and without knowledge

   Key: D (He acted in self-defence and without knowledge)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The State around An all unwitting bridegroom bound An _____ marriage chain; That was my bane.” Word bank: impious

   Key: impious

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus grant Oedipus?

   A. A throne

   B. A new name

   C. An army

   D. Protection in Athens

   Key: D (Protection in Athens)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus: “Yet am I then / A _____ born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again”

    Key: villain

11. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Ismene say in line 394?

    Sample answer: The gods who once brought him low now raise him up.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" mean?

    Sample answer: His grave will be valuable after his death. The evidence is “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 393. This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Ismene, lines 394. The evidence is “The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. The words “uplift” and “abased” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which literary element does this describe in “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”? Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus…

    A. Simile

    B. Hyperbole

    C. Tone / mood

D. Theme

Key: D (Theme)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

A. Law against force

B. Curse and mercy

C. Refuge and hospitality

D. Guilt and intent

Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) supports it: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. But “I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus) complicates it: the line (Theseus, lines 583–585) shows the same issue from another side, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

17. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 393. The evidence is “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

18. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus).

Sample answer: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. The evidence is “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 261–263. This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus innocent? Evaluate his argument in lines 261–263 against the play's other evidence.

Sample answer: A defended position: Oedipus, lines 261–263. The evidence is “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will

prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 316–318? "Father and sister, names to me most sweet, How hardly have I found you, hardly now When found at last can see you _____ my tears!"

    A. handiwork

    B. masters

    C. through

    D. headgear

    Key: C (through)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 477: "Pouring it from the urns _____ ye spake?" Word bank: handiwork, whereof, indoors, ignoble

    Key: whereof

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 288–289 reveal about the character or situation? "In his ancestral seat; a messenger, The same who sent us here, is gone for him." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 288–289) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "ancestral" and "messenger" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 480–481 reveal about the character or situation? "And wherewith shall I fill it, Ere in its place I set it?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 480–481) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "wherewith" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 335 shapes its tone: "Thy valiant brothers, where are they at need?" Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "brothers" and "valiant" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 335) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 506–507 shapes its tone: "Beyond this grove; if thou hast need of aught, The guardian of the close will lend his aid." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "guardian" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 506–507) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Parodos (lines 115–248) to Episode 1 (lines 249–694). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus, the text reads "Heaven's justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites" — Chorus, lines 222–223. In Episode 1 (lines 249–694), "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, /

Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 261–263. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 261–263. The evidence is "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. The words "because" and "defence" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.
28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 420–421? "They knew it, yet the _____ greed of rule Outweighed all longing for their sire's return."
    A. ignoble
    B. whereof
    C. indoors
    D. masters

    Key: A (ignoble)
29. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)"?
    A. The Colonus ode
    B. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome
    C. The rescue imagined
    D. The elders' fear

    Key: B (Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome)
30. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 261–263. The evidence is "Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus).
31. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 547–548 shapes its tone: "Horrors from the boundless deep Back on my soul in refluent surges sweep." Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "boundless" and "refluent" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 547–548) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 385–386 shapes its tone: "Hast thou indeed then entertained a hope The gods at last will turn and rescue me?" Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "entertained" and "rescue" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 385–386) make the tone heavy and

deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 455–459 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Come Creon then, come all the mightiest In Thebes to seek me; for if ye my friends, Championed by those dread Powers indigenous, Espouse my cause; then for the State ye gain A great deliverer, for my foemen bane.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 455–459) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “indigenous” and “deliverer” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Make a libation first of water fetched With undefilèd hands from living spring.” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 455–459), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 412 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “When what conjunction comes to pass, my child?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 412) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “conjunction” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And can a son of mine have heard of this?” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 412), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 602 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “When may we hope to reap the benefit?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 602) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “benefit” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The grace thou cravest then is small indeed.” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 602), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 393. The evidence is “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. The words “begins” and “cease” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 617 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “O Theseus, I have suffered wrongs on wrongs.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 617) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “suffered” and “wrongs” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “My case stands thus; by my own flesh and blood I was expelled my country, and can ne’er Thither return again, a…” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 617), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	11, 10, 8, 2, 3, 7, 1, 9, 4, 5, 17, 12, 14, 13, 18, 19	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	9, 5, 11, 7, 20, 2, 21, 10, 22, 12, 23, 24, 25, 13, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	5, 3, 28, 10, 9, 29, 30, 12, 23, 22, 24, 13, 31, 32, 19, 33	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 3, 2, 9, 4, 22, 23, 29, 12, 13, 32, 24, 31, 34, 35, 27	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	28, 3, 2, 5, 23, 22, 12, 31, 15, 25, 14, 24, 19, 34, 33, 35	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 3, 9, 8, 1, 7, 12, 32, 31, 24, 13, 25, 26, 35, 33, 16	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	2, 1, 10, 5, 7, 18, 25, 14, 13, 32, 35, 16, 19, 34, 26, 36	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Junior	28, 3, 10, 5, 1, 13, 25, 31, 15, 32, 16, 26, 19, 34, 37, 33	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	10, 8, 5, 1, 7, 29, 13, 31, 32, 35, 16, 34, 37, 33, 27, 19	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	7, 10, 2, 5, 1, 15, 31, 32, 37, 35, 27, 33, 19, 16, 26, 34	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Episode 1 (lines 249–694),” how does Sophocles show Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Episode 1 (lines 249–694), how does Sophocles develop the idea of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 1 (lines 249–694) develops the idea of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 1 (lines 249–694) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 1 (lines 249–694) suggests about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Episode 1 (lines 249–694) to complicate the reader's understanding of

Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 1 (lines 249–694) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 1 (lines 249–694) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 1 (lines 249–694) and its treatment of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 1 (lines 249–694) as evidence for a larger claim about Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 1 (lines 249–694) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *The way is long, And many travellers pass to speed the news. Be sure he'll hear and hasten, never fear; So wide and far thy name is noised abroad, That, were he ne'er so spent and loth to move, He would bestir him when he hears of thee.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 1 (lines 249–694)"?

   A. The mysterious passing

   B. The daughters return; a suppliant son

   C. The elders' fear

   D. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

SAT key: 1. D (Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome)

Lesson 5: Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)

Focus: the Colonus ode

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1

Content note (alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…iced nightingale, Who hid in her bower, among The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale, Trille…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Suggested language: "What does this detail add to the scene?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

Background: Jebb links the play's Colonus setting to local legend (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Sophocles was himself from Colonus.

Significance: The undying olive stands for a city that endures.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because.... Content note before we start: This section mentions drinking or a drug.
Prompt: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the Colonus ode.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: unpruned — never cut back or trimmed by a gardener. steed-famed — famous for its horses.
Words: unpruned: never cut back or trimmed by a gardener · steed-famed: famous for its horses

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Jebb links the play's Colonus setting to local legend (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Sophocles was himself from Colonus. The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Look closely: Jebb links the play's setting to local legend (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). The ode turns from Athena's olive (lines 720–728) to Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar (lines 729–739).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders tell the weary stranger that he has come to rest in a land famous for horses, the best land of all, the shining soil of Colonus. Next, craft. I notice the song piles up praise words, steed-famed, goodliest, glistening, as if welcoming a guest. The strongest word is "rest": the thing Oedipus has sought since Apollo's promise. Then, effect. Why does the ode promise rest to a stranger the elders first tried to drive away? My answer: The ode promises rest to the stranger because the elders now receive Oedipus as a guest under Theseus' protection; the praise of Colonus turns the place of his exile into a home.

> *Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil.* *(Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders tell the weary stranger that he has come to rest in a land famous for horses, the best land of all, the shining soil of Colonus. Next, craft. I notice the song piles up praise words, steed-famed, goodliest, glistening, as if welcoming a guest. The strongest word is "rest": the thing Oedipus has sought since Apollo's promise. Then, effect. Why does the ode promise rest to a stranger the elders first tried to drive away? My answer: The ode promises rest to the stranger because the elders now receive Oedipus as a guest under Theseus' protection; the praise of Colonus turns the place of his exile into a home.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Jebb links the play's Colonus setting to local legend (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Sophocles was himself from Colonus. Read closely: "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, Terror to foemen's spear, A tree in Asian soil unnamed, By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, Self-nurtured year by year; 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; Nor youth nor withering age destroys The plant that the Olive Planter tends And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends." (Chorus, lines 720–728). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: The Colonus ode. (Chorus, lines 720–728.)

> *And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; / Nor youth nor withering age destroys / The plant that the Olive Planter tends / And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends* (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Jebb links the play's Colonus setting to local legend (Jebb, 1885/1889, Introduction, § 8). Sophocles was himself from Colonus. Read closely: "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, Terror to foemen's spear, A tree in Asian soil unnamed, By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, Self-nurtured year by year; 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; Nor youth nor withering age destroys The plant that the Olive Planter tends And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends." (Chorus, lines 720–728).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: The Colonus ode. (Chorus, lines 720–728.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for imagery, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) develops the idea of the Colonus ode. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. When the text says "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus), it shows this directly. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.
Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) develops the idea of the Colonus ode. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. When the text says "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus), it shows this directly. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home? Ask: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?
Anchor question: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?
Facilitation: Ask: What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. ("Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil", Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the Colonus ode? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. ("Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil", Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes the Colonus ode. Key takeaway: the Colonus ode.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.
- **Setting:** The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.
- **Tone / mood:** The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the Colonus ode.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the Colonus ode.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) Chorus, lines 695–698.
- "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; / Nor youth nor withering age destroys / The plant that the Olive Planter tends / And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) Chorus, lines 720–728.
- "Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The undying olive stands for a city that endures.
Evidence: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus)
Reasoning: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Line 136

136 **Chorus:** O dread to see and dread to hear!

Lines 144–158

144 **Chorus:** Wast thou then sightless from thy birth?
145 **Chorus:** Evil, methinks, and long
146 **Chorus:** Thy pilgrimage on earth.
147 **Chorus:** Yet add not curse to curse and wrong to wrong.
148 **Chorus:** I warn thee, trespass not
149 **Chorus:** Within this hallowed spot,
150 **Chorus:** Lest thou shouldst find the silent grassy glade
151 **Chorus:** Where offerings are laid,
152 **Chorus:** Bowls of spring water mingled with sweet mead.
153 **Chorus:** Thou must not stay,
154 **Chorus:** Come, come away,
155 **Chorus:** Tired wanderer, dost thou heed?
156 **Chorus:** (We are far off, but sure our voice can reach.)
157 **Chorus:** If aught thou would'st beseech,
158 **Chorus:** Speak where 'tis right; till then refrain from speech.

Lines 153–158

153 **Chorus:** Thou must not stay,
154 **Chorus:** Come, come away,
155 **Chorus:** Tired wanderer, dost thou heed?

156 **Chorus:** (We are far off, but sure our voice can reach.)
157 **Chorus:** If aught thou would'st beseech,
158 **Chorus:** Speak where 'tis right; till then refrain from speech.

Line 169
169 **Chorus:** Lead maiden, thou canst guide him where we will.

Lines 187–188
187 **Chorus:** Move sideways towards the ledge,
188 **Chorus:** And sit thee crouching on the scarped edge.

Line 198
198 **Chorus:** What is it, old man, that thou would'st conceal?

Line 205
205 **Oedipus:** Ah me, my daughter, now we are undone!

Line 206
206 **Antigone:** Speak, for thou standest on the slippery verge.

Lines 245–248
245 **Chorus:** Surely we pity thee and him alike
246 **Chorus:** Daughter of Oedipus, for your distress;
247 **Chorus:** But as we reverence the decrees of Heaven
248 **Chorus:** We cannot say aught other than we said.

Lines 261–263
261 **Oedipus:** The cause of this your fear. Yet am I then
262 **Oedipus:** A villain born because in self-defence,
263 **Oedipus:** Stricken, I struck the striker back again?

Lines 288–289
288 **Chorus:** In his ancestral seat; a messenger,
289 **Chorus:** The same who sent us here, is gone for him.

Lines 304–307
304 **Antigone:** I see a woman
305 **Antigone:** Riding upon a colt of Aetna's breed;
306 **Antigone:** She wears for headgear a Thessalian hat
307 **Antigone:** To shade her from the sun. Who can it be?

Lines 304–312
304 **Antigone:** I see a woman
305 **Antigone:** Riding upon a colt of Aetna's breed;
306 **Antigone:** She wears for headgear a Thessalian hat
307 **Antigone:** To shade her from the sun. Who can it be?
308 **Antigone:** She or a stranger? Do I wake or dream?

309 **Antigone:** ’Tis she; ’tis not—I cannot tell, alack;
310 **Antigone:** It is no other! Now her bright’ning glance
311 **Antigone:** Greets me with recognition, yes, ’tis she,
312 **Antigone:** Herself, Ismene!

Line 335

335 **Oedipus:** Thy valiant brothers, where are they at need?

Lines 359–360

359 **Oedipus:** This much I know, thou com’st not empty-handed,
360 **Oedipus:** Without a warning of some new alarm.

Lines 361–384

361 **Ismene:** The toil and trouble, father, that I bore
362 **Ismene:** To find thy lodging-place and how thou faredst,
363 **Ismene:** I spare thee; surely ’twere a double pain
364 **Ismene:** To suffer, first in act and then in telling;
365 **Ismene:** ’Tis the misfortune of thine ill-starred sons
366 **Ismene:** I come to tell thee. At the first they willed
367 **Ismene:** To leave the throne to Creon, minded well
368 **Ismene:** Thus to remove the inveterate curse of old,
369 **Ismene:** A canker that infected all thy race.
370 **Ismene:** But now some god and an infatuate soul
371 **Ismene:** Have stirred betwixt them a mad rivalry
372 **Ismene:** To grasp at sovereignty and kingly power.
373 **Ismene:** Today the hot-brained youth, the younger born,
374 **Ismene:** Is keeping Polyneices from the throne,
375 **Ismene:** His elder, and has thrust him from the land.
376 **Ismene:** The banished brother (so all Thebes reports)
377 **Ismene:** Fled to the vale of Argos, and by help
378 **Ismene:** Of new alliance there and friends in arms,
379 **Ismene:** Swears he will stablish Argos straight as lord
380 **Ismene:** Of the Cadmeian land, or, if he fail,
381 **Ismene:** Exalt the victor to the stars of heaven.
382 **Ismene:** This is no empty tale, but deadly truth,
383 **Ismene:** My father; and how long thy agony,
384 **Ismene:** Ere the gods pity thee, I cannot tell.

Lines 406–407

406 **Ismene:** Therefore they fain would have thee close at hand,
407 **Ismene:** Not where thou would’st be master of thyself.

Line 410

410 **Oedipus:** Then never shall they be my masters, never!

Lines 423–459

Oedipus: Then may the gods ne'er quench their fatal feud,
Oedipus: And mine be the arbitrament of the fight,
Oedipus: For which they now are arming, spear to spear;
Oedipus: That neither he who holds the scepter now
Oedipus: May keep his throne, nor he who fled the realm
Oedipus: Return again. They never raised a hand,
Oedipus: When I their sire was thrust from hearth and home;
Oedipus: When I was banned and banished, what recked they?
Oedipus: Say you 'twas done at my desire, a grace
Oedipus: Which the State, yielding to my wish, allowed?
Oedipus: Not so; for, mark you, on that very day
Oedipus: When in the tempest of my soul I craved
Oedipus: Death, even death by stoning, none appeared
Oedipus: To further that wild longing, but anon,
Oedipus: When time had numbed my anguish and I felt
Oedipus: My wrath had all outrun those errors past,
Oedipus: Then, then it was the city went about
Oedipus: By force to oust me, respited for years;
Oedipus: And they my sons, who should as sons have helped,
Oedipus: Did nothing: and, one little word from them
Oedipus: Was all I needed, and they spoke no word,
Oedipus: But let me wander on forevermore,
Oedipus: A banished man, a beggar. These two maids
Oedipus: Their sisters, girls, gave all their sex could give,
Oedipus: Food and safe harbourage and filial care;
Oedipus: While their two brethren sacrificed their sire
Oedipus: For lust of power and sceptred sovereignty.
Oedipus: No! me they ne'er shall win for an ally,
Oedipus: Nor will this Theban kingship bring them gain;
Oedipus: That know I from this maiden's oracles,
Oedipus: And those old prophecies concerning me,
Oedipus: Which Phoebus now at length has brought to pass.
Oedipus: Come Creon then, come all the mightiest
Oedipus: In Thebes to seek me; for if ye my friends,
Oedipus: Championed by those dread Powers indigenous,
Oedipus: Espouse my cause; then for the State ye gain
Oedipus: A great deliverer, for my foemen bane.

Lines 471–472

Chorus: Bowls thou wilt find, the carver's handiwork;
Chorus: Crown thou the rims and both the handles crown—

Line 474

474 **Chorus:** With wool from fleece of yearling freshly shorn.

Lines 480–481

480 **Oedipus:** And wherewith shall I fill it,
481 **Oedipus:** Ere in its place I set it? This too tell.

Line 494

494 **Oedipus:** Hear ye, my daughters, what these strangers say?

Lines 506–507

506 **Chorus:** Beyond this grove; if thou hast need of aught,
507 **Chorus:** The guardian of the close will lend his aid.

Lines 527–528

527 **Oedipus:** Know then I suffered ills most vile, but none
528 **Oedipus:** (So help me Heaven!) from acts in malice done.

Lines 590–595

590 **Oedipus:** Theseus, thy words so apt, so generous
591 **Oedipus:** So comfortable, need no long reply.
592 **Oedipus:** Both who I am and of what lineage sprung,
593 **Oedipus:** And from what land I came, thou hast declared.
594 **Oedipus:** So without prologue I may utter now
595 **Oedipus:** My brief petition, and the tale is told.

Lines 594–595

594 **Oedipus:** So without prologue I may utter now
595 **Oedipus:** My brief petition, and the tale is told.

Lines 611–612

611 **Theseus:** If there be no compulsion, then methinks
612 **Theseus:** To rest in banishment befits not thee.

Lines 629–631

629 **Oedipus:** Dear son of Aegeus, to the gods alone
630 **Oedipus:** Is given immunity from eld and death;
631 **Oedipus:** But nothing else escapes all-ruinous time.

Lines 651–653

651 **Chorus:** The man, my lord, has from the very first
652 **Chorus:** Declared his power to offer to our land
653 **Chorus:** These and like benefits.

Line 695

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,

Lines 695–698

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,
696 **Chorus:** O stranger worn with toil,
697 **Chorus:** To a land of all lands the goodliest
698 **Chorus:** Colonus' glistening soil.

Lines 695–739

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,
696 **Chorus:** O stranger worn with toil,
697 **Chorus:** To a land of all lands the goodliest
698 **Chorus:** Colonus' glistening soil.
699 **Chorus:** 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale,
700 **Chorus:** Who hid in her bower, among
701 **Chorus:** The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale,
702 **Chorus:** Trilleth her ceaseless song;
703 **Chorus:** And she loves, where the clustering berries nod
704 **Chorus:** O'er a sunless, windless glade,
705 **Chorus:** The spot by no mortal footstep trod,
706 **Chorus:** The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god,
707 **Chorus:** Where he holds each night his revels wild
708 **Chorus:** With the nymphs who fostered the lusty child.
709 **Chorus:** And fed each morn by the pearly dew
710 **Chorus:** The starred narcissi shine,
711 **Chorus:** And a wreath with the crocus' golden hue
712 **Chorus:** For the Mother and Daughter twine.
713 **Chorus:** And never the sleepless fountains cease
714 **Chorus:** That feed Cephisus' stream,
715 **Chorus:** But they swell earth's bosom with quick increase,
716 **Chorus:** And their wave hath a crystal gleam.
717 **Chorus:** And the Muses' quire will never disdain
718 **Chorus:** To visit this heaven-favoured plain,
719 **Chorus:** Nor the Cyprian queen of the golden rein.
720 **Chorus:** And here there grows, unpruned, untamed,
721 **Chorus:** Terror to foemen's spear,
722 **Chorus:** A tree in Asian soil unnamed,
723 **Chorus:** By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed,
724 **Chorus:** Self-nurtured year by year;
725 **Chorus:** 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;
726 **Chorus:** Nor youth nor withering age destroys
727 **Chorus:** The plant that the Olive Planter tends
728 **Chorus:** And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends.
729 **Chorus:** Yet another gift, of all gifts the most
730 **Chorus:** Prized by our fatherland, we boast—
731 **Chorus:** The might of the horse, the might of the sea;

732 **Chorus:** Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee,
733 **Chorus:** Son of Kronos, our king divine,
734 **Chorus:** Who in these highways first didst fit
735 **Chorus:** For the mouth of horses the iron bit;
736 **Chorus:** Thou too hast taught us to fashion meet
737 **Chorus:** For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet,
738 **Chorus:** Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet
739 **Chorus:** As they dance along the brine.

Lines 720–728

720 **Chorus:** And here there grows, unpruned, untamed,
721 **Chorus:** Terror to foemen's spear,
722 **Chorus:** A tree in Asian soil unnamed,
723 **Chorus:** By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed,
724 **Chorus:** Self-nurtured year by year;
725 **Chorus:** 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;
726 **Chorus:** Nor youth nor withering age destroys
727 **Chorus:** The plant that the Olive Planter tends
728 **Chorus:** And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends.

Lines 729–739

729 **Chorus:** Yet another gift, of all gifts the most
730 **Chorus:** Prized by our fatherland, we boast—
731 **Chorus:** The might of the horse, the might of the sea;
732 **Chorus:** Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee,
733 **Chorus:** Son of Kronos, our king divine,
734 **Chorus:** Who in these highways first didst fit
735 **Chorus:** For the mouth of horses the iron bit;
736 **Chorus:** Thou too hast taught us to fashion meet
737 **Chorus:** For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet,
738 **Chorus:** Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet
739 **Chorus:** As they dance along the brine.

Lines 736–739

736 **Chorus:** Thou too hast taught us to fashion meet
737 **Chorus:** For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet,
738 **Chorus:** Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet
739 **Chorus:** As they dance along the brine.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

unpruned (adjective)	never cut back or trimmed by a gardener	*And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, Terror to foemen's spear, A tree in Asian soil unnamed, By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, Self-nurtured year by year; 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; Nor youth nor withering age destroys The plant that the Olive Planter tends And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends.*	"unpruned": not pruned; the verb "prune" in its plant sense, "lop superfluous twigs or branches from," is from the 1540s, from Old French proignier "cut back (vines), prune." (Online Etymology Dictionary (hand-checked note), https://www.etymonline.com/word/prune)
steed-famed (adjective)	famous for its horses	*Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, O stranger worn with toil, To a land of all lands the goodliest Colonus' glistening soil.*	"steed-famed": "steed" is from Old English steda "stallion, stud horse"; in Middle English "a great horse," "a spirited war horse"; obsolete from the 16c. except in poetic language. (Online Etymology Dictionary (hand-checked note), https://www.etymonline.com/word/steed)

Discussion questions

1. What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with law against force?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What can neither youth nor age destroy? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The olive tree.
2. What land does the ode praise? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Colonus and Athens
3. What tree does the ode celebrate? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The olive
4. Who defends the olive, according to the ode? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The Grey-eyed Goddess (Athena)
5. What is Colonus called in line 695? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A steed-famed land
6. What is the tone of the ode? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Proud and loving

7. Retell the three most important events of "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.
8. Who is on stage in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that begins "Strophe 1 Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, O stranger worn with toil, To a land of all lands the goodliest Colonus' glistening soil.", who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why place a hymn of praise right after Theseus' welcome? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: It celebrates the city that has just shown hospitality.
2. What does "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" suggest about the Colonus ode? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The undying olive stands for a city that endures.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the setting in this scene shape what we understand about the Colonus ode? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 695–698. On setting: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Strophe 1 Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, O stranger worn with toil, To a land of all lands the goodliest Colonus' glistening soil.", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1,

RL.11-12.3] Look for: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

7. How does “Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)” build on “Episode 1 (lines 249–694)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: “And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen’s spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops’ Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / ’Tis the grey-leaved olive that” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 720–728. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: “Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “What would you name if you wrote a song praising your own home?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with law against force? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening soil” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 695–698. On tone / mood: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is the ode about Oedipus, Athens, or both? Defend your reading. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: “And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen’s spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops’ Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / ’Tis the grey-leaved olive that” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 720–728. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. A critic might argue: "The undying olive stands for a city that endures." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 695–698. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the Colonus ode. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 720–728. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to death and blessing: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 695–698.

Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 720–728. On imagery: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)" treats the Colonus ode with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 695–698. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the Colonus ode? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Useful evidence: "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus): Chorus, lines 720–728. Theme link: the Colonus ode. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 144–158: "Evil, methinks, and long Thy _____ on earth." Word bank: outlaw, offerings, comest, pilgrimage
   Key: pilgrimage
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 206: "Speak, for thou _____ on the slippery verge." Word bank: outlaw, standest, offerings, favourite
   Key: standest
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 471–472? "Bowls thou wilt find, the carver's _____; Crown thou the rims and both the handles crown—"
   A. headgear
   B. warning
   C. learns
   D. handiwork

   Key: D (handiwork)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who defends the olive, according to the ode?
   A. Zeus
   B. The Grey-eyed Goddess (Athena)
   C. Creon
   D. Apollo

   Key: B (The Grey-eyed Goddess (Athena))
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What land does the ode praise?
   A. Corinth
   B. Colonus and Athens
   C. Delphi
   D. Thebes

   Key: B (Colonus and Athens)
6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is Colonus called in line 695?
   A. A steed-famed land
   B. A city of war
   C. A barren rock
   D. A land of plague

   Key: A (A steed-famed land)
7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus: "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle _____, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds

our boys; / Nor youth nor withering age destroys / The plant that the Olive Planter tends / And…"
Key: unclaimed

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus: "Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced _____, / Who hid in her bower, among"
Key: nightingale

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus: "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' _____ soil"
Key: glistening

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 136 reveal about the character or situation? "O dread to see and dread to hear!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 136) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words its wording are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 527–528 reveal about the character or situation? "Antistrophe 1 Know then I suffered ills most vile, but none (So help me Heaven!) from acts in malice done." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 527–528) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "suffered" and "malice" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why place a hymn of praise right after Theseus' welcome?
Sample answer: It celebrates the city that has just shown hospitality. The evidence is "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 695–698.

13. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)"?
A. The Colonus ode
B. The beggar at the sacred grove
C. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome
D. A prayer for an easy death
Key: A (The Colonus ode)

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 611–612 shapes its tone: "If there be no compulsion, then methinks To rest in banishment befits not thee." Pick two words and explain their effect.
Sample answer: The words "compulsion" and "banishment" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 611–612) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 423–459 shapes its tone: "They never raised a hand, When I their sire was thrust from hearth and home; When I was banned and banished, what recked they?" Pick two words and explain

their effect.

Sample answer: The words “banished” and “hearth” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 423–459) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 245–248 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Surely we pity thee and him alike Daughter of Oedipus, for your distress; But as we reverence the decrees of Heaven We cannot say aught other than we said.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 245–248) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “reverence” and “distress” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “O dread to see and dread to hear!” (Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 245–248), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 410: “Then never shall they be my _____, never!” Word bank: headgear, masters, argument, disappointed

    Key: masters

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 304–307: “I see a woman Riding upon a colt of Aetna’s breed; She wears for _____ a Thessalian hat To shade her from the sun.” Word bank: indoors, headgear, ignoble, learns

    Key: headgear

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the tone of the ode?

    A. Mocking
    B. Fearful
    C. Angry
    D. Proud and loving

    Key: D (Proud and loving)

20. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What can neither youth nor age destroy?

    Sample answer: The olive tree.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 361–384 reveal about the character or situation? “At the first they willed To leave the throne to Creon, minded well Thus to remove the inveterate curse of old, A canker that infected all thy race.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 361–384) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “inveterate” and “infected” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)?

    A. “Antistrophe 1 And fed each morn by the pearly dew The starred narcissi shine, And a wreath with the crocus’ golden hue For the Mother and…”
    B. “Antistrophe 2 Yet another gift, of all gifts the most Prized by our fatherland, we boast— The might of the horse, the might of the sea”
    C. “And the Muses’ quire will never disdain To visit this heaven-favoured plain, Nor the Cyprian queen of the golden rein.”

D. “And never the sleepless fountains cease That feed Cephisus’ stream, But they swell earth’s bosom with quick increase, And their wave hath a…”

Key: A (“Antistrophe 1 And fed each morn by the pearly dew The starred narcissi shine, And a wreath with the crocus’ golden hue For the Mother and…”)

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 594–595 shapes its tone: “So without prologue I may utter now My brief petition, and the tale is told.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “petition” and “prologue” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 594–595) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)”? The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

A. Structure

B. Point of view

C. Imagery

D. Foreshadowing

Key: C (Imagery)

25. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Colonus ode.

A. Curse and mercy

B. Law against force

C. Refuge and hospitality

D. Guilt and intent

Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 474 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “With wool from fleece of yearling freshly shorn.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 474) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “yearling” and “freshly” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And wherewith shall I fill it, Ere in its place I set it?” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 474), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 187–188? “Move sideways towards the ledge, And sit thee _____ on the scarped edge.”

A. crouching

B. country

C. pilgrimage

D. offerings

Key: A (crouching)

28. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 1 (lines 249–694)?

    A. “Thy valiant brothers, where are they at need?”

    B. “Father and sister, names to me most sweet, How hardly have I found you, hardly now When found at last can see you through my tears!”

    C. “Now her bright’ning glance Greets me with recognition, yes, ’tis she, Herself, Ismene!”

    D. “I see a woman Riding upon a colt of Aetna’s breed; She wears for headgear a Thessalian hat To shade her from the sun.”

    Key: D (“I see a woman Riding upon a colt of Aetna’s breed; She wears for headgear a Thessalian hat To shade her from the sun.”)

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 169 shapes its tone: “Lead maiden, thou canst guide him where we will.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “maiden” (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 169) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), line 198 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “What is it, old man, that thou would’st conceal?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 198) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “conceal” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Ah me, my daughter, now we are undone!” (Parodos (lines 115–248), line 198), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 494 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Hear ye, my daughters, what these strangers say?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 494) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “strangers” and “daughters” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Beyond this grove; if thou hast need of aught, The guardian of the close will lend his aid.” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 494), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

32. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 359–360? “This much I know, thou com’st not empty-handed, Without a _____ of some new alarm.”

    A. learns

    B. warning

    C. whereof

    D. masters

    Key: B (warning)

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 406–407 shapes its tone: “Therefore they fain would have thee close at hand, Not where thou would’st be master of thyself.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “thyself” and “master” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 406–407) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 335 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Now her bright’ning glance Greets me with recognition, yes, ’tis she, Herself, Ismene!” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 335) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “recognition” and “glance” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Thy valiant brothers, where are they at need?” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), line 335), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 651–653 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “The man, my lord, has from the very first Declared his power to offer to our land These and like benefits.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 651–653) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “benefits” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “In his ancestral seat; a messenger, The same who sent us here, is gone for him.” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), lines 651–653), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is the ode about Oedipus, Athens, or both? Defend your reading.
Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 695–698. The evidence is “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Episode 1 (lines 249–694) to Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus, the text reads “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” — Oedipus, lines 261–263. In Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 695–698. The Colonus ode.

38. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening soil” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus).
Sample answer: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar. The evidence is “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 695–698. This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode.

39. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The

words “nightingale” and “voiced” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

40. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The undying olive stands for a city that endures.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening soil” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) supports it: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar. But “Dear son of Aegeus, to the gods alone / Is given immunity from eld and death; / But nothing else escapes all-ruinous time.” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) complicates it: in lines 629–631 Oedipus tells Theseus that only the gods escape age and death, and that nothing else escapes all-ruinous time. Cities and friendships change; the olive's endurance is a hope, not a certainty, so the claim is a strong reading, not a complete one.

41. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 153–158 shapes its tone: “Thou must not stay, Come, come away, Tired wanderer, dost thou heed? (We are far off, but sure our voice can reach.) If aught thou would’st beseech, Speak where ’tis right; till then refrain from speech.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “wanderer” and “refrain” (Parodos (lines 115–248), lines 153–158) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

42. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Connect this passage from Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), lines 736–739 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Thou too hast taught us to fashion meet For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet, Swift as the Nereids’ hundred feet As they dance along the brine.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), lines 736–739) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “hundred” and “fashion” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And never the sleepless fountains cease That feed Cephisus’ stream, But they swell earth’s bosom with quick increase,…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), lines 736–739), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

43. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What tree does the ode celebrate?

    A. The olive
    B. The laurel
    C. The oak
    D. The cypress

    Key: A (The olive)

44. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen’s spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops’ Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / ’Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; / Nor youth nor…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 720–728. The evidence is “And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen’s spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops’ Dorian isle unclaimed, /…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The words “unclaimed” and “withering” carry that meaning: they are the

charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

45. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus)

    A. The title character, who will die halfway through.

    B. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    C. The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.

    D. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

    Key: B (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

46. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening soil” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 695–698. The evidence is “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The words “glistening” and “goodliest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 17, 18, 19, 20, 9, 6, 8, 11, 21, 22, 12, 23, 24, 25, 26	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	27, 7, 6, 9, 19, 5, 10, 28, 11, 22, 12, 29, 24, 25, 30, 31	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 32, 3, 7, 9, 10, 21, 11, 28, 22, 14, 33, 15, 24, 34, 31	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 5, 8, 9, 10, 21, 28, 11, 22, 29, 15, 33, 24, 35, 36, 37	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 2, 3, 19, 10, 28, 11, 14, 33, 38, 25, 39, 34, 36, 40, 37	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	27, 3, 7, 8, 10, 22, 12, 41, 29, 23, 15, 24, 30, 31, 42, 36	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	8, 4, 9, 5, 43, 22, 41, 29, 33, 23, 14, 26, 34, 40, 42, 36	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	1, 9, 4, 5, 28, 41, 33, 15, 23, 24, 16, 30, 34, 40, 44, 42	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	1, 5, 7, 43, 45, 29, 14, 15, 25, 30, 34, 31, 26, 35, 42, 46	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	1, 2, 4, 5, 43, 22, 29, 41, 30, 16, 31, 26, 35, 37, 40, 42	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739),” how does Sophocles show the Colonus ode? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the Colonus ode? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) develops the idea of the Colonus ode. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the Colonus ode. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) suggests about the Colonus ode. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) to complicate the reader's understanding of the Colonus ode. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the Colonus ode responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the Colonus ode follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) and its treatment of the Colonus ode. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) as evidence for a larger claim about the Colonus ode in

Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the Colonus ode. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, O stranger worn with toil, To a land of all lands the goodliest Colonus' glistening soil. 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, Who hid in her bower, among The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale, Trilleth her ceaseless song; And she loves, where the clustering berries nod O'er a sunless, windless glade, The spot by no mortal footstep trod, The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god, Where he holds each night his revels wild With the nymphs who fostered the lusty child. Antistrophe 1 And fed each morn by the pearly dew The starred narcissi shine, And a wreath with the crocus' golden hue For the Mother and Daughter twine. And never the sleepless fountains cease That feed Cephisus' stream, But they swell earth's bosom with quick increase, And their wave hath a crystal gleam. And the Muses' quire will never disdain To visit this heaven-favoured plain, Nor the Cyprian queen of the golden rein. Strophe 2 And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, Terror to foemen's spear, A tree in Asian soil unnamed, By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, Self-nurtured year by year; 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; Nor youth nor withering age destroys The plant that the Olive Planter tends And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends. Antistrophe 2 Yet another gift, of all gifts the most Prized by our fatherland, we boast— The might of the horse, the might of the sea; Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee, Son of Kronos, our king divine, Who in these highways first didst fit For the mouth of horses the iron bit; Thou too hast taught us to fashion meet For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet, Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet As they dance along the brine.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)"?

   A. "Not to be born"

   B. The Colonus ode

   C. The mysterious passing

   D. Creon seizes the daughters

SAT key: 1. B (The Colonus ode)

Lesson 6: Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)

Focus: Creon seizes the daughters

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: "What does this passage make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

Background: Slavery was legal in ancient Greece; Creon and Theseus use "slave" as an insult (lines 869, 963). Owning a person is wrong, and slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022, Executive summary).

Significance: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957).

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Creon seizes the daughters.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Three key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: freebooter — a pirate or plunderer; minions — followers who obey a leader without question; ravisher — (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force.
Words: freebooter: a pirate or plunderer · minions: followers who obey a leader without question · ravisher: (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Slavery was legal in ancient Greece; Creon and Theseus use "slave" as an insult (lines 869, 963). Owning a person is wrong, and slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022, Executive summary). The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Look closely: Slavery was legal in ancient Greece; Creon and Theseus use slave as an insult (lines 869, 963). Owning a person is wrong, and slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022, Executive summary).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content." slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus tells Creon that talking is useless: go, and leave him here; whatever happens, a man who is content does not live badly. Next, craft. I notice a sharp dismissal ends in a calm saying about contentment. The strongest word is "content": satisfied with one's lot. Then, effect. What does Oedipus' claim that a contented man does not live ill reveal about how he has changed? My answer: The claim that a contented man does not live ill reveals how Oedipus has changed: the king who once demanded every answer now asks nothing of Creon except to be left in the place he has chosen.

> *Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content.* *(Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content." slowly and put it in my own words: Oedipus tells Creon that talking is useless: go, and leave him here; whatever happens, a man who is content does not live badly. Next, craft. I notice a sharp dismissal ends in a calm saying about contentment. The strongest word is "content": satisfied with one's lot. Then, effect. What does Oedipus' claim that a contented man does not live ill reveal about how he has changed? My answer: The claim that a contented man does not live ill reveals how Oedipus has changed: the king who once demanded every answer now asks nothing of Creon except to be left in the place he has chosen.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Slavery was legal in ancient Greece; Creon and Theseus use "slave" as an insult (lines 869, 963). Owning a person is wrong, and slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022, Executive summary). Read closely: "Command your minions; I am not your slave." (Creon, lines 869). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: Creon seizes the daughters. (Creon, lines 869.)

> *Command your minions; I am not your slave* *(Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Slavery was legal in ancient Greece; Creon and Theseus use "slave" as an insult (lines 869, 963). Owning a person is wrong, and slavery still exists today (International Labour Organization et al., 2022, Executive summary). Read closely: "Command your minions; I am not your slave." (Creon, lines 869).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: Creon seizes the daughters. (Creon, lines 869.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) develops the idea of Creon seizes the daughters. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). When the text says "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus), it shows this directly. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) develops the idea of Creon seizes the daughters. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). When the text says "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus), it shows this directly. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you? Ask: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?

Anchor question: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?

Facilitation: Ask: How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). (“Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freeb”, Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). (“Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freeb”, Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes Creon seizes the daughters. Key takeaway: Creon seizes the daughters.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.
- **Characterization:** Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.
- **Theme:** Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** Creon seizes the daughters.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Creon seizes the daughters.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 816–818.
- "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon) Creon, lines 869.
- "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus) Theseus, lines 956–963.
- "Anger has no old age but only death; / The dead alone can feel no touch of spite" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon) Creon, lines 1001–1002.
- "And if / When born to misery, as born I was, / I met my sire, not knowing whom I met / Or what I did, and slew him, how canst thou / With justice blame the all-unconscious hand" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1019–1023.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957).
Evidence: "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus)
Reasoning: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 695–698

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,
696 **Chorus:** O stranger worn with toil,
697 **Chorus:** To a land of all lands the goodliest
698 **Chorus:** Colonus' glistening soil.

Lines 816–818

816 **Oedipus:** Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone,
817 **Oedipus:** And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot,
818 **Oedipus:** He lives not ill who lives withal content.

Lines 823–824
823 **Creon:** Unhappy man, will years ne'er make thee wise?
824 **Creon:** Must thou live on to cast a slur on age?

Line 824
824 **Creon:** Must thou live on to cast a slur on age?

Line 828
828 **Oedipus:** Thy words, forsooth, are few and all well aimed!

Line 829
829 **Creon:** Not for a man indeed with wits like thine.

Line 839
839 **Oedipus:** What power hast thou to execute this threat?

Line 855
855 **Creon:** I meddle not with him, but her who is mine.

Lines 862–863
862 **Chorus:** What means this, sirrah? quick unhand her, or
863 **Chorus:** We'll fight it out.

Line 869
869 **Creon:** Command your minions; I am not your slave.

Lines 903–904
903 **Oedipus:** Goddesses, allow
904 **Oedipus:** Thy suppliant to utter yet one curse!

Lines 903–909
903 **Oedipus:** Goddesses, allow
904 **Oedipus:** Thy suppliant to utter yet one curse!
905 **Oedipus:** Wretch, now my eyes are gone thou hast torn away
906 **Oedipus:** The helpless maiden who was eyes to me;
907 **Oedipus:** For this to thee and all thy cursèd race
908 **Oedipus:** May the great Sun, whose eye is everywhere,
909 **Oedipus:** Grant length of days and old age like to mine.

Lines 916–917
916 **Chorus:** Thou art a bold man, stranger, if thou think'st
917 **Chorus:** To execute thy purpose.

Line 919
919 **Chorus:** Then shall I deem this State no more a State.

Lines 927–930

927 **Chorus:** Haste ye princes, sound the alarm!
928 **Chorus:** Men of Athens, arm ye, arm!
929 **Chorus:** Quickly to the rescue come
930 **Chorus:** Ere the robbers get them home.

Line 936

936 **Theseus:** What is this wrong and who hath wrought it? Speak.

Lines 956–963

956 **Theseus:** And thine own race and country. Having come
957 **Theseus:** Unto a State that champions right and asks
958 **Theseus:** For every action warranty of law,
959 **Theseus:** Thou hast set aside the custom of the land,
960 **Theseus:** And like some freebooter art carrying off
961 **Theseus:** What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth
962 **Theseus:** Thou thoughtest this a city without men,
963 **Theseus:** Or manned by slaves, and me a thing of naught.

Lines 983–984

983 **Chorus:** Thy case is perilous; though by birth and race
984 **Chorus:** Thou should'st be just, thou plainly doest wrong.

Lines 1001–1002

1001 **Creon:** Anger has no old age but only death;
1002 **Creon:** The dead alone can feel no touch of spite.

Lines 1019–1023

1019 **Oedipus:** Conceivèd in no mother's womb? And if
1020 **Oedipus:** When born to misery, as born I was,
1021 **Oedipus:** I met my sire, not knowing whom I met
1022 **Oedipus:** Or what I did, and slew him, how canst thou
1023 **Oedipus:** With justice blame the all-unconscious hand?

Lines 1068–1084

1068 **Theseus:** Show us the trail, and I'll attend thee too,
1069 **Theseus:** That, if thou hast the maidens hereabouts,
1070 **Theseus:** Thou mayst thyself discover them to me;
1071 **Theseus:** But if thy guards outstrip us with their spoil,
1072 **Theseus:** We may draw rein; for others speed, from whom
1073 **Theseus:** They will not 'scape to thank the gods at home.
1074 **Theseus:** Lead on, I say, the captor's caught, and fate
1075 **Theseus:** Hath ta'en the fowler in the toils he spread;
1076 **Theseus:** So soon are lost gains gotten by deceit.
1077 **Theseus:** And look not for allies; I know indeed
1078 **Theseus:** Such height of insolence was never reached

1079 **Theseus:** Without abettors or accomplices;
1080 **Theseus:** Thou hast some backer in thy bold essay,
1081 **Theseus:** But I will search this matter home and see
1082 **Theseus:** One man doth not prevail against the State.
1083 **Theseus:** Dost take my drift, or seem these words as vain
1084 **Theseus:** As seemed our warnings when the plot was hatched?

Lines 1077–1082
1077 **Theseus:** And look not for allies; I know indeed
1078 **Theseus:** Such height of insolence was never reached
1079 **Theseus:** Without abettors or accomplices;
1080 **Theseus:** Thou hast some backer in thy bold essay,
1081 **Theseus:** But I will search this matter home and see
1082 **Theseus:** One man doth not prevail against the State.

Lines 1090–1091
1090 **Oedipus:** Heaven bless thee, Theseus, for thy nobleness
1091 **Oedipus:** And all thy loving care in my behalf. Exeunt Theseus and Creon.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
freebooter (noun)	a pirate or plunderer	*Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off*	
minions (noun)	followers who obey a leader without question	*Command your minions; I am not your slave.*	
ravisher (noun)	(archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force	*Ah! who had e'er imagined she could fall To such a depth of misery as this, To tend in penury thy stricken frame, A virgin ripe for wedlock, but unwed, A prey for any wanton ravisher?*	

Discussion questions

1. How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with death and blessing?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Theseus say Athens asks of every action? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Warranty of law.
2. What does Creon do when Oedipus refuses to return? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Seizes his daughters
3. Why does Theseus rebuke Creon? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He broke the law of Athens by using force
4. What does Theseus send his men to do? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Rescue the daughters
5. How does Oedipus answer the charge of pollution? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He acted without knowing
6. What does Theseus call Creon's behaviour? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Like a freebooter carrying off plunder
7. Retell the three most important events of "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off" What does "freebooter" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: freebooter: a pirate or plunderer.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Creon pretend friendship at first? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He hopes to persuade Oedipus before using force.
2. What does "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)" suggest about Creon seizes the daughters? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957).
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.

4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Creon seizes the daughters? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Howbeit, I know I waste my words— begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 816–818. On characterization: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “So those two crutches shall no longer serve thee For further roaming.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.
7. How does “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)” build on “Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Command your minions; I am not your slave” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon): Creon, lines 869. Theme link: Creon seizes the daughters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pl” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus): Theseus, lines 956–963. On characterization: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can you tell when someone is pretending to care in order to control you?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your

mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with death and blessing? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Anger has no old age but only death; / The dead alone can feel no touch of spite” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon): Creon, lines 1001–1002. On theme: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does intent decide guilt? Evaluate Oedipus' argument in lines 1019–1023. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “And if / When born to misery, as born I was, / I met my sire, not knowing whom I met / Or what I did, and slew him, how canst thou / With justice blame the all-unconscious hand” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1019–1023. On theme: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957).” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Howbeit, I know I waste my words— begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 816–818. On theme: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens

as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Command your minions; I am not your slave” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon): Creon, lines 869. On characterization: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Creon seizes the daughters. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pl” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus): Theseus, lines 956–963. Theme link: Creon seizes the daughters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Anger has no old age but only death; / The dead alone can feel no touch of spite” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon): Creon, lines 1001–1002. On theme: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to refuge and hospitality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “And if / When born to misery, as born I was, / I met my sire, not knowing whom I met / Or what I did, and slew him, how canst thou / With justice blame the all-unconscious hand” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1019–1023. On theme: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Howbeit, I know I waste my words— begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 816–818. On conflict: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)” treats Creon seizes the daughters with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Command your minions; I am not your slave” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon): Creon, lines 869. On theme: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pl” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus): Theseus, lines 956–963. Theme link: Creon seizes the daughters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Creon seizes the daughters? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Useful evidence: “Anger has no old age but only death; / The dead alone can feel no touch of spite” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon): Creon, lines 1001–1002. On theme: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus call Creon's behaviour?

   A. Like a fair trade

   B. Like a king's duty

   C. Like a priest's rite

   D. Like a freebooter carrying off plunder

   Key: D (Like a freebooter carrying off plunder)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why does Theseus rebuke Creon?

   A. He was late

   B. He refused to pray

   C. He insulted Ismene's clothes

   D. He broke the law of Athens by using force

   Key: D (He broke the law of Athens by using force)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus: "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some _____ art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou thoughtest this a city without men, / Or manned by slaves, and me a…"

   Key: freebooter

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Creon do when Oedipus refuses to return?

   A. Asks Theseus for help

   B. Seizes his daughters

   C. Kneels to the gods

   D. Leaves quietly

   Key: B (Seizes his daughters)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Ah! who had e'er imagined she could fall To such a depth of misery as this, To tend in penury thy stricken frame, A virgin ripe for wedlock, but unwed, A prey for any wanton ravisher?", what does "ravisher" most nearly mean?

   A. a high point of land jutting into the sea

   B. a disaster causing great distress

   C. able to be touched or felt

   D. (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force

   Key: D ((archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Command your _____; I am not your slave.” Word bank: ravisher, freebooter, minions
   Key: minions
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus send his men to do?
   A. Arrest Oedipus
   B. Burn the grove
   C. Rescue the daughters
   D. Attack Thebes
   Key: C (Rescue the daughters)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus answer the charge of pollution?
   A. He acted without knowing
   B. He admits he planned it
   C. He says Creon is guilty
   D. He says Jocasta did it
   Key: A (He acted without knowing)
9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus say Athens asks of every action?
   Sample answer: Warranty of law.
10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some _____ art carrying off” Word bank: ravisher, minions, freebooter
    Key: freebooter
11. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus: “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal _____”
    Key: content
12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Command your minions; I am not your slave” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Creon, lines 869. The evidence is “Command your minions; I am not your slave” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Creon pretend friendship at first?
    Sample answer: He hopes to persuade Oedipus before using force. The evidence is “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 816–818.
14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)”? Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls…
    A. Conflict
    B. Hyperbole
    C. Setting
    D. Structure

Key: A (Conflict)

15. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Creon seizes the daughters.

    A. Guilt and intent

    B. Refuge and hospitality

    C. Curse and mercy

    D. Law against force

    Key: B (Refuge and hospitality)

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) to Episode 2 (lines 740–1091). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus, the text reads "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…" — Chorus, lines 695–698. In Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 816–818. Creon seizes the daughters.

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 829? "Not for a man _____ with wits like thine."

    A. stranger

    B. dearer

    C. indeed

    D. understand

    Key: C (indeed)

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 916–917: "Thou art a bold man, _____, if thou think'st To execute thy purpose." Word bank: overthrow, stranger, protest, everywhere

    Key: stranger

19. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 1077–1082 reveal about the character or situation? "And look not for allies; I know indeed Such height of insolence was never reached Without abettors or accomplices; Thou hast some backer in thy bold essay, But I will search this matter home and see One man doth not prevail against the…" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 1077–1082) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "accomplices" and "insolence" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 839 reveal about the character or situation? "What power hast thou to execute this threat?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 839) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "execute" and "threat" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)?

    A. “Thy words, forsooth, are few and all well aimed!”

    B. “Must thou live on to cast a slur on age?”

    C. “Unhappy man, will years ne’er make thee wise?”

    D. “Thou hast a glib tongue, but no honest man, Methinks, can argue well on any side.”

    Key: C (“Unhappy man, will years ne’er make thee wise?”)

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 862–863 shapes its tone: “What means this, sirrah? quick unhand her, or We’ll fight it out.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “unhand” and “sirrah” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 862–863) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 1090–1091 shapes its tone: “Heaven bless thee, Theseus, for thy nobleness And all thy loving care in my behalf.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “nobleness” and “behalf” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 1090–1091) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 903–904 shapes its tone: “Goddesses, allow Thy suppliant to utter yet one curse!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “suppliant” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 903–904) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state ‘that champions right’ (line 957).” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some…” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus) supports it: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. But “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 816–818) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 855: “I _____ not with him, but her who is mine.” Word bank: tongue, everywhere, daughters, meddle

    Key: meddle

27. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 816–818. The evidence is "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus).

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 936 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: "What is this wrong and who hath wrought it?" Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 936) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words "wrought" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Thy case is perilous; though by birth and race Thou should'st be just, thou plainly doest wrong." (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 936), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Creon, lines 869. The evidence is "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters. The words "minions" and "slave" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does intent decide guilt? Evaluate Oedipus' argument in lines 1019–1023.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Theseus, lines 956–963. The evidence is "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land,…" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 919 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: "Then shall I deem this State no more a State." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 919) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Quickly to the rescue come Ere the robbers get them home." (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 919), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou…" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Theseus, lines 956–963. The evidence is "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land,…" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters. The words "freebooter" and "thoughtest" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 824 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: "Must thou live on to cast a slur on age?" Use one other

moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 824) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Thy words, forsooth, are few and all well aimed!” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 824), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

34. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon: “Command your _____; I am not your slave”

    Key: minions

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 816–818. The evidence is “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters. The words “content” and “withal” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

36. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Claim: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou…” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus).

    Sample answer: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. The evidence is “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land,…” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus) — Theseus, lines 956–963. This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	10, 2, 5, 17, 18, 9, 1, 4, 19, 12, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	8, 17, 3, 7, 5, 26, 19, 20, 13, 27, 21, 23, 24, 15, 28, 29	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 9, 11, 10, 8, 18, 19, 21, 20, 13, 23, 24, 22, 15, 30, 31	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 3, 10, 2, 21, 20, 13, 27, 19, 15, 24, 22, 23, 30, 25, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	10, 1, 17, 6, 27, 13, 19, 23, 32, 15, 22, 14, 16, 25, 33, 30	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	10, 6, 2, 13, 19, 20, 21, 15, 23, 22, 14, 24, 30, 29, 28, 16	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
	17, 2, 6, 3, 21, 27, 23, 24, 22, 15, 33, 29, 16, 31, 30, 28	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6

College Sophomore		
College Junior	17, 8, 10, 34, 21, 22, 32, 24, 23, 15, 31, 30, 28, 35, 16, 33	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	2, 10, 34, 21, 23, 14, 22, 15, 24, 16, 30, 31, 25, 28, 29, 33	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	4, 10, 6, 2, 23, 14, 15, 24, 36, 28, 35, 30, 33, 31, 16, 25	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)," how does Sophocles show Creon seizes the daughters? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), how does Sophocles develop the idea of Creon seizes the daughters? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) develops the idea of Creon seizes the daughters. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of Creon seizes the daughters. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) suggests about Creon seizes the daughters. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) to complicate the reader's understanding of Creon seizes the daughters. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Creon seizes the daughters responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Creon seizes the daughters follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) and its treatment of Creon seizes the daughters. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) as evidence for a larger claim about Creon seizes the daughters in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Creon seizes the daughters. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *So those two crutches shall no longer serve thee For further roaming. Since it pleaseth thee To triumph o'er thy country and thy friends Whose mandate, though a prince, I here discharge. Enjoy thy triumph; soon or late thou'lt find Thou art an enemy to thyself, both now And in time past, when in despite of friends Thou gav'st the rein to passion, still thy bane.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)"?

   A. The rescue imagined

   B. The elders' fear

   C. The Colonus ode

   D. Creon seizes the daughters

SAT key: 1. D (Creon seizes the daughters)

Lesson 7: Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)

Focus: the rescue imagined

Objective: Students will analyze how imagery develops in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

Background: The ode names Athenian holy places, such as the shore of the Eleusinian rites, to set the rescue in Athens' own landscape.

Significance: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the rescue imagined.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: acolytes — assistants in religious rites.
Words: acolytes: assistants in religious rites

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The ode names Athenian holy places, such as the shore of the Eleusinian rites, to set the rescue in Athens' own landscape. They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Look closely: The ode names Athenian holy places, such as the shore of the Eleusinian rites, to set the rescue in Athens' own landscape.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders wish they could be where they might see Theseus catch the raiders before they leave the land and rescue the two captive girls. Next, craft. I notice the ode is a wish: the battle exists only as the elders imagine it. The strongest word is "Rescue": the act the elders can only hope for. Then, effect. Why do the elders imagine the rescue instead of seeing it? My answer: The elders imagine the rescue because they must stay at the grove; like the blind Oedipus, they see the battle only with their minds, and the song turns waiting into hope.

> *There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain.* *(Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders wish they could be where they might see Theseus catch the raiders before they leave the land and rescue the two captive girls. Next, craft. I notice the ode is a wish: the battle exists only as the elders imagine it. The strongest word is "Rescue": the act the elders can only hope for. Then, effect. Why do the elders imagine the rescue instead of seeing it? My answer: The elders imagine the rescue because they must stay at the grove; like the blind Oedipus, they see the battle only with their minds, and the song turns waiting into hope.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The ode names Athenian holy places, such as the shore of the Eleusinian rites, to set the rescue in Athens' own landscape. Read closely: "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, To be borne with the speed of the gale, Up and still upwards to sail And gaze on the fray from the clouds above." (Chorus, lines 1134–1137). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: The rescue imagined. (Chorus, lines 1134–1137.)

> *O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above* *(Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The ode names Athenian holy places, such as the shore of the Eleusinian rites, to set the rescue in Athens' own landscape. Read closely: "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, To be borne with the speed of the gale, Up and still upwards to sail And gaze on the fray from the clouds above." (Chorus, lines 1134–1137).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: The rescue imagined. (Chorus, lines 1134–1137.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) develops the idea of the rescue imagined. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. When the text says "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus), it shows this directly. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

Task: Annotate the scene for imagery, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) develops the idea of the rescue imagined. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. When the text says "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus), it shows this directly. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control? Ask: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?

Anchor question: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?

Facilitation: Ask: What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. ("There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the cap", Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the rescue imagined? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. ("There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the cap", Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how imagery shapes the rescue imagined. Key takeaway: the rescue imagined.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.
- **Tone / mood:** The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.
- **Structure:** The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the rescue imagined.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the rescue imagined.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1106–1111.
- "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1134–1137.
- "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus.
Evidence: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus)
Reasoning: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 695–739

695 **Chorus:** Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest,
696 **Chorus:** O stranger worn with toil,
697 **Chorus:** To a land of all lands the goodliest

698 **Chorus:** Colonus' glistening soil.
699 **Chorus:** 'Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale,
700 **Chorus:** Who hid in her bower, among
701 **Chorus:** The wine-dark ivy that wreathes the vale,
702 **Chorus:** Trilleth her ceaseless song;
703 **Chorus:** And she loves, where the clustering berries nod
704 **Chorus:** O'er a sunless, windless glade,
705 **Chorus:** The spot by no mortal footstep trod,
706 **Chorus:** The pleasance kept for the Bacchic god,
707 **Chorus:** Where he holds each night his revels wild
708 **Chorus:** With the nymphs who fostered the lusty child.
709 **Chorus:** And fed each morn by the pearly dew
710 **Chorus:** The starred narcissi shine,
711 **Chorus:** And a wreath with the crocus' golden hue
712 **Chorus:** For the Mother and Daughter twine.
713 **Chorus:** And never the sleepless fountains cease
714 **Chorus:** That feed Cephisus' stream,
715 **Chorus:** But they swell earth's bosom with quick increase,
716 **Chorus:** And their wave hath a crystal gleam.
717 **Chorus:** And the Muses' quire will never disdain
718 **Chorus:** To visit this heaven-favoured plain,
719 **Chorus:** Nor the Cyprian queen of the golden rein.
720 **Chorus:** And here there grows, unpruned, untamed,
721 **Chorus:** Terror to foemen's spear,
722 **Chorus:** A tree in Asian soil unnamed,
723 **Chorus:** By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed,
724 **Chorus:** Self-nurtured year by year;
725 **Chorus:** 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys;
726 **Chorus:** Nor youth nor withering age destroys
727 **Chorus:** The plant that the Olive Planter tends
728 **Chorus:** And the Grey-eyed Goddess herself defends.
729 **Chorus:** Yet another gift, of all gifts the most
730 **Chorus:** Prized by our fatherland, we boast—
731 **Chorus:** The might of the horse, the might of the sea;
732 **Chorus:** Our fame, Poseidon, we owe to thee,
733 **Chorus:** Son of Kronos, our king divine,
734 **Chorus:** Who in these highways first didst fit
735 **Chorus:** For the mouth of horses the iron bit;
736 **Chorus:** Thou too hast taught us to fashion meet
737 **Chorus:** For the arm of the rower the oar-blade fleet,
738 **Chorus:** Swift as the Nereids' hundred feet
739 **Chorus:** As they dance along the brine.

Lines 745–746
745 **Oedipus:** Fear not, it shall be so; if we are old,
746 **Oedipus:** This country's vigour has no touch of age.

Lines 816–818
816 **Oedipus:** Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone,
817 **Oedipus:** And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot,
818 **Oedipus:** He lives not ill who lives withal content.

Line 828
828 **Oedipus:** Thy words, forsooth, are few and all well aimed!

Lines 833–835
833 **Creon:** I protest to these,
834 **Creon:** Not thee, and for thine answer to thy kin,
835 **Creon:** If e'er I take thee—

Line 846
846 **Oedipus:** Ho, friends! ye will not surely play me false?

Lines 846–847
846 **Oedipus:** Ho, friends! ye will not surely play me false?
847 **Oedipus:** Chase this ungodly villain from your land.

Line 876
876 **Antigone:** Ah, woe is me, they drag me hence, O friends.

Lines 883–890
883 **Creon:** So those two crutches shall no longer serve thee
884 **Creon:** For further roaming. Since it pleaseth thee
885 **Creon:** To triumph o'er thy country and thy friends
886 **Creon:** Whose mandate, though a prince, I here discharge,
887 **Creon:** Enjoy thy triumph; soon or late thou'lt find
888 **Creon:** Thou art an enemy to thyself, both now
889 **Creon:** And in time past, when in despite of friends
890 **Creon:** Thou gav'st the rein to passion, still thy bane.

Lines 887–890
887 **Creon:** Enjoy thy triumph; soon or late thou'lt find
888 **Creon:** Thou art an enemy to thyself, both now
889 **Creon:** And in time past, when in despite of friends
890 **Creon:** Thou gav'st the rein to passion, still thy bane.

Line 910
910 **Creon:** Listen, O men of Athens, mark ye this?

Lines 913–914

913 **Creon:** Nothing shall curb my will; though I be old
914 **Creon:** And single-handed, I will have this man.

Lines 922–923

922 **Chorus:** Aye words, but not yet deeds,
923 **Chorus:** Zeus knoweth!

Lines 927–930

927 **Chorus:** Haste ye princes, sound the alarm!
928 **Chorus:** Men of Athens, arm ye, arm!
929 **Chorus:** Quickly to the rescue come
930 **Chorus:** Ere the robbers get them home.

Lines 929–930

929 **Chorus:** Quickly to the rescue come
930 **Chorus:** Ere the robbers get them home.

Lines 983–984

983 **Chorus:** Thy case is perilous; though by birth and race
984 **Chorus:** Thou should'st be just, thou plainly doest wrong.

Lines 1068–1073

1068 **Theseus:** Show us the trail, and I'll attend thee too,
1069 **Theseus:** That, if thou hast the maidens hereabouts,
1070 **Theseus:** Thou mayst thyself discover them to me;
1071 **Theseus:** But if thy guards outstrip us with their spoil,
1072 **Theseus:** We may draw rein; for others speed, from whom
1073 **Theseus:** They will not 'scape to thank the gods at home.

Lines 1068–1084

1068 **Theseus:** Show us the trail, and I'll attend thee too,
1069 **Theseus:** That, if thou hast the maidens hereabouts,
1070 **Theseus:** Thou mayst thyself discover them to me;
1071 **Theseus:** But if thy guards outstrip us with their spoil,
1072 **Theseus:** We may draw rein; for others speed, from whom
1073 **Theseus:** They will not 'scape to thank the gods at home.
1074 **Theseus:** Lead on, I say, the captor's caught, and fate
1075 **Theseus:** Hath ta'en the fowler in the toils he spread;
1076 **Theseus:** So soon are lost gains gotten by deceit.
1077 **Theseus:** And look not for allies; I know indeed
1078 **Theseus:** Such height of insolence was never reached
1079 **Theseus:** Without abettors or accomplices;
1080 **Theseus:** Thou hast some backer in thy bold essay,
1081 **Theseus:** But I will search this matter home and see
1082 **Theseus:** One man doth not prevail against the State.

1083 **Theseus:** Dost take my drift, or seem these words as vain
1084 **Theseus:** As seemed our warnings when the plot was hatched?

Lines 1092–1152

1092 **Chorus:** O when the flying foe,
1093 **Chorus:** Turning at last to bay,
1094 **Chorus:** Soon will give blow for blow.
1095 **Chorus:** Might I behold the fray;
1096 **Chorus:** Hear the loud battle roar,
1097 **Chorus:** Swell, on the Pythian shore,
1098 **Chorus:** Or by the torch-lit bay,
1099 **Chorus:** Where the dread Queen and Maid
1100 **Chorus:** Cherish the mystic rites,
1101 **Chorus:** Rites they to none betray,
1102 **Chorus:** Ere on his lips is laid
1103 **Chorus:** Secrecy's golden key
1104 **Chorus:** By their own acolytes,
1105 **Chorus:** Priestly Eumolpidae.
1106 **Chorus:** There I might chance behold
1107 **Chorus:** Theseus our captain bold
1108 **Chorus:** Meet with the robber band,
1109 **Chorus:** Ere they have fled the land,
1110 **Chorus:** Rescue by might and main
1111 **Chorus:** Maidens, the captives twain.
1112 **Chorus:** Haply on swiftest steed,
1113 **Chorus:** Or in the flying car,
1114 **Chorus:** Now they approach the glen,
1115 **Chorus:** West of white Oea's scaur.
1116 **Chorus:** They will be vanquishèd:
1117 **Chorus:** Dread are our warriors, dread
1118 **Chorus:** Theseus our chieftain's men.
1119 **Chorus:** Flashes each bridle bright,
1120 **Chorus:** Charges each gallant knight,
1121 **Chorus:** All that our Queen adore,
1122 **Chorus:** Pallas their patron, or
1123 **Chorus:** Him whose wide floods enring
1124 **Chorus:** Earth, the great Ocean-king
1125 **Chorus:** Whom Rhea bore.
1126 **Chorus:** Fight they or now prepare
1127 **Chorus:** To fight? a vision rare
1128 **Chorus:** Tells me that soon again
1129 **Chorus:** I shall behold the twain
1130 **Chorus:** Maidens so ill bestead,
1131 **Chorus:** By their kin buffeted.

1132 **Chorus:** Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing
1133 **Chorus:** This day shall victory bring.
1134 **Chorus:** O for the wings, the wings of a dove,
1135 **Chorus:** To be borne with the speed of the gale,
1136 **Chorus:** Up and still upwards to sail
1137 **Chorus:** And gaze on the fray from the clouds above.
1138 **Chorus:** All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven,
1139 **Chorus:** To our guardian host be given
1140 **Chorus:** Might triumphant to surprise
1141 **Chorus:** Flying foes and win their prize.
1142 **Chorus:** Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child
1143 **Chorus:** Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled,
1144 **Chorus:** Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,
1145 **Chorus:** Huntress, sister of Apollo,
1146 **Chorus:** Who the dappled swift-foot deer
1147 **Chorus:** O'er the wooded glade dost follow;
1148 **Chorus:** Help with your two-fold power
1149 **Chorus:** Athens in danger's hour!
1150 **Chorus:** O wayfarer, thou wilt not have to tax
1151 **Chorus:** The friends who watch for thee with false presage,
1152 **Chorus:** For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.

Lines 1106–1111
1106 **Chorus:** There I might chance behold
1107 **Chorus:** Theseus our captain bold
1108 **Chorus:** Meet with the robber band,
1109 **Chorus:** Ere they have fled the land,
1110 **Chorus:** Rescue by might and main
1111 **Chorus:** Maidens, the captives twain.

Lines 1116–1118
1116 **Chorus:** They will be vanquishèd:
1117 **Chorus:** Dread are our warriors, dread
1118 **Chorus:** Theseus our chieftain's men.

Lines 1134–1137
1134 **Chorus:** O for the wings, the wings of a dove,
1135 **Chorus:** To be borne with the speed of the gale,
1136 **Chorus:** Up and still upwards to sail
1137 **Chorus:** And gaze on the fray from the clouds above.

Lines 1142–1149
1142 **Chorus:** Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child
1143 **Chorus:** Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled,
1144 **Chorus:** Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,

Chorus: Huntress, sister of Apollo,
Chorus: Who the dappled swift-foot deer
Chorus: O'er the wooded glade dost follow;
Chorus: Help with your two-fold power
Chorus: Athens in danger's hour!

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
acolytes (noun)	assistants in religious rites	*Secrecy's golden key / By their own acolytes,*	

Discussion questions

1. What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?
2. Where does imagery appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with refuge and hospitality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What bird do the elders wish to be like? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A dove.
2. What do the elders imagine? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The chase and rescue of the daughters
3. What do the elders wish for in lines 1134–1137? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wings to watch the battle from above
4. Whom do the elders picture rescuing the maidens? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Theseus
5. What is the mood of the ode? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Eager and anxious
6. Why is the ode placed here? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: It fills the time while the rescue happens offstage
7. Retell the three most important events of "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

8. Who is on stage in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "Secrecy's golden key / By their own acolytes," What does "acolytes" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: acolytes: assistants in religious rites.

Inferential / analytical

1. How is the ode like Oedipus' blindness? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: The elders must imagine what they cannot see.
2. What does "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" suggest about the rescue imagined? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus.
3. Find one example of imagery in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about the rescue imagined? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1106–1111. On tone / mood: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Strophe 1 O when the flying foe, Turning at last to bay, Soon will give blow for blow.", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.
7. How does "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)" build on "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1134–1137. On structure: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and

Athena for victory. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: "What helps people endure waiting for news they cannot control?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does structure appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with refuge and hospitality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1106–1111. On structure: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the ode make Theseus a hero? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1134–1137. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus.

Useful evidence: “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1106–1111. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the rescue imagined. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: “O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1134–1137. On structure: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: “O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to guilt and intent: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1106–1111. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the imagery in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: “O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1134–1137. On imagery: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)” treats the rescue imagined with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1106–1111. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the rescue imagined? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Useful evidence: "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1134–1137. Theme link: the rescue imagined. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Structure**: how the scene is ordered and why it begins and ends where it does

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Secrecy's golden key / By their own _____," Word bank: acolytes
   Key: acolytes
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why is the ode placed here?
   A. It replaces a messenger
   B. It ends the play
   C. It introduces Teiresias
   D. It fills the time while the rescue happens offstage

   Key: D (It fills the time while the rescue happens offstage)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders wish for in lines 1134–1137?
   A. A sword
   B. Wings to watch the battle from above
   C. A ship

D. A new king

Key: B (Wings to watch the battle from above)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders imagine?

   A. A funeral

   B. A wedding

   C. A trial

   D. The chase and rescue of the daughters

   Key: D (The chase and rescue of the daughters)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus: "O when the _____ foe, / Turning at last to bay"

   Key: flying

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom do the elders picture rescuing the maidens?

   A. Theseus

   B. Polyneices

   C. Ismene

   D. Creon

   Key: A (Theseus)

7. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What bird do the elders wish to be like?

   Sample answer: A dove.

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the mood of the ode?

   A. Bitter

   B. Bored

   C. Eager and anxious

   D. Comic

   Key: C (Eager and anxious)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus: "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still _____ to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above"

   Key: upwards

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus: "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the _____ twain"

    Key: captives

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] How is the ode like Oedipus' blindness?

    Sample answer: The elders must imagine what they cannot see. The evidence is "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1106–1111.

12. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay"

(Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The words "flying" and "last" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)"? The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

    A. Irony

    B. Theme

    C. Plot

    D. Imagery

    Key: D (Imagery)

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The rescue imagined.

    A. Curse and mercy

    B. Guilt and intent

    C. Refuge and hospitality

    D. Law against force

    Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does the ode make Theseus a hero? Defend your view.
    Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 1106–1111. The evidence is "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091) to Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152). Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus, the text reads "Howbeit, I know I waste my words— begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" — Oedipus, lines 816–818. In Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1106–1111. The rescue imagined.

17. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1134–1137. The evidence is "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The words "upwards" and "clouds" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 922–923? "Aye words, but not yet deeds, Zeus _____!"

    A. tongue

    B. daughters

    C. friends

D. knoweth

Key: D (knoweth)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 876? “Ah, woe is me, they drag me hence, O _____.”

A. overthrow

B. understand

C. friends

D. meddle

Key: C (friends)

20. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 929–930 reveal about the character or situation? “Quickly to the rescue come Ere the robbers get them home.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 929–930) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “robbers” and “rescue” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 745–746 reveal about the character or situation? “Fear not, it shall be so; if we are old, This country’s vigour has no touch of age.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 745–746) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “country” and “vigour” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1092–1152 reveal about the character or situation? “Antistrophe 2 All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven, To our guardian host be given Might triumphant to surprise Flying foes and win their prize.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1092–1152) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “triumphant” and “surprise” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)”?

A. The daughters return; a suppliant son

B. The rescue imagined

C. The elders' fear

D. The Colonus ode

Key: B (The rescue imagined)

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 983–984 shapes its tone: “Thy case is perilous; though by birth and race Thou should’st be just, thou plainly doest wrong.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “perilous” and “plainly” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 983–984) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1142–1149? “Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child Of Zeus, Athenè _____, Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear, Huntress, sister of Apollo, Who the dappled swift-foot deer O’er the wooded glade dost follow; Help with your two-fold power Athens in danger’s hour!”

    A. worketh

    B. undefiled

    C. swiftest

    D. gallant

    Key: B (undefiled)

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 1068–1073 shapes its tone: “Show us the trail, and I’ll attend thee too, That, if thou hast the maidens hereabouts, Thou mayst thyself discover them to me; But if thy guards outstrip us with their spoil, We may draw rein; for others speed, from whom They will not…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “hereabouts” and “discover” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 1068–1073) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1116–1118 shapes its tone: “They will be vanquishèd: Dread are our warriors, dread Theseus our chieftain’s men.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “chieftain” and “warriors” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1116–1118) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 910 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Listen, O men of Athens, mark ye this?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 910) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words its wording carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Nothing shall curb my will; though I be old And single-handed, I will have this man.” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 910), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1106–1111. The evidence is “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The words “captives” and “captain” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 846 shapes its tone: “Ho, friends! ye will not surely play me false?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “friends” and “surely” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 846) make the tone heavy and deliberate

rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 887–890 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Enjoy thy triumph; soon or late thou’lt find Thou art an enemy to thyself, both now And in time past, when in despite of friends Thou gav’st the rein to passion, still thy bane.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 887–890) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “despite” and “friends” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “So those two crutches shall no longer serve thee For further roaming.” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 887–890), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

32. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), lines 833–835: “I _____ to these, Not thee, and for thine answer to thy kin, If e’er I take thee—” Word bank: protest, understand, extolled, knoweth

    Key: protest

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), lines 695–739 shapes its tone: “Antistrophe 2 Yet another gift, of all gifts the most Prized by our fatherland, we boast— The might of the horse, the might of the sea” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “fatherland” and “another” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), lines 695–739) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus)

    A. The play's motto: moral values inverted.

    B. His last words begin.

    C. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    D. The sexton's unknowing irony.

    Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 828 shapes its tone: “Thy words, forsooth, are few and all well aimed!” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “forsooth” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), line 828) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Freshman	6, 7, 2, 3, 4, 1, 5, 8, 10, 11, 13, 12, 14, 17, 16, 15	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	18, 19, 1, 7, 5, 2, 20, 21, 11, 22, 23, 24, 12, 14, 16, 15	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	18, 4, 1, 9, 25, 8, 20, 21, 11, 22, 26, 27, 13, 12, 28, 29	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2

HS Senior	4, 8, 2, 5, 10, 20, 21, 22, 11, 24, 30, 26, 14, 31, 16, 15	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 32, 6, 1, 21, 11, 23, 33, 26, 24, 12, 14, 28, 31, 29, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	19, 25, 5, 1, 21, 34, 11, 33, 35, 26, 27, 14, 31, 28, 16, 15	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	32, 3, 10, 4, 11, 22, 24, 35, 30, 13, 27, 14, 28, 31, 16, 15	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 6, synthesis 4
College Junior	18, 10, 9, 4, 3, 33, 26, 35, 30, 24, 14, 27, 28, 31, 16, 15	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 4
College Senior	3, 1, 10, 34, 33, 26, 24, 35, 30, 13, 14, 27, 28, 31, 16, 15	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 8, synthesis 4
Graduate / PhD	3, 9, 5, 4, 33, 30, 26, 35, 13, 14, 27, 28, 31, 29, 16, 15	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 7, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)," how does Sophocles show the rescue imagined? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the rescue imagined? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) develops the idea of the rescue imagined. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of the rescue imagined. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) suggests about the rescue imagined. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses imagery in Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) to complicate the reader's understanding of the rescue imagined. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the rescue

imagined responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the rescue imagined follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) and its treatment of the rescue imagined. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's imagery and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) as evidence for a larger claim about the rescue imagined in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the rescue imagined. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 O when the flying foe, Turning at last to bay, Soon will give blow for blow. Might I behold the fray; Hear the loud battle roar, Swell, on the Pythian shore, Or by the torch-lit bay, Where the dread Queen and Maid Cherish the mystic rites, Rites they to none betray, Ere on his lips is laid Secrecy's golden key By their own acolytes, Priestly Eumolpidae. There I might chance behold Theseus our captain bold Meet with the robber band, Ere they have fled the land, Rescue by might and main Maidens, the captives twain. Antistrophe 1 Haply on swiftest steed, Or in the flying car, Now they approach the glen, West of white Oea's scaur. They will be vanquishèd: Dread are our warriors, dread Theseus our chieftain's men. Flashes each bridle bright, Charges each gallant knight, All that our Queen adore, Pallas their patron, or Him whose wide floods enring Earth, the great Ocean-king Whom Rhea bore. Strophe 2 Fight they or now prepare To fight? a vision rare Tells me that soon again I shall behold the twain Maidens so ill bestead, By their kin buffeted. Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing This day shall victory bring. O for the wings, the wings of a dove, To be borne with the speed of the gale, Up and still upwards to sail And gaze on the fray from the clouds above. Antistrophe 2 All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven, To our guardian host be given Might triumphant to surprise Flying foes and win their prize. Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled, Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear, Huntress, sister of Apollo, Who the dappled swift-foot deer O'er the wooded glade dost follow;*

> *Help with your two-fold power Athens in danger's hour! O wayfarer, thou wilt not have to tax The friends who watch for thee with false presage, For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)"?

A. The rescue imagined

B. The Colonus ode

C. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

D. A prayer for an easy death

SAT key: 1. A (The rescue imagined)

Lesson 8: Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)

Focus: the daughters return; a suppliant son

Objective: Students will analyze how characterization develops in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Teacher only · spoilers

Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Background: A suppliant at an altar was under the god's protection and could not be harmed.

Significance: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: calamity — a disaster causing great distress.
Words: calamity: a disaster causing great distress

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
A suppliant at an altar was under the god's protection and could not be harmed. Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Look closely: A suppliant at an altar was under the god's protection; Antigone becomes the voice of mercy when she asks her father to hear Polyneices (lines 1248–1249).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "They only who have known calamity / Can share it." slowly and put it in my own words: Only people who have suffered disaster can share in his, Oedipus says, as he holds back from touching Theseus. Next, craft. I notice the sentence is short and breaks off in the middle of a line, as if he stops himself. The strongest word is "calamity": disaster. Then, effect. Why does Oedipus refuse the touch of Theseus even while thanking him? My answer: Oedipus refuses the touch of Theseus while thanking him because he will share his calamity only with those who have known it, his daughters, and he spares his rescuer the pollution he believes he carries.

> *They only who have known calamity / Can share it.* *(Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "They only who have known calamity / Can share it." slowly and put it in my own words: Only people who have suffered disaster can share in his, Oedipus says, as he holds back from touching Theseus. Next, craft. I notice the sentence is short and breaks off in the middle of a line, as if he stops himself. The strongest word is "calamity": disaster. Then, effect. Why does Oedipus refuse the touch of Theseus even while thanking him? My answer: Oedipus refuses the touch of Theseus while thanking him because he will share his calamity only with those who have known it, his daughters, and he spares his rescuer the pollution he believes he carries.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A suppliant at an altar was under the god's protection and could not be harmed. Read closely: "A wise man heeds all matters great or small." (Theseus, lines 1210). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: The daughters return; a suppliant son. (Theseus, lines 1210.)

> *A wise man heeds all matters great or small* *(Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: A suppliant at an altar was under the god's protection and could not be harmed. Read closely: "A wise man heeds all matters great or small." (Theseus, lines 1210).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: The daughters return; a suppliant son. (Theseus, lines 1210.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) develops the idea of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. When the text says "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Task: Annotate the scene for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) develops the idea of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. When the text says "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus), it shows this directly. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible? Ask: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?

Anchor question: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?

Facilitation: Ask: Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. ("They only who have known calamity / Can share it", Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. ("They only who have known calamity / Can share it", Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the daughters return; a suppliant son. Key takeaway: the daughters return; a suppliant son.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.
- **Conflict:** Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.
- **Theme:** Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the daughters return; a suppliant son.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1195–1196.
- “A wise man heeds all matters great or small” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus) Theseus, lines 1210.
- “Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son’s most impious outrages” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone) Antigone, lines 1248–1249.
- “Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail, / Of evil passion evil is the end” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone) Antigone, lines 1254–1257.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone.
Evidence: “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus)
Reasoning: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still

polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1106–1111

Chorus: There I might chance behold
Chorus: Theseus our captain bold
Chorus: Meet with the robber band,
Chorus: Ere they have fled the land,
Chorus: Rescue by might and main
Chorus: Maidens, the captives twain.

Lines 1154–1156

Antigone: O father, father,
Antigone: Would that some god might grant thee eyes to see
Antigone: This best of men who brings us back again.

Lines 1169–1174

Oedipus: I have my darlings, and if death should come,
Oedipus: Death were not wholly bitter with you near.
Oedipus: Cling to me, press me close on either side,
Oedipus: There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring.
Oedipus: Now tell me of your ventures, but in brief;
Oedipus: Brief speech suffices for young maids like you.

Lines 1171–1172

Oedipus: Cling to me, press me close on either side,
Oedipus: There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring.

Lines 1175–1176

Antigone: Here is our saviour; thou should'st hear the tale
Antigone: From his own lips; so shall my part be brief.

Lines 1177–1197

Oedipus: I pray thee do not wonder if the sight
Oedipus: Of children, given o'er for lost, has made
Oedipus: My converse somewhat long and tedious.
Oedipus: Full well I know the joy I have of them
Oedipus: Is due to thee, to thee and no man else;
Oedipus: Thou wast their sole deliverer, none else.
Oedipus: The gods deal with thee after my desire,
Oedipus: With thee and with this land! for fear of heaven
Oedipus: I found above all peoples most with you,
Oedipus: And righteousness and lips that cannot lie.
Oedipus: I speak in gratitude of what I know,

1188 **Oedipus:** For all I have I owe to thee alone.
1189 **Oedipus:** Give me thy hand, O Prince, that I may touch it,
1190 **Oedipus:** And if thou wilt permit me, kiss thy cheek.
1191 **Oedipus:** What say I? Can I wish that thou should'st touch
1192 **Oedipus:** One fallen like me to utter wretchedness,
1193 **Oedipus:** Corrupt and tainted with a thousand ills?
1194 **Oedipus:** Oh no, I would not let thee if thou would'st.
1195 **Oedipus:** They only who have known calamity
1196 **Oedipus:** Can share it. Let me greet thee where thou art,
1197 **Oedipus:** And still befriend me as thou hast till now.

Lines 1180–1182
1180 **Oedipus:** Full well I know the joy I have of them
1181 **Oedipus:** Is due to thee, to thee and no man else;
1182 **Oedipus:** Thou wast their sole deliverer, none else.

Lines 1189–1190
1189 **Oedipus:** Give me thy hand, O Prince, that I may touch it,
1190 **Oedipus:** And if thou wilt permit me, kiss thy cheek.

Lines 1195–1196
1195 **Oedipus:** They only who have known calamity
1196 **Oedipus:** Can share it. Let me greet thee where thou art,

Lines 1198–1210
1198 **Theseus:** I marvel not if thou hast dallied long
1199 **Theseus:** In converse with thy children and preferred
1200 **Theseus:** Their speech to mine; I feel no jealousy,
1201 **Theseus:** I would be famous more by deeds than words.
1202 **Theseus:** Of this, old friend, thou hast had proof; my oath
1203 **Theseus:** I have fulfilled and brought thee back the maids
1204 **Theseus:** Alive and nothing harmed for all those threats.
1205 **Theseus:** And how the fight was won, 'twere waste of words
1206 **Theseus:** To boast—thy daughters here will tell thee all.
1207 **Theseus:** But of a matter that has lately chanced
1208 **Theseus:** On my way hitherward, I fain would have
1209 **Theseus:** Thy counsel—slight 'twould seem, yet worthy thought.
1210 **Theseus:** A wise man heeds all matters great or small.

Lines 1207–1209
1207 **Theseus:** But of a matter that has lately chanced
1208 **Theseus:** On my way hitherward, I fain would have
1209 **Theseus:** Thy counsel—slight 'twould seem, yet worthy thought.

Line 1210
1210 **Theseus:** A wise man heeds all matters great or small.

Lines 1211–1212

Oedipus: What is it, son of Aegeus? Let me hear.
Oedipus: Of what thou askest I myself know naught.

Lines 1221–1222

Theseus: He only waits, they say, to speak with thee,
Theseus: And then unharmed to go upon his way.

Lines 1234–1235

Theseus: Thou sure mightest listen. If his suit offend,
Theseus: No need to grant it. Why so loth to hear him?

Lines 1236–1237

Oedipus: That voice, O king, grates on a father's ears;
Oedipus: I have come to loathe it. Force me not to yield.

Lines 1240–1262

Antigone: O heed me, father, though I am young in years.
Antigone: Let the prince have his will and pay withal
Antigone: What in his eyes is service to the god;
Antigone: For our sake also let our brother come.
Antigone: If what he urges tend not to thy good
Antigone: He cannot surely wrest perforce thy will.
Antigone: To hear him then, what harm? By open words
Antigone: A scheme of villainy is soon bewrayed.
Antigone: Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay
Antigone: In kind a son's most impious outrages.
Antigone: O listen to him; other men like thee
Antigone: Have thankless children and are choleric,
Antigone: But yielding to persuasion's gentle spell
Antigone: They let their savage mood be exorcised.
Antigone: Look thou to the past, forget the present, think
Antigone: On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee;
Antigone: Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail,
Antigone: Of evil passion evil is the end.
Antigone: Thou hast, alas, to prick thy memory,
Antigone: Stern monitors, these ever-sightless orbs.
Antigone: O yield to us; just suitors should not need
Antigone: To be importunate, nor he that takes
Antigone: A favour lack the grace to make return.

Lines 1248–1249

Antigone: Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay
Antigone: In kind a son's most impious outrages.

Lines 1250–1253

1250 **Antigone:** O listen to him; other men like thee
1251 **Antigone:** Have thankless children and are choleric,
1252 **Antigone:** But yielding to persuasion's gentle spell
1253 **Antigone:** They let their savage mood be exorcised.

Lines 1254–1257

1254 **Antigone:** Look thou to the past, forget the present, think
1255 **Antigone:** On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee;
1256 **Antigone:** Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail,
1257 **Antigone:** Of evil passion evil is the end.

Lines 1267–1269

1267 **Theseus:** No need, Sir, to appeal a second time.
1268 **Theseus:** It likes me not to boast, but be assured
1269 **Theseus:** Thy life is safe while any god saves mine. Exit Theseus.

Lines 1268–1269

1268 **Theseus:** It likes me not to boast, but be assured
1269 **Theseus:** Thy life is safe while any god saves mine. Exit Theseus.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
calamity (noun)	a disaster causing great distress	*They only who have known calamity Can share it.*	

Discussion questions

1. Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?
2. Where does characterization appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and intent?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who can share calamity, according to Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Only those who have known it.

2. Why will Oedipus not touch Theseus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He believes he is still polluted
3. Who is the suppliant at Poseidon's altar? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Polyneices
4. How does Oedipus first respond? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He refuses to see him
5. Who persuades Oedipus to listen? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Antigone
6. What lesson does Antigone draw from the past? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Evil passion ends in evil
7. Retell the three most important events of "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "They only who have known calamity Can share it." What does "calamity" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: calamity: a disaster causing great distress.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Antigone remind her father of his own past? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: To show where anger leads.
2. What does "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" suggest about the daughters return; a suppliant son? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone.
3. Find one example of characterization in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
4. How does the conflict in this scene shape what we understand about the daughters return; a suppliant son? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. On conflict: Theseus brings the daughters back.

Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “I have my darlings, and if death should come, Death were not wholly bitter with you near.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.
7. How does “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)” build on “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: “A wise man heeds all matters great or small” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus): Theseus, lines 1210. Theme link: the daughters return; a suppliant son. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: “Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son’s most impious outrages” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1248–1249. On characterization: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Can you forgive someone and still hold them responsible?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and intent? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: “Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail, / Of evil passion evil is the end” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1254–1257. On theme: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted.

Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Antigone right that a father cannot repay a son in kind? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. On theme: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: “A wise man heeds all matters great or small” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus): Theseus, lines 1210. On theme: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: “Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son’s most impious outrages” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1248–1249. On characterization: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the daughters return; a suppliant son. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: “Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail, / Of evil passion

evil is the end" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1254–1257. Theme link: the daughters return; a suppliant son. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. On theme: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to curse and mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus): Theseus, lines 1210. On theme: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the characterization in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: "Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1248–1249. On characterization: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)" treats the daughters return; a suppliant son with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: "Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail, / Of evil passion evil is the end" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1254–1257. On theme: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted.

Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. Theme link: the daughters return; a suppliant son. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the daughters return; a suppliant son? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Useful evidence: "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus): Theseus, lines 1210. On theme: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone: "Thou art his father, _____ canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages"
   Key: therefore
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus: "A wise man heeds all _____ great or small"
   Key: matters
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why will Oedipus not touch Theseus?
   A. He cannot find him
   B. Theseus forbids it
   C. He believes he is still polluted
   D. He is angry with him

   Key: C (He believes he is still polluted)

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who is the suppliant at Poseidon's altar?

   A. Eteocles

   B. Creon

   C. Ismene

   D. Polyneices

   Key: D (Polyneices)

5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who persuades Oedipus to listen?

   A. Antigone

   B. Ismene

   C. The Chorus

   D. Creon

   Key: A (Antigone)

6. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who can share calamity, according to Oedipus?
   Sample answer: Only those who have known it.

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus first respond?

   A. He embraces him

   B. He curses Theseus

   C. He refuses to see him

   D. He sends him money

   Key: C (He refuses to see him)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What lesson does Antigone draw from the past?

   A. Evil passion ends in evil

   B. Sons are always wrong

   C. Revenge is sweet

   D. The gods do not care

   Key: A (Evil passion ends in evil)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "They only who have known _____ Can share it." Word bank: calamity
   Key: calamity

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone: "Look thou to the past, forget the _____, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail, / Of evil passion evil is the end"
    Key: present

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Antigone remind her father of his own past?
    Sample answer: To show where anger leads: Antigone, lines 1254–1257. The evidence is "Look thou to the past, forget the present, think / On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee; / Thence wilt thou draw this lesson…" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone).

12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)"? Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing

himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone…

A. Alliteration

B. Diction / vocabulary

C. Characterization

D. Allusion

Key: C (Characterization)

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Antigone, lines 1248–1249. The evidence is "Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son. The words "therefore" and "outrages" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The daughters return; a suppliant son.

    A. Curse and mercy

    B. Law against force

    C. Guilt and intent

    D. Refuge and hospitality

    Key: D (Refuge and hospitality)

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus) supports it: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. But "Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone) complicates it: the line (Antigone, lines 1248–1249) shows the same issue from another side, and its "not" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Theseus, lines 1210. The evidence is "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son. The words "matters" and "small" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus: "They only who have known _____ / Can share it"

    Key: calamity

18. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Theseus, lines 1210. The evidence is "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1211–1212? "Of what thou _____ I myself know naught."

    A. ventures

    B. reverence

    C. askest

    D. should

    Key: C (askest)

20. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1154–1156: "O _____, father, Would that some god might grant thee eyes to see This best of men who brings us back again." Word bank: righteousness, father, askest, permit

    Key: father

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1234–1235: "If his suit _____, No need to grant it." Word bank: ventures, daughters, children, offend

    Key: offend

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)?

    A. "Now tell me of your ventures, but in brief; Brief speech suffices for young maids like you."

    B. "Here is our saviour; thou should'st hear the tale From his own lips; so shall my part be brief."

    C. "Cling to me, press me close on either side, There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring."

    D. "I have my darlings, and if death should come, Death were not wholly bitter with you near."

    Key: D ("I have my darlings, and if death should come, Death were not wholly bitter with you near.")

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1268–1269 reveal about the character or situation? "It likes me not to boast, but be assured Thy life is safe while any god saves mine." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1268–1269) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "assured" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1180–1182 reveal about the character or situation? "Full well I know the joy I have of them Is due to thee, to thee and no man else; Thou wast their sole deliverer, none else." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1180–1182) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "deliverer" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1207–1209 shapes its tone: "But of a matter that has lately chanced On my way hitherward, I fain would have Thy counsel—slight 'twould seem, yet worthy thought." Pick two words and

explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "hitherward" and "counsel" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1207–1209) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1221–1222 shapes its tone: "He only waits, they say, to speak with thee, And then unharmed to go upon his way." Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words "unharmed" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1221–1222) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1250–1253 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: "O listen to him; other men like thee Have thankless children and are choleric, But yielding to persuasion's gentle spell They let their savage mood be exorcised." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1250–1253) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words "persuasion" and "exorcised" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "O yield to us; just suitors should not need To be importunate, nor he that takes A favour lack the grace to make return." (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1250–1253), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1169–1174? "Now tell me of your _____, but in brief; Brief speech suffices for young maids like you."

A. ventures

B. offend

C. askest

D. should

Key: A (ventures)

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1236–1237 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: "That voice, O king, grates on a father's ears; I have come to loathe it." Use one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1236–1237) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words "loathe" and "grates" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "If what he urges tend not to thy good He cannot surely wrest perforce thy will." (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1236–1237), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

30. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1189–1190: "Give me thy hand, O Prince, that I may touch it, And if thou wilt _____ me, kiss thy cheek."

Word bank: preferred, darlings, father, permit

Key: permit

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152) to Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus, the text reads "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…" — Chorus, lines 1106–

1111. In Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. The daughters return; a suppliant son.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1171–1172 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Cling to me, press me close on either side, There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1171–1172) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “wayfaring” and “dreary” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Here is our saviour; thou should’st hear the tale From his own lips; so shall my part be brief.” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1171–1172), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

33. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”?
A. The elders' fear
B. Polyneices and the father's curse
C. The daughters return; a suppliant son
D. The rescue imagined
Key: C (The daughters return; a suppliant son)

34. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. The evidence is “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

35. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Is Antigone right that a father cannot repay a son in kind? Defend your view.
Sample answer: A defended position: Antigone, lines 1248–1249. The evidence is “Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son’s most impious outrages” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. The evidence is “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son. The words “calamity” and “known” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Freshman	6, 10, 3, 17, 8, 1, 7, 5, 4, 2, 18, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1

HS Sophomore	19, 10, 20, 21, 5, 3, 8, 22, 11, 23, 24, 25, 14, 26, 27, 15	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 28, 2, 7, 6, 1, 22, 24, 23, 11, 13, 12, 25, 26, 29, 27	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	3, 10, 30, 1, 22, 24, 11, 18, 23, 12, 25, 14, 26, 31, 32, 29	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	9, 2, 4, 33, 22, 23, 11, 13, 14, 26, 25, 29, 31, 16, 27, 15	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Freshman	2, 30, 5, 34, 22, 11, 23, 26, 12, 14, 25, 13, 29, 31, 32, 15	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	4, 8, 9, 2, 22, 23, 26, 13, 25, 14, 35, 16, 29, 15, 27, 31	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Junior	2, 8, 1, 3, 4, 26, 13, 14, 25, 29, 35, 32, 15, 27, 31, 36	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7
College Senior	19, 2, 1, 22, 14, 12, 26, 13, 25, 27, 31, 29, 36, 32, 16, 35	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	1, 9, 3, 4, 24, 18, 25, 13, 12, 14, 35, 27, 29, 32, 31, 15	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)," how does Sophocles show the daughters return; a suppliant son? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the daughters return; a suppliant son? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) develops the idea of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and conflict shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) suggests about the daughters return; a suppliant son. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's characterization and conflict), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses characterization in Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) to complicate the reader's understanding of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 3 (lines

1153–1269) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the daughters return; a suppliant son responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the daughters return; a suppliant son follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) and its treatment of the daughters return; a suppliant son. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's characterization and conflict, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) as evidence for a larger claim about the daughters return; a suppliant son in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the daughters return; a suppliant son. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *I have my darlings, and if death should come, Death were not wholly bitter with you near. Cling to me, press me close on either side, There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring. Now tell me of your ventures, but in brief; Brief speech suffices for young maids like you.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)"?

   A. A prayer for an easy death

   B. The summons

   C. The daughters return; a suppliant son

   D. Creon seizes the daughters

SAT key: 1. C (The daughters return; a suppliant son)

Lesson 9: Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)

Focus: "Not to be born"

Objective: Students will analyze how theme develops in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: “What does this passage make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

Background: The ode is sung by old men in grief. The rest of the play answers it: Oedipus' end is honoured and peaceful (line 1764).

Significance: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the rest of the play push back against this ode? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: How does the rest of the play push back against this ode?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Not to be born".

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: sedition — speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority; headland — a high point of land jutting into the sea.
Words: sedition: speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority · headland: a high point of land jutting into the sea

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The ode is sung by old men in grief. The rest of the play answers it: Oedipus' end is honoured and peaceful (line 1764). The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Look closely: Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Give the one-line reminder: this is a song of grief from old men, not advice.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way." slowly and put it in my own words: The old men sing in grief that it is best never to be born, and next best to go back quickly the way one came. Next, craft. I notice rhymed, short lines give the bleakest thought in the play the form of a song. The strongest word is "backward": a return to where life began. Then, effect. How does the rest of the play answer the elders' lament? My answer: The rest of the play answers the elders' lament by giving Oedipus an honoured and peaceful end and a last word of love to his daughters (line 1661); the ode is grief, not advice.

> *Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way.* *(Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way." slowly and put it in my own words: The old men sing in grief that it is best never to be born, and next best to go back quickly the way one came. Next, craft. I notice rhymed, short lines give the bleakest thought in the play the form of a song. The strongest word is "backward": a return to where life began. Then, effect. How does the rest of the play answer the elders' lament? My answer: The rest of the play answers the elders' lament by giving Oedipus an honoured and peaceful end and a last word of love to his daughters (line 1661); the ode is grief, not advice.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The ode is sung by old men in grief. The rest of the play answers it: Oedipus' end is honoured and peaceful (line 1764). Read closely: "Such ills not I alone, He too our guest hath known, E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, So is he buffeted on every side By drear misfortune's whelming tide, By every wind of heaven o'erborne Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, Some from the noonday glow." (Chorus, lines 1298–1306). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: "Not to be born". (Chorus, lines 1298–1306.)

> *Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The ode is sung by old men in grief. The rest of the play answers it: Oedipus' end is honoured and peaceful (line 1764). Read closely: "Such ills not I alone, He too our guest hath known, E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, So is he buffeted on every side By drear misfortune's whelming tide, By every wind of heaven o'erborne Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, Some from the noonday glow." (Chorus, lines 1298–1306).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: "Not to be born". (Chorus, lines 1298–1306.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) develops the idea of "Not to be born". Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. When the text says "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus), it shows this directly. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

Task: Annotate the scene for theme, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) develops the idea of "Not to be born". Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. When the text says "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus), it shows this directly. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does the rest of the play push back against this ode? Ask: How does the rest of the play push back against this ode?

Anchor question: How does the rest of the play push back against this ode?

Facilitation: Ask: How does the rest of the play push back against this ode?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. ("Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he", Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about "Not to be born"? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. ("Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he", Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how theme shapes "Not to be born". Key takeaway: "Not to be born".

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Theme:** The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.
- **Imagery:** The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.
- **Tone / mood:** The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** "Not to be born".

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: "Not to be born".

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1284–1287.

- "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1298–1306.
- "Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair.
Evidence: "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, / Some from the noonday glow" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus)
Reasoning: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1092–1152

1092 **Chorus:** O when the flying foe,
1093 **Chorus:** Turning at last to bay,
1094 **Chorus:** Soon will give blow for blow.
1095 **Chorus:** Might I behold the fray;
1096 **Chorus:** Hear the loud battle roar,
1097 **Chorus:** Swell, on the Pythian shore,
1098 **Chorus:** Or by the torch-lit bay,
1099 **Chorus:** Where the dread Queen and Maid
1100 **Chorus:** Cherish the mystic rites,
1101 **Chorus:** Rites they to none betray,
1102 **Chorus:** Ere on his lips is laid
1103 **Chorus:** Secrecy's golden key
1104 **Chorus:** By their own acolytes,
1105 **Chorus:** Priestly Eumolpidae.
1106 **Chorus:** There I might chance behold
1107 **Chorus:** Theseus our captain bold
1108 **Chorus:** Meet with the robber band,
1109 **Chorus:** Ere they have fled the land,
1110 **Chorus:** Rescue by might and main
1111 **Chorus:** Maidens, the captives twain.
1112 **Chorus:** Haply on swiftest steed,
1113 **Chorus:** Or in the flying car,
1114 **Chorus:** Now they approach the glen,
1115 **Chorus:** West of white Oea's scaur.

1116 **Chorus:** They will be vanquishèd:
1117 **Chorus:** Dread are our warriors, dread
1118 **Chorus:** Theseus our chieftain's men.
1119 **Chorus:** Flashes each bridle bright,
1120 **Chorus:** Charges each gallant knight,
1121 **Chorus:** All that our Queen adore,
1122 **Chorus:** Pallas their patron, or
1123 **Chorus:** Him whose wide floods enring
1124 **Chorus:** Earth, the great Ocean-king
1125 **Chorus:** Whom Rhea bore.
1126 **Chorus:** Fight they or now prepare
1127 **Chorus:** To fight? a vision rare
1128 **Chorus:** Tells me that soon again
1129 **Chorus:** I shall behold the twain
1130 **Chorus:** Maidens so ill bestead,
1131 **Chorus:** By their kin buffeted.
1132 **Chorus:** Today, today Zeus worketh some great thing
1133 **Chorus:** This day shall victory bring.
1134 **Chorus:** O for the wings, the wings of a dove,
1135 **Chorus:** To be borne with the speed of the gale,
1136 **Chorus:** Up and still upwards to sail
1137 **Chorus:** And gaze on the fray from the clouds above.
1138 **Chorus:** All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven,
1139 **Chorus:** To our guardian host be given
1140 **Chorus:** Might triumphant to surprise
1141 **Chorus:** Flying foes and win their prize.
1142 **Chorus:** Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child
1143 **Chorus:** Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled,
1144 **Chorus:** Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,
1145 **Chorus:** Huntress, sister of Apollo,
1146 **Chorus:** Who the dappled swift-foot deer
1147 **Chorus:** O'er the wooded glade dost follow;
1148 **Chorus:** Help with your two-fold power
1149 **Chorus:** Athens in danger's hour!
1150 **Chorus:** O wayfarer, thou wilt not have to tax
1151 **Chorus:** The friends who watch for thee with false presage,
1152 **Chorus:** For lo, an escort with the maids draws near.

Lines 1116–1118

1116 **Chorus:** They will be vanquishèd:
1117 **Chorus:** Dread are our warriors, dread
1118 **Chorus:** Theseus our chieftain's men.

Lines 1142–1149

1142 **Chorus:** Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child
1143 **Chorus:** Of Zeus, Athenè undefiled,
1144 **Chorus:** Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear,
1145 **Chorus:** Huntress, sister of Apollo,
1146 **Chorus:** Who the dappled swift-foot deer
1147 **Chorus:** O'er the wooded glade dost follow;
1148 **Chorus:** Help with your two-fold power
1149 **Chorus:** Athens in danger's hour!

Line 1162

1162 **Antigone:** Thou askest what is doubly sweet to give.

Lines 1169–1174

1169 **Oedipus:** I have my darlings, and if death should come,
1170 **Oedipus:** Death were not wholly bitter with you near.
1171 **Oedipus:** Cling to me, press me close on either side,
1172 **Oedipus:** There rest ye from your dreary wayfaring.
1173 **Oedipus:** Now tell me of your ventures, but in brief;
1174 **Oedipus:** Brief speech suffices for young maids like you.

Lines 1177–1197

1177 **Oedipus:** I pray thee do not wonder if the sight
1178 **Oedipus:** Of children, given o'er for lost, has made
1179 **Oedipus:** My converse somewhat long and tedious.
1180 **Oedipus:** Full well I know the joy I have of them
1181 **Oedipus:** Is due to thee, to thee and no man else;
1182 **Oedipus:** Thou wast their sole deliverer, none else.
1183 **Oedipus:** The gods deal with thee after my desire,
1184 **Oedipus:** With thee and with this land! for fear of heaven
1185 **Oedipus:** I found above all peoples most with you,
1186 **Oedipus:** And righteousness and lips that cannot lie.
1187 **Oedipus:** I speak in gratitude of what I know,
1188 **Oedipus:** For all I have I owe to thee alone.
1189 **Oedipus:** Give me thy hand, O Prince, that I may touch it,
1190 **Oedipus:** And if thou wilt permit me, kiss thy cheek.
1191 **Oedipus:** What say I? Can I wish that thou should'st touch
1192 **Oedipus:** One fallen like me to utter wretchedness,
1193 **Oedipus:** Corrupt and tainted with a thousand ills?
1194 **Oedipus:** Oh no, I would not let thee if thou would'st.
1195 **Oedipus:** They only who have known calamity
1196 **Oedipus:** Can share it. Let me greet thee where thou art,
1197 **Oedipus:** And still befriend me as thou hast till now.

Lines 1183–1186

1183 **Oedipus:** The gods deal with thee after my desire,
1184 **Oedipus:** With thee and with this land! for fear of heaven
1185 **Oedipus:** I found above all peoples most with you,
1186 **Oedipus:** And righteousness and lips that cannot lie.

Lines 1191–1193

1191 **Oedipus:** What say I? Can I wish that thou should'st touch
1192 **Oedipus:** One fallen like me to utter wretchedness,
1193 **Oedipus:** Corrupt and tainted with a thousand ills?

Lines 1195–1196

1195 **Oedipus:** They only who have known calamity
1196 **Oedipus:** Can share it. Let me greet thee where thou art,

Lines 1196–1197

1196 **Oedipus:** Can share it. Let me greet thee where thou art,
1197 **Oedipus:** And still befriend me as thou hast till now.

Lines 1198–1210

1198 **Theseus:** I marvel not if thou hast dallied long
1199 **Theseus:** In converse with thy children and preferred
1200 **Theseus:** Their speech to mine; I feel no jealousy,
1201 **Theseus:** I would be famous more by deeds than words.
1202 **Theseus:** Of this, old friend, thou hast had proof; my oath
1203 **Theseus:** I have fulfilled and brought thee back the maids
1204 **Theseus:** Alive and nothing harmed for all those threats.
1205 **Theseus:** And how the fight was won, 'twere waste of words
1206 **Theseus:** To boast—thy daughters here will tell thee all.
1207 **Theseus:** But of a matter that has lately chanced
1208 **Theseus:** On my way hitherward, I fain would have
1209 **Theseus:** Thy counsel—slight 'twould seem, yet worthy thought.
1210 **Theseus:** A wise man heeds all matters great or small.

Lines 1205–1206

1205 **Theseus:** And how the fight was won, 'twere waste of words
1206 **Theseus:** To boast—thy daughters here will tell thee all.

Line 1217

1217 **Oedipus:** What is his country? what the suitor's prayer?

Line 1231

1231 **Theseus:** Who can he be that I should frown on him?

Lines 1232–1233

1232 **Oedipus:** My son, O king, my hateful son, whose words
1233 **Oedipus:** Of all men's most would jar upon my ears.

Line 1240

1240 **Antigone:** O heed me, father, though I am young in years.

Lines 1240–1262

1240 **Antigone:** O heed me, father, though I am young in years.
1241 **Antigone:** Let the prince have his will and pay withal
1242 **Antigone:** What in his eyes is service to the god;
1243 **Antigone:** For our sake also let our brother come.
1244 **Antigone:** If what he urges tend not to thy good
1245 **Antigone:** He cannot surely wrest perforce thy will.
1246 **Antigone:** To hear him then, what harm? By open words
1247 **Antigone:** A scheme of villainy is soon bewrayed.
1248 **Antigone:** Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay
1249 **Antigone:** In kind a son's most impious outrages.
1250 **Antigone:** O listen to him; other men like thee
1251 **Antigone:** Have thankless children and are choleric,
1252 **Antigone:** But yielding to persuasion's gentle spell
1253 **Antigone:** They let their savage mood be exorcised.
1254 **Antigone:** Look thou to the past, forget the present, think
1255 **Antigone:** On all the woe thy sire and mother brought thee;
1256 **Antigone:** Thence wilt thou draw this lesson without fail,
1257 **Antigone:** Of evil passion evil is the end.
1258 **Antigone:** Thou hast, alas, to prick thy memory,
1259 **Antigone:** Stern monitors, these ever-sightless orbs.
1260 **Antigone:** O yield to us; just suitors should not need
1261 **Antigone:** To be importunate, nor he that takes
1262 **Antigone:** A favour lack the grace to make return.

Lines 1263–1266

1263 **Oedipus:** Grievous to me, my child, the boon ye win
1264 **Oedipus:** By pleading. Let it be then; have your way
1265 **Oedipus:** Only if come he must, I beg thee, friend,
1266 **Oedipus:** Let none have power to dispose of me.

Lines 1264–1266

1264 **Oedipus:** By pleading. Let it be then; have your way
1265 **Oedipus:** Only if come he must, I beg thee, friend,
1266 **Oedipus:** Let none have power to dispose of me.

Lines 1267–1269

1267 **Theseus:** No need, Sir, to appeal a second time.

1268 **Theseus:** It likes me not to boast, but be assured
1269 **Theseus:** Thy life is safe while any god saves mine. Exit Theseus.

Lines 1284–1287
1284 **Chorus:** Not to be born at all
1285 **Chorus:** Is best, far best that can befall,
1286 **Chorus:** Next best, when born, with least delay
1287 **Chorus:** To trace the backward way.

Lines 1298–1306
1298 **Chorus:** Such ills not I alone,
1299 **Chorus:** He too our guest hath known,
1300 **Chorus:** E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,
1301 **Chorus:** Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar,
1302 **Chorus:** So is he buffeted on every side
1303 **Chorus:** By drear misfortune's whelming tide,
1304 **Chorus:** By every wind of heaven o'erborne
1305 **Chorus:** Some from the sunset, some from orient morn,
1306 **Chorus:** Some from the noonday glow.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
sedition (noun)	speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority	*Envy, sedition, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life.*	
headland (noun)	a high point of land jutting into the sea	*He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,*	

Discussion questions

1. How does the rest of the play push back against this ode?
2. Where does theme appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with curse and mercy?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. From which directions do the winds strike the headland? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: From every side: sunset, morning, noon and the north.
2. Who sings this ode? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The elders of Colonus
3. To what is Oedipus compared? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A headland battered by storms
4. What stage of life does the ode call the worst? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Old age
5. According to the lesson, how should the ode be read? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: As a song of grief from old men, open to debate against the ending
6. Which troubles does the ode list? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war
7. Retell the three most important events of “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.
8. Who is on stage in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: “Envy, sedition, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life.” What does “sedition” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: sedition: speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why compare Oedipus to a headland rather than a ship? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: He stands fixed and endures; he is battered but not sunk.
2. What does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” suggest about "Not to be born"? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair.
3. Find one example of theme in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

4. How does the imagery in this scene shape what we understand about "Not to be born"? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1284–1287. On imagery: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Strophe Who craves excess of days, Scorning the common span Of life, I judge that man A giddy wight who walks in folly’s ways.”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.
7. How does “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” build on “Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfo” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1298–1306. Theme link: "Not to be born". Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: "Not to be born". Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How does the rest of the play push back against this ode?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with curse and mercy? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Not to be born at all / Is best, far

best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1284–1287. On tone / mood: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Open question: does the play agree with this ode? Defend any position with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Any defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfo" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1298–1306. On theme: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: "Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1284–1287. Theme link: "Not to be born". Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of "Not to be born". [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfo" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus):

Chorus, lines 1298–1306. Theme link: "Not to be born". Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to law against force: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1284–1287. On theme: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the theme in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfo” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1298–1306. On theme: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Compare how “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)” treats "Not to be born" with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the

class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1284–1287. Theme link: "Not to be born". Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about "Not to be born"? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Useful evidence: “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfo” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1298–1306. On theme: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1142–1149? “Hear us, Zeus, and hear us, child Of Zeus, Athenè _____, Hear, Apollo, hunter, hear, Huntress, sister of Apollo, Who the dappled swift-foot deer O’er the wooded glade dost follow; Help with your two-fold power Athens in danger’s hour!”

    A. worketh

    B. undefiled

    C. swiftest

    D. gallant

    Key: B (undefiled)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1183–1186? “The gods deal with thee after my desire, With thee and with this land! for fear of heaven I found above all peoples most with you, And _____ and lips that cannot lie.”

    A. permit

    B. children

    C. righteousness

    D. darlings

Key: C (righteousness)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1169–1174: "I have my _____, and if death should come, Death were not wholly bitter with you near." Word bank: ventures, reverence, father, darlings

   Key: darlings

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1205–1206: "And how the fight was won, 'twere waste of words To boast—thy _____ here will tell thee all." Word bank: askest, daughters, preferred, implores

   Key: daughters

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus: "Who _____ excess of days, / Scorning the common span"

   Key: craves

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the lesson, how should the ode be read?

   A. As a prophecy

   B. As a joke

   C. As a song of grief from old men, open to debate against the ending

   D. As advice for living

   Key: C (As a song of grief from old men, open to debate against the ending)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus: "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the _____ way"

   Key: backward

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Envy, _____, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life." Word bank: headland, sedition

   Key: sedition

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] From which directions do the winds strike the headland?

   Sample answer: From every side: sunset, morning, noon and the north.

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1092–1152 reveal about the character or situation? "Antistrophe 2 All-seeing Zeus, O lord of heaven, To our guardian host be given Might triumphant to surprise Flying foes and win their prize." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1092–1152) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "triumphant" and "surprise" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)?

    A. "O father, father, Would that some god might grant thee eyes to see This best of men who brings us back again."

    B. "Come to your father's arms, O let me feel A child's embrace I never hoped for more."

    C. "Yes, saved By Theseus and his gallant followers."

    D. "Thou askest what is doubly sweet to give."

    Key: A ("O father, father, Would that some god might grant thee eyes to see This best of men who brings us back again.")

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), line 1217 reveal about the character or situation? “What is his country? what the suitor’s prayer?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), line 1217) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “country” and “suitor” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why compare Oedipus to a headland rather than a ship?
    Sample answer: He stands fixed and endures; he is battered but not sunk. The evidence is “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1298–1306.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1116–1118 shapes its tone: “They will be vanquishèd: Dread are our warriors, dread Theseus our chieftain’s men.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “chieftain” and “warriors” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1116–1118) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The words “craves” and “common” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Open question: does the play agree with this ode? Defend any position with evidence.
    Sample answer: Any defended position: Chorus, lines 1284–1287. The evidence is “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), lines 1092–1152: “Antistrophe 1 Haply on _____ steed, Or in the flying car, Now they approach the glen, West of white Oea’s scaur.” Word bank: worketh, swiftest, undefiled, gallant
    Key: swiftest
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which troubles does the ode list?
    A. Love and marriage
    B. Envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war
    C. Feasts and dances
    D. Wealth and fame

    Key: B (Envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war)
19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what is Oedipus compared?
    A. A hunted bull
    B. A tree in flood
    C. A ship at harbour

D. A headland battered by storms

Key: D (A headland battered by storms)

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), line 1240 shapes its tone: “O heed me, father, though I am young in years.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “though” and “father” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), line 1240) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
21. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1232–1233 shapes its tone: “My son, O king, my hateful son, whose words Of all men’s most would jar upon my ears.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “hateful” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1232–1233) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
22. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? ‘Not to be born’.
    A. Refuge and hospitality
    B. Guilt and intent
    C. Law against force
    D. Curse and mercy

    Key: A (Refuge and hospitality)
23. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1191–1193 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Can I wish that thou should’st touch One fallen like me to utter wretchedness, Corrupt and tainted with a thousand ills?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1191–1193) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “wretchedness” and “thousand” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Full well I know the joy I have of them Is due to thee, to thee and no man else; Thou wast their sole deliverer, none…” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1191–1193), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.
24. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus: “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear _____’s whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o’erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient…”
    Key: misfortune
25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What stage of life does the ode call the worst?
    A. Childhood
    B. Old age
    C. Youth
    D. Marriage

    Key: B (Old age)

26. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)"?

    A. The Colonus ode

    B. Polyneices and the father's curse

    C. The elders' fear

    D. "Not to be born"

    Key: D ("Not to be born")

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), line 1162 shapes its tone: "Thou askest what is doubly sweet to give." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "doubly" and "askest" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), line 1162) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1196–1197 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: "Let me greet thee where thou art, And still befriend me as thou hast till now." Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1196–1197) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words "befriend" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "But of a matter that has lately chanced On my way hitherward, I fain would have Thy counsel—slight 'twould seem, yet…" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1196–1197), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Who sings this ode?

    A. Oedipus

    B. Theseus

    C. The elders of Colonus

    D. Antigone

    Key: C (The elders of Colonus)

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) to Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus, the text reads "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" — Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. In Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1284–1287. "Not to be born".

31. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), line 1231? "Who can he be that I _____ frown on him?"

    A. father

    B. implores

    C. should

    D. askest

    Key: C (should)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1264–1266 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Let it be then; have your way Only if come he must, I beg thee, friend, Let none have power to dispose of me.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1264–1266) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “dispose” and “friend” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “It likes me not to boast, but be assured Thy life is safe while any god saves mine.” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), lines 1264–1266), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune’s whelming tide, / By every wind…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus).

    Sample answer: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. The evidence is “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1298–1306. This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born".

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore,”, what does “headland” most nearly mean?

    A. a disaster causing great distress

    B. speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority

    C. able to be touched or felt

    D. a high point of land jutting into the sea

    Key: D (a high point of land jutting into the sea)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What does this passage most clearly show? “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus)

    A. His new compassion for ordinary people.

    B. The letter's failure as a punishment.

    C. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    D. The prison as an image.

    Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some _____ on an iron-bound shore,” Word bank: sedition, headland

    Key: headland

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune’s whelming tide, / By every wind…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1298–1306. The evidence is “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This

develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The words “misfortune” and “headland” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1284–1287. The evidence is “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The words “backward” and “befall” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

39. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”? The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

    A. Characterization

    B. Imagery

    C. Alliteration

    D. Irony

    Key: B (Imagery)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 17, 2, 4, 18, 9, 19, 5, 10, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	2, 4, 24, 25, 19, 6, 10, 11, 12, 26, 13, 14, 27, 22, 28, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	2, 24, 29, 6, 8, 19, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 20, 27, 15, 23, 30	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	31, 3, 4, 29, 6, 10, 12, 11, 13, 14, 20, 21, 15, 23, 32, 16	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	3, 6, 19, 8, 11, 12, 13, 14, 27, 20, 33, 22, 32, 28, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	18, 34, 7, 8, 12, 35, 13, 14, 21, 27, 20, 22, 28, 23, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	18, 8, 36, 12, 26, 35, 14, 27, 21, 20, 22, 28, 23, 32, 30, 16	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	31, 25, 8, 36, 11, 14, 21, 20, 27, 22, 15, 28, 32, 23, 30, 16	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Senior		

	8, 36, 29, 19, 26, 27, 21, 20, 22, 23, 32, 28, 37, 38, 16, 30	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	6, 8, 24, 10, 11, 20, 27, 21, 22, 39, 32, 28, 23, 38, 16, 30	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307),” how does Sophocles show "Not to be born"? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), how does Sophocles develop the idea of "Not to be born"? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) develops the idea of "Not to be born". Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of "Not to be born". Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) suggests about "Not to be born". Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's theme and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses theme in Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) to complicate the reader's understanding of "Not to be born". Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of "Not to be born" responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of "Not to be

born" follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) and its treatment of "Not to be born". State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's theme and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) as evidence for a larger claim about "Not to be born" in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of "Not to be born". Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe Who craves excess of days, Scorning the common span Of life, I judge that man A giddy wight who walks in folly's ways. For the long years heap up a grievous load, Scant pleasures, heavier pains, Till not one joy remains For him who lingers on life's weary road And come it slow or fast, One doom of fate Doth all await, For dance and marriage bell, The dirge and funeral knell. Death the deliverer freeth all at last. Antistrophe Not to be born at all Is best, far best that can befall, Next best, when born, with least delay To trace the backward way. For when youth passes with its giddy train, Troubles on troubles follow, toils on toils, Pain, pain for ever pain; And none escapes life's coils. Envy, sedition, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life. Last comes the worst and most abhorred stage Of unregarded age, Joyless, companionless and slow, Of woes the crowning woe. Epode Such ills not I alone, He too our guest hath known, E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, So is he buffeted on every side By drear misfortune's whelming tide, By every wind of heaven o'erborne Some from the sunset, some from orient morn, Some from the noonday glow. Some from Rhipean gloom of everlasting snow.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)"?

   A. "Not to be born"

   B. The rescue imagined

   C. The elders' fear

   D. Polyneices and the father's curse

SAT key: 1. A ("Not to be born")

Lesson 10: Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)

Focus: Polyneices and the father's curse

Objective: Students will analyze how conflict develops in “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)” by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1

Content note (mature themes): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently.
Student preview: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Suggested language: “What does this passage make us notice?”

Teacher only · spoilers

Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

Background: Oedipus' praise of his daughters as "men / Not women" (lines 1419–1420) reflects the gender stereotypes of his time; teach them as such.

Significance: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because.... Content note before we start: This section deals with mature themes in the play.
Prompt: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Polyneices and the father's curse.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
Two key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: unkempt — uncombed and untidy. mishaps — bad accidents or setbacks.
Words: unkempt: uncombed and untidy · mishaps: bad accidents or setbacks

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Oedipus' praise of his daughters as "men / Not women" (lines 1419–1420) reflects the gender stereotypes of his time; teach them as such. The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Look closely: Teacher erratum note: the Standard Ebooks text misprints line 1325 as this throne; the app text now reads his throne, as in Storr's 1912 edition.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise." slowly and put it in my own words: Polyneices says that as Zeus shares his throne with Mercy in everything he does, his father should let Mercy rule in his heart too. Next, craft. I notice mercy is personified as a queen beside Zeus, and the son flatters his father by comparing him to the king of the gods. The strongest word is "Mercy": the quality Polyneices asks for and never showed. Then, effect. Why does Polyneices appeal to Mercy, and why does the appeal fail? My answer: Polyneices appeals to Mercy because he has no defence for driving his father out; the appeal fails because he asks for mercy only when he needs help for his war, and Oedipus answers with a curse.

> *But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise.* *(Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise." slowly and put it in my own words: Polyneices says that as Zeus shares his throne with Mercy in everything he does, his father should let Mercy rule in his heart too. Next, craft. I notice mercy is personified as a queen beside Zeus, and the son flatters his father by comparing him to the king of the gods. The strongest word is "Mercy": the quality Polyneices asks for and never showed. Then, effect. Why does Polyneices appeal to Mercy, and why does the appeal fail? My answer: Polyneices appeals to Mercy because he has no defence for driving his father out; the appeal fails because he asks for mercy only when he needs help for his war, and Oedipus answers with a curse.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Oedipus' praise of his daughters as "men / Not women" (lines 1419–1420) reflects the gender stereotypes of his time; teach them as such. Read closely: "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men Not women in true service to their sire; But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine." (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: Polyneices and the father's curse. (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421.)

> *They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine* (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Oedipus' praise of his daughters as "men / Not women" (lines 1419–1420) reflects the gender stereotypes of his time; teach them as such. Read closely: "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men Not women in true service to their sire; But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine." (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: Polyneices and the father's curse. (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) develops the idea of Polyneices and the father's curse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. When the text says "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices), it shows this directly. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.
Task: Annotate the scene for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) develops the idea of Polyneices and the father's curse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. When the text says "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices), it shows this directly. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail? Ask: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?
Anchor question: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?
Facilitation: Ask: Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. ("But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise", Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. ("But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise", Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes Polyneices and the father's curse. Key takeaway: Polyneices and the father's curse.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.
- **Characterization:** Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.
- **Foreshadowing:** Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** Polyneices and the father's curse.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: Polyneices and the father's curse.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) Polyneices, lines 1324–1327.
- "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1419–1421.
- "I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) Polyneices, lines 1479–1480.
- "Misguided youth, thy purpose then stands fast" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Antigone) Antigone, lines 1481.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone.
Evidence: "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices)
Reasoning: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1284–1287
1284 **Chorus:** Not to be born at all
1285 **Chorus:** Is best, far best that can befall,
1286 **Chorus:** Next best, when born, with least delay
1287 **Chorus:** To trace the backward way.

Lines 1308–1309
1308 **Antigone:** Father, methinks I see the stranger coming,
1309 **Antigone:** Alone he comes and weeping plenteous tears.

Lines 1313–1335
1313 **Polyneices:** Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament
1314 **Polyneices:** My own afflictions, or my aged sire's,
1315 **Polyneices:** Whom here I find a castaway, with you,
1316 **Polyneices:** In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad
1317 **Polyneices:** In antic tatters, marring all his frame,
1318 **Polyneices:** While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks
1319 **Polyneices:** Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match,
1320 **Polyneices:** He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch.
1321 **Polyneices:** All this too late I learn, wretch that I am,

1322 **Polyneices:** Alas! I own it, and am proved most vile
1323 **Polyneices:** In my neglect of thee: I scorn myself.
1324 **Polyneices:** But as almighty Zeus in all he doth
1325 **Polyneices:** Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne,
1326 **Polyneices:** Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned
1327 **Polyneices:** In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past
1328 **Polyneices:** May be amended, cannot be made worse.
1329 **Polyneices:** Why silent? Father, speak, nor turn away,
1330 **Polyneices:** Hast thou no word, wilt thou dismiss me then
1331 **Polyneices:** In mute disdain, nor tell me why thou art wrath?
1332 **Polyneices:** O ye his daughters, sisters mine, do ye
1333 **Polyneices:** This sullen, obstinate silence try to move.
1334 **Polyneices:** Let him not spurn, without a single word
1335 **Polyneices:** Of answer, me the suppliant of the god.

Line 1321
1321 **Polyneices:** All this too late I learn, wretch that I am,

Lines 1324–1327
1324 **Polyneices:** But as almighty Zeus in all he doth
1325 **Polyneices:** Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne,
1326 **Polyneices:** Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned
1327 **Polyneices:** In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past

Line 1325
1325 **Polyneices:** Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne,

Lines 1334–1335
1334 **Polyneices:** Let him not spurn, without a single word
1335 **Polyneices:** Of answer, me the suppliant of the god.

Lines 1336–1339
1336 **Antigone:** Tell him thyself, unhappy one, thine errand;
1337 **Antigone:** For large discourse may send a thrill of joy,
1338 **Antigone:** Or stir a chord of wrath or tenderness,
1339 **Antigone:** And to the tongue-tied somehow give a tongue.

Lines 1340–1398
1340 **Polyneices:** Well dost thou counsel, and I will speak out.
1341 **Polyneices:** First will I call in aid the god himself,
1342 **Polyneices:** Poseidon, from whose altar I was raised,
1343 **Polyneices:** With warrant from the monarch of this land,
1344 **Polyneices:** To parley with you, and depart unscathed.
1345 **Polyneices:** These pledges, strangers, I would see observed
1346 **Polyneices:** By you and by my sisters and my sire.
1347 **Polyneices:** Now, father, let me tell thee why I came.

Polyneices: I have been banished from my native land
Polyneices: Because by right of primogeniture
Polyneices: I claimed possession of thy sovereign throne
Polyneices: Wherefrom Eteocles, my younger brother,
Polyneices: Ousted me, not by weight of precedent,
Polyneices: Nor by the last arbitrament of war,
Polyneices: But by his popular acts; and the prime cause
Polyneices: Of this I deem the curse that rests on thee.
Polyneices: So likewise hold the soothsayers, for when
Polyneices: I came to Argos in the Dorian land
Polyneices: And took the king Adrastus' child to wife,
Polyneices: Under my standard I enlisted all
Polyneices: The foremost captains of the Apian isle,
Polyneices: To levy with their aid that sevenfold host
Polyneices: Of spearmen against Thebes, determining
Polyneices: To oust my foes or die in a just cause.
Polyneices: Why then, thou askest, am I here today?
Polyneices: Father, I come a suppliant to thee
Polyneices: Both for myself and my allies who now
Polyneices: With squadrons seven beneath their seven spears
Polyneices: Beleaguer all the plain that circles Thebes.
Polyneices: Foremost the peerless warrior, peerless seer,
Polyneices: Amphiaraüs with his lightning lance;
Polyneices: Next an Aetolian, Tydeus, Oeneus' son;
Polyneices: Eteoclus of Argive birth the third;
Polyneices: The fourth Hippomedon, sent to the war
Polyneices: By his sire Talaos; Capaneus, the fifth,
Polyneices: Vaunts he will fire and raze the town; the sixth
Polyneices: Parthenopaeus, an Arcadian born
Polyneices: Named of that maid, longtime a maid and late
Polyneices: Espoused, Atalanta's true-born child;
Polyneices: Last I thy son, or thine at least in name,
Polyneices: If but the bastard of an evil fate,
Polyneices: Lead against Thebes the fearless Argive host.
Polyneices: Thus by thy children and thy life, my sire,
Polyneices: We all adjure thee to remit thy wrath
Polyneices: And favour one who seeks a just revenge
Polyneices: Against a brother who has banned and robbed him.
Polyneices: For victory, if oracles speak true,
Polyneices: Will fall to those who have thee for ally.
Polyneices: So, by our fountains and familiar gods
Polyneices: I pray thee, yield and hear; a beggar I
Polyneices: And exile, thou an exile likewise; both
Polyneices: Involved in one misfortune find a home

1392 **Polyneices:** As pensioners, while he, the lord of Thebes,
1393 **Polyneices:** O agony! makes mock of thee and me.
1394 **Polyneices:** I'll scatter with a breath the upstart's might,
1395 **Polyneices:** And bring thee home again and stablish thee,
1396 **Polyneices:** And stablish, having cast him out, myself.
1397 **Polyneices:** This with thy goodwill I will undertake,
1398 **Polyneices:** Without it I can scarce return alive.

Lines 1348–1354

1348 **Polyneices:** I have been banished from my native land
1349 **Polyneices:** Because by right of primogeniture
1350 **Polyneices:** I claimed possession of thy sovereign throne
1351 **Polyneices:** Wherefrom Eteocles, my younger brother,
1352 **Polyneices:** Ousted me, not by weight of precedent,
1353 **Polyneices:** Nor by the last arbitrament of war,
1354 **Polyneices:** But by his popular acts; and the prime cause

Line 1364

1364 **Polyneices:** Why then, thou askest, am I here today?

Lines 1394–1396

1394 **Polyneices:** I'll scatter with a breath the upstart's might,
1395 **Polyneices:** And bring thee home again and stablish thee,
1396 **Polyneices:** And stablish, having cast him out, myself.

Lines 1399–1400

1399 **Chorus:** For the king's sake who sent him, Oedipus,
1400 **Chorus:** Dismiss him not without a meet reply.

Lines 1401–1449

1401 **Oedipus:** Nay, worthy seniors, but for Theseus' sake
1402 **Oedipus:** Who sent him hither to have word of me.
1403 **Oedipus:** Never again would he have heard my voice;
1404 **Oedipus:** But now he shall obtain this parting grace,
1405 **Oedipus:** An answer that will bring him little joy.
1406 **Oedipus:** O villain, when thou hadst the sovereignty
1407 **Oedipus:** That now thy brother holdeth in thy stead,
1408 **Oedipus:** Didst thou not drive me, thine own father, out,
1409 **Oedipus:** An exile, cityless, and make me wear
1410 **Oedipus:** This beggar's garb thou weepest to behold,
1411 **Oedipus:** Now thou art come thyself to my sad plight?
1412 **Oedipus:** Nothing is here for tears; it must be borne
1413 **Oedipus:** By me till death, and I shall think of thee
1414 **Oedipus:** As of my murderer; thou didst thrust me out;
1415 **Oedipus:** 'Tis thou hast made me conversant with woe,

1416 **Oedipus:** Through thee I beg my bread in a strange land;
1417 **Oedipus:** And had not these my daughters tended me
1418 **Oedipus:** I had been dead for aught of aid from thee.
1419 **Oedipus:** They tend me, they preserve me, they are men
1420 **Oedipus:** Not women in true service to their sire;
1421 **Oedipus:** But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine.
1422 **Oedipus:** Therefore just Heaven hath an eye on thee;
1423 **Oedipus:** Howbeit not yet with aspect so austere
1424 **Oedipus:** As thou shalt soon experience, if indeed
1425 **Oedipus:** These banded hosts are moving against Thebes.
1426 **Oedipus:** That city thou canst never storm, but first
1427 **Oedipus:** Shalt fall, thou and thy brother, blood-imbrued.
1428 **Oedipus:** Such curse I lately launched against you twain,
1429 **Oedipus:** Such curse I now invoke to fight for me,
1430 **Oedipus:** That ye may learn to honour those who bare thee
1431 **Oedipus:** Nor flout a sightless father who begat
1432 **Oedipus:** Degenerate sons—these maidens did not so.
1433 **Oedipus:** Therefore my curse is stronger than thy "throne,"
1434 **Oedipus:** Thy "suppliance," if by right of laws eterne
1435 **Oedipus:** Primeval Justice sits enthroned with Zeus.
1436 **Oedipus:** Begone, abhorred, disowned, no son of mine,
1437 **Oedipus:** Thou vilest of the vile! and take with thee
1438 **Oedipus:** This curse I leave thee as my last bequest:—
1439 **Oedipus:** Never to win by arms thy native land,
1440 **Oedipus:** No, nor return to Argos in the Vale,
1441 **Oedipus:** But by a kinsman's hand to die and slay
1442 **Oedipus:** Him who expelled thee. So I pray and call
1443 **Oedipus:** On the ancestral gloom of Tartarus
1444 **Oedipus:** To snatch thee hence, on these dread goddesses
1445 **Oedipus:** I call, and Ares who incensed you both
1446 **Oedipus:** To mortal enmity. Go now proclaim
1447 **Oedipus:** What thou hast heard to the Cadmeians all,
1448 **Oedipus:** Thy staunch confederates—this the heritage
1449 **Oedipus:** That Oedipus divideth to his sons.

Lines 1419–1421

1419 **Oedipus:** They tend me, they preserve me, they are men
1420 **Oedipus:** Not women in true service to their sire;
1421 **Oedipus:** But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine.

Lines 1422–1425

1422 **Oedipus:** Therefore just Heaven hath an eye on thee;
1423 **Oedipus:** Howbeit not yet with aspect so austere

1424 **Oedipus:** As thou shalt soon experience, if indeed
1425 **Oedipus:** These banded hosts are moving against Thebes.

Line 1448
1448 **Oedipus:** Thy staunch confederates—this the heritage

Line 1452
1452 **Polyneices:** Woe worth my journey and my baffled hopes!

Lines 1452–1463
1452 **Polyneices:** Woe worth my journey and my baffled hopes!
1453 **Polyneices:** Woe worth my comrades! What a desperate end
1454 **Polyneices:** To that glad march from Argos! Woe is me!
1455 **Polyneices:** I dare not whisper it to my allies
1456 **Polyneices:** Or turn them back, but mute must meet my doom.
1457 **Polyneices:** My sisters, ye his daughters, ye have heard
1458 **Polyneices:** The prayers of our stern father, if his curse
1459 **Polyneices:** Should come to pass and ye some day return
1460 **Polyneices:** To Thebes, O then disown me not, I pray,
1461 **Polyneices:** But grant me burial and due funeral rites.
1462 **Polyneices:** So shall the praise your filial care now wins
1463 **Polyneices:** Be doubled for the service wrought for me.

Lines 1477–1478
1477 **Antigone:** O woe is me! but say, will any dare,
1478 **Antigone:** Hearing his prophecy, to follow thee?

Lines 1479–1480
1479 **Polyneices:** I shall not tell it; a good general
1480 **Polyneices:** Reports successes and conceals mishaps.

Line 1481
1481 **Antigone:** Misguided youth, thy purpose then stands fast!

Lines 1498–1501
1498 **Polyneices:** Nay, that rests with fate,
1499 **Polyneices:** Whether I live or die; but for you both
1500 **Polyneices:** I pray to heaven ye may escape all ill;
1501 **Polyneices:** For ye are blameless in the eyes of all. Exit Polyneices.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

unkempt (adjective)	uncombed and untidy	*Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament My own afflictions, or my aged sire's, Whom here I find a castaway, with you, In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad In antic tatters, marring all his frame, While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match, He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch.*	"unkempt": "uncombed, disheveled," 1570s, from un- "not" + kempt "well-combed, neat," from a past participle of Middle English kemben "to comb," from Old English cemban. (Online Etymology Dictionary (hand-checked note), https://www.etymonline.com/word/unkempt)
mishaps (noun)	bad accidents or setbacks	*I shall not tell it; a good general Reports successes and conceals mishaps.*	"mishap": mid-13c., "bad luck, misfortune, unlucky accident," from mis- "bad" + hap "luck"; the meaning "unfortunate event" is from mid-14c. (Online Etymology Dictionary (hand-checked note), https://www.etymonline.com/word/mishap)

Discussion questions

1. Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?
2. Where does conflict appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with law against force?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does Polyneices say sits beside Zeus' throne? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Mercy.
2. What does Polyneices ask of his father? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Pardon and help in his war on Thebes
3. How does Oedipus answer? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: He curses him
4. What does Polyneices ask his sisters? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To bury him if the curse comes true
5. Why will Polyneices not tell his army of the curse? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A good general hides mishaps

6. Which play continues this story? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Antigone
7. Retell the three most important events of "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.
8. Who is on stage in "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that begins "Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament My own afflictions, or my aged sire's, Whom here I find a castaway, with you, In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad In antic tatters,…", who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why is Polyneices' plea for mercy unsuccessful? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: His father cannot forgive his abandonment; the curse is already set.
2. What does "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)" suggest about Polyneices and the father's curse? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone.
3. Find one example of conflict in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
4. How does the characterization in this scene shape what we understand about Polyneices and the father's curse? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices): Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. On characterization: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. In the passage that begins “Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament My own afflictions, or my aged sire’s, Whom here I find a castaway, with you, In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad In antic tatters,…”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.
7. How does “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)” build on “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices): Polyneices, lines 1479–1480. On characterization: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “Why do people refuse to turn back from a course they expect to fail?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with law against force? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “Misguided youth, thy purpose then stands fast” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1481. On foreshadowing: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Is Oedipus just or cruel to Polyneices? Defend your view with evidence. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices): Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices): Polyneices, lines 1479–1480. On characterization: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of Polyneices and the father's curse. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “Misguided youth, thy purpose then stands fast” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1481. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices'

burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices): Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to death and blessing: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the conflict in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices): Polyneices, lines 1479–1480. On conflict: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)” treats Polyneices and the father's curse with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “Misguided youth, thy purpose then stands fast” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1481. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)” will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices): Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. On foreshadowing: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true,

which sets up Antigone. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about Polyneices and the father's curse? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Useful evidence: “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. Theme link: Polyneices and the father's curse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Polyneices ask of his father?
    A. Pardon and help in his war on Thebes
    B. Antigone's hand in marriage
    C. Money for the journey
    D. A place to live in Athens

    Key: A (Pardon and help in his war on Thebes)
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Polyneices ask his sisters?
    A. To kill Creon
    B. To bury him if the curse comes true
    C. To forget him
    D. To come to Argos

    Key: B (To bury him if the curse comes true)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why will Polyneices not tell his army of the curse?
    A. He has forgotten it
    B. A good general hides mishaps
    C. Theseus forbade him
    D. He does not believe in curses

    Key: B (A good general hides mishaps)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus: “They tend me, they _____ me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye

are bastards, and no sons of mine”

Key: preserve

5. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Polyneices say sits beside Zeus' throne?

   Sample answer: Mercy.

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Antigone: “Misguided youth, thy _____ then stands fast”

   Key: purpose

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices: “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports _____ and conceals mishaps”

   Key: successes

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which play continues this story?

   A. Oedipus Rex

   B. The Odyssey

   C. Medea

   D. Antigone

   Key: D (Antigone)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus answer?

   A. He sends Theseus

   B. He blesses him

   C. He joins his army

   D. He curses him

   Key: D (He curses him)

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why is Polyneices' plea for mercy unsuccessful?

    Sample answer: His father cannot forgive his abandonment; the curse is already set. The evidence is “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) — Polyneices, lines 1324–1327.

11. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)”?

    A. The summons

    B. A prayer for an easy death

    C. Polyneices and the father's curse

    D. The daughters return; a suppliant son

    Key: C (Polyneices and the father's curse)

12. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. The evidence is “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus).

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy

heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices).

Sample answer: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. The evidence is "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) — Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse.

14. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Polyneices and the father's curse.

    A. Death and blessing

    B. Refuge and hospitality

    C. Law against force

    D. Guilt and intent

    Key: B (Refuge and hospitality)

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) supports it: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. But "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421) shows the same issue from another side, and its "Not" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) to Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus, the text reads "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" — Chorus, lines 1284–1287. In Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) — Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. Polyneices and the father's curse.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices: "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit _____ / In thy heart likewise"

    Key: enthroned

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus just or cruel to Polyneices? Defend your view with evidence.

    Sample answer: A defended position: Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. The evidence is "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1401–1449? "So I pray and call On the _____ gloom of Tartarus To snatch thee hence, on these dread goddesses I call, and Ares who incensed you both To mortal enmity."

    A. ancestral

    B. daughters

    C. primogeniture

    D. suppliant

    Key: A (ancestral)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1334–1335? "Let him not spurn, without a single word Of answer, me the _____ of the god."

    A. suppliance

    B. undertake

    C. suppliant

    D. ancestral

    Key: C (suppliant)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1308–1309: "Father, methinks I see the stranger coming, Alone he comes and weeping _____ tears." Word bank: children, primogeniture, plenteous, undertake

    Key: plenteous

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1422–1425 reveal about the character or situation? "Therefore just Heaven hath an eye on thee; Howbeit not yet with aspect so austere As thou shalt soon experience, if indeed These banded hosts are moving against Thebes." Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1422–1425) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "experience" and "against" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1321 reveal about the character or situation? "All this too late I learn, wretch that I am, Alas!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1321) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "wretch" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1336–1339 shapes its tone: "Tell him thyself, unhappy one, thine errand; For large discourse may send a thrill of joy, Or stir a chord of wrath or tenderness, And to the tongue-tied somehow give a tongue." Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words "tenderness" and "discourse" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1336–1339) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1452 shapes its tone: "Woe worth my journey and my baffled hopes!" Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “journey” and “baffled” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1452) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1394–1396 shapes its tone: “I’ll scatter with a breath the upstart’s might, And bring thee home again and stablish thee, And stablish, having cast him out, myself.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “stablish” and “scatter” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1394–1396) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1477–1478 shapes its tone: “O woe is me! but say, will any dare, Hearing his prophecy, to follow thee?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “prophecy” and “follow” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1477–1478) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1364 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Why then, thou askest, am I here today?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1364) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “askest” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “For the king’s sake who sent him, Oedipus, Dismiss him not without a meet reply.” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1364), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1348–1354: “I have been banished from my native land Because by right of _____ I claimed possession of thy sovereign throne Wherefrom Eteocles, my younger brother, Ousted me, not by weight of precedent, Nor by the last arbitrament of war, But by his popular acts” Word bank: primogeniture, strangers, daughters, fountains

    Key: primogeniture

30. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)”? Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true,…

    A. Structure

    B. Irony

    C. Personification

    D. Conflict

    Key: D (Conflict)

31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. The evidence is “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices). This

develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse. The words “enthroned” and “almighty” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Polyneices, lines 1479–1480. The evidence is “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices). This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse. The words “successes” and “conceals” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1498–1501 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Nay, that rests with fate, Whether I live or die; but for you both I pray to heaven ye may escape all ill; For ye are blameless in the eyes of all.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1498–1501) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “blameless” and “heaven” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “All this too late I learn, wretch that I am, Alas!” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1498–1501), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

34. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1448 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Go now proclaim What thou hast heard to the Cadmeians all, Thy staunch confederates—this the heritage That Oedipus divideth to his sons.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1448) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “confederates” and “heritage” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Never again would he have heard my voice; But now he shall obtain this parting grace, An answer that will bring him…” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1448), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

35. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1340–1398? “So, by our _____ and familiar gods I pray thee, yield and hear”

    A. fountains

    B. children

    C. counsel

    D. brother

    Key: A (fountains)

36. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1401–1449: “And had not these my _____ tended me I had been dead for aught of aid from thee.” Word bank: primogeniture, fountains, neglect, daughters

    Key: daughters

37. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. The evidence is “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse. The words “bastards” and “preserve” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 3, analysis 2, synthesis 2
HS Freshman	17, 2, 5, 1, 7, 6, 3, 9, 4, 8, 10, 11, 14, 18, 16, 15	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	19, 20, 8, 7, 17, 21, 12, 11, 22, 10, 23, 24, 14, 25, 18, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	17, 5, 6, 3, 20, 8, 22, 23, 10, 12, 14, 25, 26, 27, 28, 18	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	2, 1, 9, 7, 29, 12, 22, 23, 10, 24, 27, 26, 30, 16, 31, 18	recall 5, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 29, 8, 1, 10, 12, 22, 25, 24, 14, 32, 30, 18, 33, 28, 34	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	3, 29, 4, 1, 9, 10, 25, 32, 24, 30, 27, 16, 34, 33, 31, 28	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	35, 7, 17, 1, 11, 23, 25, 24, 27, 26, 14, 28, 34, 16, 33, 15	recall 4, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	8, 36, 17, 1, 9, 32, 27, 14, 24, 25, 37, 18, 34, 33, 15, 28	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	3, 4, 6, 1, 9, 25, 26, 32, 14, 15, 16, 18, 37, 34, 33, 28	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	4, 6, 1, 9, 25, 30, 26, 14, 27, 24, 16, 28, 18, 33, 34, 15	recall 4, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 6

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501),” how does Sophocles show Polyneices and the father's curse? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), how does Sophocles develop the idea of Polyneices and the father's curse? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) develops the idea of Polyneices and the father's curse. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding

of Polyneices and the father's curse. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) suggests about Polyneices and the father's curse. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's conflict and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses conflict in Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) to complicate the reader's understanding of Polyneices and the father's curse. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of Polyneices and the father's curse responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of Polyneices and the father's curse follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) and its treatment of Polyneices and the father's curse. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's conflict and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) as evidence for a larger claim about Polyneices and the father's curse in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of Polyneices and the father's curse. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament My own afflictions, or my aged sire's, Whom here I find a castaway, with you, In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad In antic tatters, marring all his frame, While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match, He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch. All this too late I learn, wretch that I am, Alas! I own it, and am proved most vile In my neglect of thee: I scorn myself. But as almighty Zeus in all he doth Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past May be amended, cannot be made worse. Why silent? Father, speak, nor turn away, Hast thou no word, wilt thou dismiss me then In mute disdain, nor tell me why thou art wrath? O ye his daughters, sisters mine, do ye This sullen, obstinate silence try to move. Let him not spurn, without a single word Of answer, me the suppliant of the god.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)"?

   A. Polyneices and the father's curse

   B. "Not to be born"

   C. The beggar at the sacred grove

   D. The Colonus ode

SAT key: 1. A (Polyneices and the father's curse)

Lesson 11: Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)

Focus: the summons

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported or spoken of)): Cite method lines by number only.
Student preview: This section returns to grief and despair in the play.
Suggested language: "How do the others respond to this loss?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

Background: Compare Oedipus Rex, where the seeing king could not see the truth; here the blind man leads.

Significance: The blind man leads the seeing.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does it mean to face the end of something calmly? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because.... Content note before we start: This section returns to grief and despair in the play.
Prompt: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the summons.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: palpable — able to be touched or felt. "palpable": Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis.
Words: palpable: able to be touched or felt

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Compare Oedipus Rex, where the seeing king could not see the truth; here the blind man leads. The blind man leads the seeing. Look closely: Compare Oedipus Rex, where the seeing king could not see the truth; here the blind man leads (lines 1592–1593).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders sing that Time watches over what the gods have written, now throwing down the great and now raising the low. Next, craft. I notice the two balanced lines, overthrowing and raising, show the turn of fortune in one picture. The strongest word is "Raising": Time's lifting of the humble. Then, effect. How does the picture of Time overthrowing and raising apply to Oedipus? My answer: The picture of Time overthrowing the great and raising the low applies to Oedipus in both directions: Time overthrew him in Oedipus Rex, and now it raises the outcast to honour as he leads Theseus to his resting place.

> *Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate.* (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus)

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders sing that Time watches over what the gods have written, now throwing down the great and now raising the low. Next, craft. I notice the two balanced lines, overthrowing and raising, show the turn of fortune in one picture. The strongest word is "Raising": Time's lifting of the humble. Then, effect. How does the picture of Time overthrowing and raising apply to Oedipus? My answer: The picture of Time overthrowing the great and raising the low applies to Oedipus in both directions: Time overthrew him in Oedipus Rex, and now it raises the outcast to honour as he leads Theseus to his resting place.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Compare Oedipus Rex, where the seeing king could not see the truth; here the blind man leads. Read closely: "Strange that I Whom ye have led so long should lead you now." (Oedipus, lines 1592–1593). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: The summons. (Oedipus, lines 1592–1593.)

> *Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now* (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Compare Oedipus Rex, where the seeing king could not see the truth; here the blind man leads. Read closely: "Strange that I Whom ye have led so long should lead you now." (Oedipus, lines 1592–1593).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: The summons. (Oedipus, lines 1592–1593.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the scene for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the summons? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) develops the idea of the summons. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The blind man leads the seeing. When the text says "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus), it shows this directly. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.
Task: Annotate the scene for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the summons? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) develops the idea of the summons. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The blind man leads the seeing. When the text says "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus), it shows this directly. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly? Ask: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?
Anchor question: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?
Facilitation: Ask: What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the summons? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The blind man leads the seeing. ("Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate", Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the summons? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The blind man leads the seeing. ("Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate", Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the summons. Key takeaway: the summons.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.
- **Irony:** Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.
- **Characterization:** Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the summons.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the summons.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1508–1511.
- "Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1592–1593.
- "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) Oedipus, lines 1599–1602.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The blind man leads the seeing.
Evidence: "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus)
Reasoning: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1324–1327
1324 **Polyneices:** But as almighty Zeus in all he doth
1325 **Polyneices:** Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne,
1326 **Polyneices:** Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned
1327 **Polyneices:** In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past

Lines 1506–1507
1506 **Chorus:** For ne'er have I proved vain
1507 **Chorus:** Aught that the heavenly powers ordain.

Lines 1508–1511
1508 **Chorus:** Time with never sleeping eye
1509 **Chorus:** Watches what is writ on high,
1510 **Chorus:** Overthrowing now the great,
1511 **Chorus:** Raising now from low estate.

Lines 1513–1514
1513 **Oedipus:** Children, my children! will no messenger
1514 **Oedipus:** Go summon hither Theseus my best friend?

Lines 1528–1529
1528 **Oedipus:** I know full well. Let some one with all speed
1529 **Oedipus:** Go summon hither the Athenian prince.

Lines 1530–1537
1530 **Chorus:** Ha! once more the deafening sound
1531 **Chorus:** Peals yet louder all around
1532 **Chorus:** If thou darkenest our land,
1533 **Chorus:** Lightly, lightly lay thy hand;
1534 **Chorus:** Grace, not anger, let me win,
1535 **Chorus:** If upon a man of sin
1536 **Chorus:** I have looked with pitying eye,
1537 **Chorus:** Zeus, our king, to thee I cry!

Lines 1538–1539
1538 **Oedipus:** Is the prince coming? Will he when he comes
1539 **Oedipus:** Find me yet living and my senses clear!

Lines 1543–1549
1543 **Chorus:** Hither haste, my son, arise,
1544 **Chorus:** Altar leave and sacrifice,
1545 **Chorus:** If haply to Poseidon now
1546 **Chorus:** In the far glade thou pay'st thy vow.
1547 **Chorus:** For our guest to thee would bring

1548 **Chorus:** And thy folk an offering,
1549 **Chorus:** Thy due guerdon. Haste, O King!

Lines 1547–1549

1547 **Chorus:** For our guest to thee would bring
1548 **Chorus:** And thy folk an offering,
1549 **Chorus:** Thy due guerdon. Haste, O King!

Lines 1550–1554

1550 **Theseus:** Wherefore again this general din? at once
1551 **Theseus:** My people call me and the stranger calls.
1552 **Theseus:** Is it a thunderbolt of Zeus or sleet
1553 **Theseus:** Of arrowy hail? a storm so fierce as this
1554 **Theseus:** Would warrant all surmises of mischance.

Line 1560

1560 **Theseus:** What sign assures thee that thine end is near?

Lines 1568–1605

1568 **Oedipus:** O son of Aegeus, for this state will I
1569 **Oedipus:** Unfold a treasure age cannot corrupt.
1570 **Oedipus:** Myself anon without a guiding hand
1571 **Oedipus:** Will take thee to the spot where I must end.
1572 **Oedipus:** This secret ne'er reveal to mortal man,
1573 **Oedipus:** Neither the spot nor whereabouts it lies,
1574 **Oedipus:** So shall it ever serve thee for defense
1575 **Oedipus:** Better than native shields and near allies.
1576 **Oedipus:** But those dread mysteries speech may not profane
1577 **Oedipus:** Thyself shalt gather coming there alone;
1578 **Oedipus:** Since not to any of thy subjects, nor
1579 **Oedipus:** To my own children, though I love them dearly,
1580 **Oedipus:** Can I reveal what thou must guard alone,
1581 **Oedipus:** And whisper to thy chosen heir alone,
1582 **Oedipus:** So to be handed down from heir to heir.
1583 **Oedipus:** Thus shalt thou hold this land inviolate
1584 **Oedipus:** From the dread Dragon's brood. The justest State
1585 **Oedipus:** By countless wanton neighbours may be wronged,
1586 **Oedipus:** For the gods, though they tarry, mark for doom
1587 **Oedipus:** The godless sinner in his mad career.
1588 **Oedipus:** Far from thee, son of Aegeus, be such fate!
1589 **Oedipus:** Thou knowest, yet I would admonish thee.
1590 **Oedipus:** But to the spot—the god within me goads—
1591 **Oedipus:** Let us set forth nor longer hesitate.
1592 **Oedipus:** Follow me, daughters, this way. Strange that I
1593 **Oedipus:** Whom ye have led so long should lead you now.

1594 **Oedipus:** Oh, touch me not, but let me all alone
1595 **Oedipus:** Find out the sepulcher that destiny
1596 **Oedipus:** Appoints me in this land. Hither, this way,
1597 **Oedipus:** For this way Hermes leads, the spirit guide,
1598 **Oedipus:** And Persephassa, empress of the dead.
1599 **Oedipus:** O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile,
1600 **Oedipus:** Now the last time I feel thee palpable,
1601 **Oedipus:** For I am drawing near the final gloom
1602 **Oedipus:** Of Hades. Blessing on thee, dearest friend,
1603 **Oedipus:** On thee and on thy land and followers!
1604 **Oedipus:** Live prosperous and in your happy state
1605 **Oedipus:** Still for your welfare think on me, the dead. Exit Theseus followed by Antigone and Ismene.

Lines 1578–1582
1578 **Oedipus:** Since not to any of thy subjects, nor
1579 **Oedipus:** To my own children, though I love them dearly,
1580 **Oedipus:** Can I reveal what thou must guard alone,
1581 **Oedipus:** And whisper to thy chosen heir alone,
1582 **Oedipus:** So to be handed down from heir to heir.

Lines 1592–1593
1592 **Oedipus:** Follow me, daughters, this way. Strange that I
1593 **Oedipus:** Whom ye have led so long should lead you now.

Lines 1599–1602
1599 **Oedipus:** O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile,
1600 **Oedipus:** Now the last time I feel thee palpable,
1601 **Oedipus:** For I am drawing near the final gloom
1602 **Oedipus:** Of Hades. Blessing on thee, dearest friend,

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
palpable (adjective)	able to be touched or felt	*O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, Now the last time I feel thee palpable, For I am drawing near the final gloom Of Hades.*	"palpable": Origin: Middle French palpable; earlier Latin palpābilis. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/palpable#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with death and blessing?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Oedipus say in lines 1592–1593? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Those who led him so long are now led by him.
2. What signals Oedipus' end? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thunder
3. Whom does Oedipus call for? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Theseus
4. What is strange about Oedipus in this scene? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The blind man leads the others
5. What will protect Athens, according to Oedipus? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The secret of his resting place, passed to Theseus' heir
6. What does Time do, according to the Chorus? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Overthrows the great and raises the low
7. Retell the three most important events of "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.
8. Who is on stage in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. Reread: "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, Now the last time I feel thee palpable, For I am drawing near the final gloom Of Hades." What does "palpable" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: palpable: able to be touched or felt.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Oedipus no longer need a guide? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He is led by the god; his inner sight guides him.
2. What does "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" suggest about the summons? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The blind man leads the seeing.
3. Find one example of plot in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the irony in this scene shape what we understand about the summons? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.6, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1508–1511. On irony: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins "Strophe 1 Ills on ills!", why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.
7. How does "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)" build on "Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1599–1602. On characterization: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret,

passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. The bell-ringer asked: "What does it mean to face the end of something calmly?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with death and blessing? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1508–1511. On characterization: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Open question: is Oedipus' passing a reward, a mystery, or both? Defend any position. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Any defended position.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: "The blind man leads the seeing." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1599–1602. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1508–1511. On characterization: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the summons. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1599–1602. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to refuge and hospitality: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1508–1511. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. On plot: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)” treats the summons with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1599–1602. Theme

link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Predict what "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1508–1511. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the summons? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The blind man leads the seeing. Useful evidence: "Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus): Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. Theme link: the summons. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is strange about Oedipus in this scene?
   A. He regains his sight
   B. He refuses to move
   C. The blind man leads the others
   D. He asks to return to Thebes

   Key: C (The blind man leads the others)
2. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Oedipus say in lines 1592–1593?
   Sample answer: Those who led him so long are now led by him.
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Oedipus call for?
   A. Polyneices
   B. Theseus
   C. Creon
   D. Teiresias

   Key: B (Theseus)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus: "Time with never _____ eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, /

Raising now from low estate”

Key: sleeping

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus: “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long _____ lead you now”

   Key: should

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What signals Oedipus' end?

   A. An earthquake

   B. Thunder

   C. A messenger from Thebes

   D. A dream

   Key: B (Thunder)

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What will protect Athens, according to Oedipus?

   A. A wall

   B. The secret of his resting place, passed to Theseus' heir

   C. A new temple

   D. An alliance with Thebes

   Key: B (The secret of his resting place, passed to Theseus' heir)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Time do, according to the Chorus?

   A. Stands still

   B. Forgets the past

   C. Overthrows the great and raises the low

   D. Favors only kings

   Key: C (Overthrows the great and raises the low)

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, Now the last time I feel thee _____, For I am drawing near the final gloom Of Hades.” Word bank: palpable

   Key: palpable

10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Oedipus no longer need a guide?

    Sample answer: He is led by the god; his inner sight guides him. The evidence is “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1599–1602.

11. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The summons.

    A. Guilt and intent

    B. Law against force

    C. Refuge and hospitality

    D. Curse and mercy

    Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

12. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)”? Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a

guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

A. Plot

B. Conflict

C. Tone / mood

D. Simile

Key: A (Plot)

13. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The blind man leads the seeing. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus).
Sample answer: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. The evidence is “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1508–1511. This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons.

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501) to Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices, the text reads “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…” — Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. In Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1508–1511. The summons.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Open question: is Oedipus' passing a reward, a mystery, or both? Defend any position.
Sample answer: Any defended position: Chorus, lines 1508–1511. The evidence is “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The blind man leads the seeing.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) supports it: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. But “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 1599–1602) shows the same issue from another side, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus: “O light, no light to me, but mine _____, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades”
Key: erewhile

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1508–1511. The evidence is "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. The words "sleeping" and "estate" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1543–1549: "Antistrophe 2 Hither haste, my son, arise, Altar leave and _____, If haply to Poseidon now In the far glade thou pay'st thy vow." Word bank: thunder, stranger, sacrifice, believe

    Key: sacrifice

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1528–1529? "Let some one with all speed Go _____ hither the Athenian prince."

    A. summon

    B. without

    C. pitying

    D. promised

    Key: A (summon)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), line 1560 reveal about the character or situation? "What sign assures thee that thine end is near?" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), line 1560) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "assures" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)"?

    A. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

    B. The daughters return; a suppliant son

    C. "Not to be born"

    D. The summons

    Key: D (The summons)

23. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)?

    A. "Or haply now we see fulfilled What fate long time hath willed?"

    B. "Strophe 1 Ills on ills! no pause or rest!"

    C. "For ne'er have I proved vain Aught that the heavenly powers ordain."

    D. "Children, my children! will no messenger Go summon hither Theseus my best friend?"

    Key: B ("Strophe 1 Ills on ills! no pause or rest!")

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1578–1582 shapes its tone: “Since not to any of thy subjects, nor To my own children, though I love them dearly, Can I reveal what thou must guard alone, And whisper to thy chosen heir alone, So to be handed down from heir to heir.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “subjects” and “children” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1578–1582) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1513–1514 shapes its tone: “Children, my children! will no messenger Go summon hither Theseus my best friend?” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “messenger” and “children” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1513–1514) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1547–1549 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “For our guest to thee would bring And thy folk an offering, Thy due guerdon.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1547–1549) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “offering” and “guerdon” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Is it a thunderbolt of Zeus or sleet Of arrowy hail? a storm so fierce as this Would warrant all surmises of mischance.” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1547–1549), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.
27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1506–1507: “For ne’er have I proved vain Aught that the _____ powers ordain.” Word bank: themselves, wished, spirit, heavenly
    Key: heavenly
28. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1568–1605: “Myself anon _____ a guiding hand Will take thee to the spot where I must end.” Word bank: impress, without, inviolate, pitying
    Key: without
29. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1508–1511. The evidence is “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus).
30. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1568–1605 shapes its tone: “Hither, this way, For this way Hermes leads, the spirit guide, And Persephassa, empress of the dead.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “empress” and “spirit” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1568–1605) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
31. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1530–1537 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Strophe 2 Ha! once more the deafening sound Peals yet louder all around If thou darkenest our land, Lightly, lightly lay thy hand” Use

one other moment from the story as well.

Sample answer: This passage (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1530–1537) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “deafening” and “darkenest” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Will he when he comes Find me yet living and my senses clear!” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1538–1539), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. The evidence is “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. The words “should” and “lead” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

33. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1599–1602. The evidence is “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. The words “palpable” and “erewhile” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 3, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	4, 6, 17, 1, 8, 3, 2, 5, 7, 10, 12, 11, 15, 16, 18, 14	recall 9, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 4
HS Sophomore	19, 5, 6, 9, 4, 2, 20, 21, 22, 23, 10, 24, 11, 25, 26, 14	recall 7, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	6, 27, 20, 28, 5, 19, 10, 23, 29, 21, 25, 11, 30, 24, 31, 16	recall 6, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	4, 3, 2, 1, 19, 7, 10, 23, 21, 12, 30, 11, 24, 16, 14, 18	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	7, 9, 19, 21, 10, 23, 25, 30, 12, 24, 11, 15, 31, 14, 26, 32	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Freshman	4, 28, 20, 10, 23, 21, 30, 25, 24, 11, 12, 14, 16, 15, 26, 31	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	9, 7, 4, 22, 23, 10, 29, 24, 30, 11, 25, 15, 26, 16, 31, 14	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
College Junior	3, 17, 4, 6, 22, 11, 25, 24, 13, 30, 15, 14, 32, 26, 16, 31	recall 4, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	8, 4, 5, 23, 22, 21, 25, 30, 11, 33, 24, 31, 15, 16, 14, 26	recall 3, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	4, 9, 6, 23, 30, 12, 11, 25, 24, 32, 15, 18, 26, 14, 16, 31	recall 3, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 7

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)," how does Sophocles show the summons? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the summons? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) develops the idea of the summons. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the summons. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) suggests about the summons. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses plot in Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) to complicate the reader's understanding of the summons. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the summons responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the summons follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Thunder scene (lines

1502–1605) and its treatment of the summons. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's plot and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) as evidence for a larger claim about the summons in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the summons. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 Ills on ills! no pause or rest! Come they from our sightless guest? Or haply now we see fulfilled What fate long time hath willed? For ne'er have I proved vain Aught that the heavenly powers ordain. Time with never sleeping eye Watches what is writ on high, Overthrowing now the great, Raising now from low estate. Hark! How the thunder rumbles! Zeus defend us!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)"?

   A. Creon seizes the daughters

   B. The elders' fear

   C. The Colonus ode

   D. The summons

SAT key: 1. D (The summons)

Lesson 12: Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)

Focus: a prayer for an easy death

Objective: Students will summarize what happens in Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) (a prayer for an easy death) in 2 sentences and, in a 3-sentence warm-up response, explain how one quoted line from the scene sets up the scene that follows.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.1

Teacher only · spoilers

The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

Background: The ode names figures of the Greek underworld, such as its queen and its watch-dog (lines 1616–1617).

Significance: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How have the elders changed since the Parodos? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because....
Prompt: How have the elders changed since the Parodos?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: a prayer for an easy death.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tearless — without tears; calm and free of grief.
Words: tearless: without tears; calm and free of grief

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The ode names figures of the Greek underworld, such as its queen and its watch-dog (lines 1616–1617). The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Look closely: Lines 1610–1613 are the elders' prayer for a gentle death for Oedipus, whose end the god has called; it is not a wish to harm oneself.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders pray to the powers below to send the stranger gently, without tears or pain, into the dark world of the dead. Next, craft. I notice a prayer in short rhymed lines, soft words, gentle and tearless, against the gloom. The strongest word is "gentle": the kind of end they ask the gods to grant him. Then, effect. How has the elders' attitude to Oedipus changed by the time they pray for his gentle passing? My answer: The elders' attitude to Oedipus has changed from fear to care: the men who first ordered him out of their borders now pray that his passing be gentle, the play's model of welcome.

> *By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain.* *(Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), lines 1610–1613)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain." slowly and put it in my own words: The elders pray to the powers below to send the stranger gently, without tears or pain, into the dark world of the dead. Next, craft. I notice a prayer in short rhymed lines, soft words, gentle and tearless, against the gloom. The strongest word is "gentle": the kind of end they ask the gods to grant him. Then, effect. How has the elders' attitude to Oedipus changed by the time they pray for his gentle passing? My answer: The elders' attitude to Oedipus has changed from fear to care: the men who first ordered him out of their borders now pray that his passing be gentle, the play's model of welcome.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Read closely: "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed." (Chorus, lines 1614–1615). Ask: What do the elders ask Justice to do? Expected: Bless Oedipus now. Ask: Why do the elders call Oedipus "wrongfully" oppressed? Expected: They now accept that he acted unknowingly.

> *Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed.* *(Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus)*

Ask: What do the elders ask Justice to do?
Expected answer: Bless Oedipus now.
Ask: Why do the elders call Oedipus "wrongfully" oppressed?
Expected answer: They now accept that he acted unknowingly.

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the ode for allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about a prayer for an easy death? Exemplar: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. The lines "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain." (lines 1610–1613) are the evidence.
Task: Annotate the ode for allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this ode suggest about a prayer for an easy death?
Exemplar: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. The lines "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain." (lines 1610–1613) are the evidence.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How have the elders changed since the Parodos? Ask: Does the change in the Chorus show the play's view of Oedipus? Defend your view.
Anchor question: How have the elders changed since the Parodos?
Facilitation: Ask: Does the change in the Chorus show the play's view of Oedipus? Defend your view. · Ask for the line that proves each answer.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: How has the elders' attitude to Oedipus changed by the time they pray for his gentle passing? Model answer: The elders' attitude to Oedipus has changed from fear to care: the men who first ordered him out of their borders now pray that his passing be gentle, the play's model of welcome.
Exit ticket: How has the elders' attitude to Oedipus changed by the time they pray for his gentle passing?
Answer: The elders' attitude to Oedipus has changed from fear to care: the men who first ordered him out of their borders now pray that his passing be gentle, the play's model of welcome.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes a prayer for an easy death. Key takeaway: a prayer for an easy death.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Allusion:** The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.
- **Tone / mood:** The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.
- **Theme:** The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** a prayer for an easy death.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: a prayer for an easy death.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1610–1613.
- "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1614–1615.
- "If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) Chorus, in this part of the section.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace.
Evidence: "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus)
Reasoning: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1308–1309

Antigone: Father, methinks I see the stranger coming,
Antigone: Alone he comes and weeping plenteous tears.

Lines 1313–1335

Polyneices: Ah me, my sisters, shall I first lament
Polyneices: My own afflictions, or my aged sire's,
Polyneices: Whom here I find a castaway, with you,
Polyneices: In a strange land, an ancient beggar clad
Polyneices: In antic tatters, marring all his frame,
Polyneices: While o'er the sightless orbs his unkempt locks
Polyneices: Float in the breeze; and, as it were to match,
Polyneices: He bears a wallet against hunger's pinch.
Polyneices: All this too late I learn, wretch that I am,
Polyneices: Alas! I own it, and am proved most vile
Polyneices: In my neglect of thee: I scorn myself.
Polyneices: But as almighty Zeus in all he doth
Polyneices: Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne,
Polyneices: Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned

1327 **Polyneices:** In thy heart likewise. For transgressions past
1328 **Polyneices:** May be amended, cannot be made worse.
1329 **Polyneices:** Why silent? Father, speak, nor turn away,
1330 **Polyneices:** Hast thou no word, wilt thou dismiss me then
1331 **Polyneices:** In mute disdain, nor tell me why thou art wrath?
1332 **Polyneices:** O ye his daughters, sisters mine, do ye
1333 **Polyneices:** This sullen, obstinate silence try to move.
1334 **Polyneices:** Let him not spurn, without a single word
1335 **Polyneices:** Of answer, me the suppliant of the god.

Line 1321

1321 **Polyneices:** All this too late I learn, wretch that I am,

Lines 1334–1335

1334 **Polyneices:** Let him not spurn, without a single word
1335 **Polyneices:** Of answer, me the suppliant of the god.

Lines 1336–1339

1336 **Antigone:** Tell him thyself, unhappy one, thine errand;
1337 **Antigone:** For large discourse may send a thrill of joy,
1338 **Antigone:** Or stir a chord of wrath or tenderness,
1339 **Antigone:** And to the tongue-tied somehow give a tongue.

Lines 1340–1398

1340 **Polyneices:** Well dost thou counsel, and I will speak out.
1341 **Polyneices:** First will I call in aid the god himself,
1342 **Polyneices:** Poseidon, from whose altar I was raised,
1343 **Polyneices:** With warrant from the monarch of this land,
1344 **Polyneices:** To parley with you, and depart unscathed.
1345 **Polyneices:** These pledges, strangers, I would see observed
1346 **Polyneices:** By you and by my sisters and my sire.
1347 **Polyneices:** Now, father, let me tell thee why I came.
1348 **Polyneices:** I have been banished from my native land
1349 **Polyneices:** Because by right of primogeniture
1350 **Polyneices:** I claimed possession of thy sovereign throne
1351 **Polyneices:** Wherefrom Eteocles, my younger brother,
1352 **Polyneices:** Ousted me, not by weight of precedent,
1353 **Polyneices:** Nor by the last arbitrament of war,
1354 **Polyneices:** But by his popular acts; and the prime cause
1355 **Polyneices:** Of this I deem the curse that rests on thee.
1356 **Polyneices:** So likewise hold the soothsayers, for when
1357 **Polyneices:** I came to Argos in the Dorian land
1358 **Polyneices:** And took the king Adrastus' child to wife,
1359 **Polyneices:** Under my standard I enlisted all
1360 **Polyneices:** The foremost captains of the Apian isle,

1361 **Polyneices:** To levy with their aid that sevenfold host
1362 **Polyneices:** Of spearmen against Thebes, determining
1363 **Polyneices:** To oust my foes or die in a just cause.
1364 **Polyneices:** Why then, thou askest, am I here today?
1365 **Polyneices:** Father, I come a suppliant to thee
1366 **Polyneices:** Both for myself and my allies who now
1367 **Polyneices:** With squadrons seven beneath their seven spears
1368 **Polyneices:** Beleaguer all the plain that circles Thebes.
1369 **Polyneices:** Foremost the peerless warrior, peerless seer,
1370 **Polyneices:** Amphiaraüs with his lightning lance;
1371 **Polyneices:** Next an Aetolian, Tydeus, Oeneus' son;
1372 **Polyneices:** Eteoclus of Argive birth the third;
1373 **Polyneices:** The fourth Hippomedon, sent to the war
1374 **Polyneices:** By his sire Talaos; Capaneus, the fifth,
1375 **Polyneices:** Vaunts he will fire and raze the town; the sixth
1376 **Polyneices:** Parthenopaeus, an Arcadian born
1377 **Polyneices:** Named of that maid, longtime a maid and late
1378 **Polyneices:** Espoused, Atalanta's true-born child;
1379 **Polyneices:** Last I thy son, or thine at least in name,
1380 **Polyneices:** If but the bastard of an evil fate,
1381 **Polyneices:** Lead against Thebes the fearless Argive host.
1382 **Polyneices:** Thus by thy children and thy life, my sire,
1383 **Polyneices:** We all adjure thee to remit thy wrath
1384 **Polyneices:** And favour one who seeks a just revenge
1385 **Polyneices:** Against a brother who has banned and robbed him.
1386 **Polyneices:** For victory, if oracles speak true,
1387 **Polyneices:** Will fall to those who have thee for ally.
1388 **Polyneices:** So, by our fountains and familiar gods
1389 **Polyneices:** I pray thee, yield and hear; a beggar I
1390 **Polyneices:** And exile, thou an exile likewise; both
1391 **Polyneices:** Involved in one misfortune find a home
1392 **Polyneices:** As pensioners, while he, the lord of Thebes,
1393 **Polyneices:** O agony! makes mock of thee and me.
1394 **Polyneices:** I'll scatter with a breath the upstart's might,
1395 **Polyneices:** And bring thee home again and stablish thee,
1396 **Polyneices:** And stablish, having cast him out, myself.
1397 **Polyneices:** This with thy goodwill I will undertake,
1398 **Polyneices:** Without it I can scarce return alive.

Lines 1348–1354

1348 **Polyneices:** I have been banished from my native land
1349 **Polyneices:** Because by right of primogeniture
1350 **Polyneices:** I claimed possession of thy sovereign throne
1351 **Polyneices:** Wherefrom Eteocles, my younger brother,

1352 **Polyneices:** Ousted me, not by weight of precedent,
1353 **Polyneices:** Nor by the last arbitrament of war,
1354 **Polyneices:** But by his popular acts; and the prime cause

Line 1364

1364 **Polyneices:** Why then, thou askest, am I here today?

Lines 1394–1396

1394 **Polyneices:** I'll scatter with a breath the upstart's might,
1395 **Polyneices:** And bring thee home again and stablish thee,
1396 **Polyneices:** And stablish, having cast him out, myself.

Lines 1399–1400

1399 **Chorus:** For the king's sake who sent him, Oedipus,
1400 **Chorus:** Dismiss him not without a meet reply.

Lines 1401–1449

1401 **Oedipus:** Nay, worthy seniors, but for Theseus' sake
1402 **Oedipus:** Who sent him hither to have word of me.
1403 **Oedipus:** Never again would he have heard my voice;
1404 **Oedipus:** But now he shall obtain this parting grace,
1405 **Oedipus:** An answer that will bring him little joy.
1406 **Oedipus:** O villain, when thou hadst the sovereignty
1407 **Oedipus:** That now thy brother holdeth in thy stead,
1408 **Oedipus:** Didst thou not drive me, thine own father, out,
1409 **Oedipus:** An exile, cityless, and make me wear
1410 **Oedipus:** This beggar's garb thou weepest to behold,
1411 **Oedipus:** Now thou art come thyself to my sad plight?
1412 **Oedipus:** Nothing is here for tears; it must be borne
1413 **Oedipus:** By me till death, and I shall think of thee
1414 **Oedipus:** As of my murderer; thou didst thrust me out;
1415 **Oedipus:** 'Tis thou hast made me conversant with woe,
1416 **Oedipus:** Through thee I beg my bread in a strange land;
1417 **Oedipus:** And had not these my daughters tended me
1418 **Oedipus:** I had been dead for aught of aid from thee.
1419 **Oedipus:** They tend me, they preserve me, they are men
1420 **Oedipus:** Not women in true service to their sire;
1421 **Oedipus:** But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine.
1422 **Oedipus:** Therefore just Heaven hath an eye on thee;
1423 **Oedipus:** Howbeit not yet with aspect so austere
1424 **Oedipus:** As thou shalt soon experience, if indeed
1425 **Oedipus:** These banded hosts are moving against Thebes.
1426 **Oedipus:** That city thou canst never storm, but first
1427 **Oedipus:** Shalt fall, thou and thy brother, blood-imbrued.
1428 **Oedipus:** Such curse I lately launched against you twain,

1429 **Oedipus:** Such curse I now invoke to fight for me,
1430 **Oedipus:** That ye may learn to honour those who bare thee
1431 **Oedipus:** Nor flout a sightless father who begat
1432 **Oedipus:** Degenerate sons—these maidens did not so.
1433 **Oedipus:** Therefore my curse is stronger than thy "throne,"
1434 **Oedipus:** Thy "suppliance," if by right of laws eterne
1435 **Oedipus:** Primeval Justice sits enthroned with Zeus.
1436 **Oedipus:** Begone, abhorred, disowned, no son of mine,
1437 **Oedipus:** Thou vilest of the vile! and take with thee
1438 **Oedipus:** This curse I leave thee as my last bequest:—
1439 **Oedipus:** Never to win by arms thy native land,
1440 **Oedipus:** No, nor return to Argos in the Vale,
1441 **Oedipus:** But by a kinsman's hand to die and slay
1442 **Oedipus:** Him who expelled thee. So I pray and call
1443 **Oedipus:** On the ancestral gloom of Tartarus
1444 **Oedipus:** To snatch thee hence, on these dread goddesses
1445 **Oedipus:** I call, and Ares who incensed you both
1446 **Oedipus:** To mortal enmity. Go now proclaim
1447 **Oedipus:** What thou hast heard to the Cadmeians all,
1448 **Oedipus:** Thy staunch confederates—this the heritage
1449 **Oedipus:** That Oedipus divideth to his sons.

Lines 1422–1425

1422 **Oedipus:** Therefore just Heaven hath an eye on thee;
1423 **Oedipus:** Howbeit not yet with aspect so austere
1424 **Oedipus:** As thou shalt soon experience, if indeed
1425 **Oedipus:** These banded hosts are moving against Thebes.

Line 1448

1448 **Oedipus:** Thy staunch confederates—this the heritage

Line 1452

1452 **Polyneices:** Woe worth my journey and my baffled hopes!

Lines 1452–1463

1452 **Polyneices:** Woe worth my journey and my baffled hopes!
1453 **Polyneices:** Woe worth my comrades! What a desperate end
1454 **Polyneices:** To that glad march from Argos! Woe is me!
1455 **Polyneices:** I dare not whisper it to my allies
1456 **Polyneices:** Or turn them back, but mute must meet my doom.
1457 **Polyneices:** My sisters, ye his daughters, ye have heard
1458 **Polyneices:** The prayers of our stern father, if his curse
1459 **Polyneices:** Should come to pass and ye some day return
1460 **Polyneices:** To Thebes, O then disown me not, I pray,
1461 **Polyneices:** But grant me burial and due funeral rites.

1462 **Polyneices:** So shall the praise your filial care now wins
1463 **Polyneices:** Be doubled for the service wrought for me.

Lines 1477–1478
1477 **Antigone:** O woe is me! but say, will any dare,
1478 **Antigone:** Hearing his prophecy, to follow thee?

Lines 1498–1501
1498 **Polyneices:** Nay, that rests with fate,
1499 **Polyneices:** Whether I live or die; but for you both
1500 **Polyneices:** I pray to heaven ye may escape all ill;
1501 **Polyneices:** For ye are blameless in the eyes of all. Exit Polyneices.

Lines 1502–1512
1502 **Chorus:** Ills on ills! no pause or rest!
1503 **Chorus:** Come they from our sightless guest?
1504 **Chorus:** Or haply now we see fulfilled
1505 **Chorus:** What fate long time hath willed?
1506 **Chorus:** For ne'er have I proved vain
1507 **Chorus:** Aught that the heavenly powers ordain.
1508 **Chorus:** Time with never sleeping eye
1509 **Chorus:** Watches what is writ on high,
1510 **Chorus:** Overthrowing now the great,
1511 **Chorus:** Raising now from low estate.
1512 **Chorus:** Hark! How the thunder rumbles! Zeus defend us!

Lines 1504–1505
1504 **Chorus:** Or haply now we see fulfilled
1505 **Chorus:** What fate long time hath willed?

Lines 1508–1511
1508 **Chorus:** Time with never sleeping eye
1509 **Chorus:** Watches what is writ on high,
1510 **Chorus:** Overthrowing now the great,
1511 **Chorus:** Raising now from low estate.

Lines 1518–1524
1518 **Chorus:** Hark! with louder, nearer roar
1519 **Chorus:** The bolt of Zeus descends once more.
1520 **Chorus:** My spirit quails and cowers: my hair
1521 **Chorus:** Bristles for fear. Again that flare!
1522 **Chorus:** What doth the lightning-flash portend?
1523 **Chorus:** Ever it points to issues grave.
1524 **Chorus:** Dread powers of air! Save, Zeus, O save!

Lines 1525–1526
1525 **Oedipus:** Daughters, upon me the predestined end
1526 **Oedipus:** Has come; no turning from it any more.

Line 1540
1540 **Antigone:** What solemn charge would'st thou impress on him?

Lines 1541–1542
1541 **Oedipus:** For all his benefits I would perform
1542 **Oedipus:** The promise made when I received them first.

Lines 1555–1556
1555 **Oedipus:** Thou com'st much wished for, Prince, and sure some god
1556 **Oedipus:** Hath bid good luck attend thee on thy way.

Line 1557
1557 **Theseus:** What, son of Laius, hath chanced of new?

Line 1560
1560 **Theseus:** What sign assures thee that thine end is near?

Lines 1566–1567
1566 **Theseus:** I must believe thee, having found thee oft
1567 **Theseus:** A prophet true; then speak what must be done.

Lines 1568–1569
1568 **Oedipus:** O son of Aegeus, for this state will I
1569 **Oedipus:** Unfold a treasure age cannot corrupt.

Lines 1568–1605
1568 **Oedipus:** O son of Aegeus, for this state will I
1569 **Oedipus:** Unfold a treasure age cannot corrupt.
1570 **Oedipus:** Myself anon without a guiding hand
1571 **Oedipus:** Will take thee to the spot where I must end.
1572 **Oedipus:** This secret ne'er reveal to mortal man,
1573 **Oedipus:** Neither the spot nor whereabouts it lies,
1574 **Oedipus:** So shall it ever serve thee for defense
1575 **Oedipus:** Better than native shields and near allies.
1576 **Oedipus:** But those dread mysteries speech may not profane
1577 **Oedipus:** Thyself shalt gather coming there alone;
1578 **Oedipus:** Since not to any of thy subjects, nor
1579 **Oedipus:** To my own children, though I love them dearly,
1580 **Oedipus:** Can I reveal what thou must guard alone,
1581 **Oedipus:** And whisper to thy chosen heir alone,
1582 **Oedipus:** So to be handed down from heir to heir.
1583 **Oedipus:** Thus shalt thou hold this land inviolate

1584 **Oedipus:** From the dread Dragon's brood. The justest State
1585 **Oedipus:** By countless wanton neighbours may be wronged,
1586 **Oedipus:** For the gods, though they tarry, mark for doom
1587 **Oedipus:** The godless sinner in his mad career.
1588 **Oedipus:** Far from thee, son of Aegeus, be such fate!
1589 **Oedipus:** Thou knowest, yet I would admonish thee.
1590 **Oedipus:** But to the spot—the god within me goads—
1591 **Oedipus:** Let us set forth nor longer hesitate.
1592 **Oedipus:** Follow me, daughters, this way. Strange that I
1593 **Oedipus:** Whom ye have led so long should lead you now.
1594 **Oedipus:** Oh, touch me not, but let me all alone
1595 **Oedipus:** Find out the sepulcher that destiny
1596 **Oedipus:** Appoints me in this land. Hither, this way,
1597 **Oedipus:** For this way Hermes leads, the spirit guide,
1598 **Oedipus:** And Persephassa, empress of the dead.
1599 **Oedipus:** O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile,
1600 **Oedipus:** Now the last time I feel thee palpable,
1601 **Oedipus:** For I am drawing near the final gloom
1602 **Oedipus:** Of Hades. Blessing on thee, dearest friend,
1603 **Oedipus:** On thee and on thy land and followers!
1604 **Oedipus:** Live prosperous and in your happy state
1605 **Oedipus:** Still for your welfare think on me, the dead. Exit Theseus followed by Antigone and Ismene.

Lines 1572–1575

1572 **Oedipus:** This secret ne'er reveal to mortal man,
1573 **Oedipus:** Neither the spot nor whereabouts it lies,
1574 **Oedipus:** So shall it ever serve thee for defense
1575 **Oedipus:** Better than native shields and near allies.

Lines 1583–1584

1583 **Oedipus:** Thus shalt thou hold this land inviolate
1584 **Oedipus:** From the dread Dragon's brood. The justest State

Lines 1590–1591

1590 **Oedipus:** But to the spot—the god within me goads—
1591 **Oedipus:** Let us set forth nor longer hesitate.

Lines 1610–1613

1610 **Chorus:** By a gentle, tearless doom
1611 **Chorus:** Speed this stranger to the gloom,
1612 **Chorus:** Let him enter without pain
1613 **Chorus:** The all-shrouding Stygian plain.

Lines 1614–1615

1614 **Chorus:** Wrongfully in life oppressed,

1615 **Chorus:** Be he now by Justice blessed.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tearless (adjective)	without tears; calm and free of grief	*By a gentle, tearless doom Speed this stranger to the gloom, Let him enter without pain The all-shrouding Stygian plain.*	

Discussion questions

1. How have the elders changed since the Parodos?
2. Where does allusion appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with refuge and hospitality?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What do the elders ask Justice to do? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Bless Oedipus now.
2. What do the elders pray for? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A gentle passing for Oedipus
3. How do the elders now describe Oedipus' life? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wrongfully oppressed
4. What does "Stygian" refer to? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The underworld (the river Styx)
5. How have the elders changed since the Parodos? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: From driving him away to praying for him
6. What is the tone of the prayer? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Gentle and reverent
7. Retell the three most important events of “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

8. Who is on stage in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”, and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.
10. In the passage that begins “Strophe If mortal prayers are heard in hell, Hear, Goddess dread, invisible!”, who is speaking or being described, and what do they say or do? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Literal paraphrase of the anchor passage.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why do the elders call Oedipus "wrongfully" oppressed? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: They now accept that he acted unknowingly.
2. What does “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)” suggest about a prayer for an easy death? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace.
3. Find one example of allusion in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
4. How does the tone / mood in this scene shape what we understand about a prayer for an easy death? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1610–1613. On tone / mood: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Strophe If mortal prayers are heard in hell, Hear, Goddess dread, invisible!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.
7. How does “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)” build on “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1614–1615. Theme link: a prayer for an easy death. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. Theme link: a prayer for an easy death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How have the elders changed since the Parodos?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with refuge and hospitality? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1610–1613. On theme: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Does the change in the Chorus show the play's view of Oedipus? Defend your view. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1614–1615. On theme: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1610–1613. Theme link: a prayer for an easy death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. You are directing “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”. Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of a prayer for an easy death. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1614–1615. Theme link: a prayer for an easy death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Write three questions of your own about “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
6. Connect this scene to guilt and intent: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1610–1613. On theme: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Is the allusion in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.9, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1614–1615. On allusion: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)" treats a prayer for an easy death with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: "If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, in this part of the section. On theme: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Predict what "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" will bring, using two clues from this scene. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1610–1613. Theme link: a prayer for an easy death. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a prayer for an easy death? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Useful evidence: "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1614–1615. On theme: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the speaker's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1340–1398? "So, by our _____ and familiar gods I pray thee, yield and hear"

   A. fountains

   B. children

   C. counsel

   D. brother

   Key: A (fountains)

2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1348–1354: "I have been banished from my native land Because by right of _____ I claimed possession of thy sovereign throne Wherefrom Eteocles, my younger brother, Ousted me, not by weight of precedent, Nor by the last arbitrament of war, But by his popular acts" Word bank: primogeniture, strangers, daughters, fountains
   Key: primogeniture
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1334–1335? "Let him not spurn, without a single word Of answer, me the _____ of the god."
   A. suppliance
   B. undertake
   C. suppliant
   D. ancestral

   Key: C (suppliant)
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1566–1567? "I must _____ thee, having found thee oft A prophet true; then speak what must be done."
   A. wished
   B. without
   C. stranger
   D. believe

   Key: D (believe)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), line 1540? "What solemn charge would'st thou _____ on him?"
   A. wished
   B. summon
   C. impress
   D. believe

   Key: C (impress)
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus: "If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, _____"
   Key: invisible
7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the tone of the prayer?
   A. Angry
   B. Comic
   C. Gentle and reverent
   D. Fearful

   Key: C (Gentle and reverent)
8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does "Stygian" refer to?
   A. A temple
   B. A city
   C. A mountain

D. The underworld (the river Styx)

Key: D (The underworld (the river Styx))

9. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus: “Wrongfully in life _____, / Be he now by Justice blessed”
   Key: oppressed
10. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1504–1505 reveal about the character or situation? “Or haply now we see fulfilled What fate long time hath willed?” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1504–1505) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “fulfilled” and “willed” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1568–1569 reveal about the character or situation? “O son of Aegeus, for this state will I Unfold a treasure age cannot corrupt.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1568–1569) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “treasure” and “corrupt” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.
12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”?
    A. Creon seizes the daughters
    B. The mysterious passing
    C. A prayer for an easy death
    D. "Not to be born"

    Key: C (A prayer for an easy death)
13. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why do the elders call Oedipus "wrongfully" oppressed?
    Sample answer: They now accept that he acted unknowingly. The evidence is “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1614–1615.
14. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1541–1542 shapes its tone: “For all his benefits I would perform The promise made when I received them first.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “received” and “benefits” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1541–1542) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
15. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1525–1526 shapes its tone: “Daughters, upon me the predestined end Has come; no turning from it any more.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “predestined” and “turning” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1525–1526) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Does the change in the Chorus show the play's view of Oedipus? Defend your view.
    Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “If mortal prayers are heard in

hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death. The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1401–1449: "And had not these my _____ tended me I had been dead for aught of aid from thee." Word bank: primogeniture, fountains, neglect, daughters
    Key: daughters

18. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1583–1584: "Thus shalt thou hold this land _____ From the dread Dragon's brood." Word bank: summon, inviolate, thunder, mysteries
    Key: inviolate

19. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1518–1524: "My _____ quails and cowers: my hair Bristles for fear." Word bank: sacrifice, pitying, believe, spirit
    Key: spirit

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders pray for?

    A. Victory in war

    B. Creon's death

    C. A gentle passing for Oedipus

    D. Rain

    Key: C (A gentle passing for Oedipus)

21. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1321 reveal about the character or situation? "All this too late I learn, wretch that I am, Alas!" Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1321) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words "wretch" are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

22. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1614–1615. The evidence is "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death.

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1610–1613. The evidence is "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus).

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1452 shapes its tone: "Woe worth my journey and my baffled hopes!" Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words "journey" and "baffled" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1452) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1394–1396 shapes its tone: “I’ll scatter with a breath the upstart’s might, And bring thee home again and stablish thee, And stablish, having cast him out, myself.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “stablish” and “scatter” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1394–1396) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”? The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

    A. Characterization
    B. Point of view
    C. Structure
    D. Tone / mood

    Key: D (Tone / mood)

27. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), line 1557 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “What, son of Laius, hath chanced of new?” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), line 1557) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “chanced” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “What sign assures thee that thine end is near?” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), line 1557), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1401–1449? “So I pray and call On the _____ gloom of Tartarus To snatch thee hence, on these dread goddesses I call, and Ares who incensed you both To mortal enmity.”

    A. ancestral
    B. daughters
    C. primogeniture
    D. suppliant

    Key: A (ancestral)

29. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How have the elders changed since the Parodos?

    A. From fear to anger
    B. From praise to blame
    C. They have not changed
    D. From driving him away to praying for him

    Key: D (From driving him away to praying for him)

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the elders now describe Oedipus' life?

    A. Lucky
    B. Royal
    C. Wicked
    D. Wrongfully oppressed

Key: D (Wrongfully oppressed)

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1422–1425 reveal about the character or situation? “Therefore just Heaven hath an eye on thee; Howbeit not yet with aspect so austere As thou shalt soon experience, if indeed These banded hosts are moving against Thebes.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
    Sample answer: The passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1422–1425) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “experience” and “against” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1336–1339 shapes its tone: “Tell him thyself, unhappy one, thine errand; For large discourse may send a thrill of joy, Or stir a chord of wrath or tenderness, And to the tongue-tied somehow give a tongue.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “tenderness” and “discourse” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1336–1339) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1364 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: “Why then, thou askest, am I here today?” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1364) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words “askest” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “For the king’s sake who sent him, Oedipus, Dismiss him not without a meet reply.” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1364), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

34. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1477–1478 shapes its tone: “O woe is me! but say, will any dare, Hearing his prophecy, to follow thee?” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “prophecy” and “follow” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1477–1478) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

35. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1572–1575 shapes its tone: “This secret ne’er reveal to mortal man, Neither the spot nor whereabouts it lies, So shall it ever serve thee for defense Better than native shields and near allies.” Pick two words and explain their effect.
    Sample answer: The words “whereabouts” and “shields” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1572–1575) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

36. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1448 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Go now proclaim What thou hast heard to the Cadmeians all, Thy staunch confederates—this the heritage That Oedipus divideth to his sons.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1448) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “confederates” and “heritage” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Never again would he have heard my voice; But now he shall obtain this parting grace, An answer that will bring him…”

(Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), line 1448), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

37. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus: "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-_____ Stygian plain"
    Key: shrouding

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1590–1591 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: "But to the spot—the god within me goads— Let us set forth nor longer hesitate." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1590–1591) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words "hesitate" and "within" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "Hither, this way, For this way Hermes leads, the spirit guide, And Persephassa, empress of the dead." (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1590–1591), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

39. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605) to Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625). Use one quotation from each.
    Sample answer: Earlier, in Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus, the text reads "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" — Chorus, lines 1508–1511. In Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1610–1613. A prayer for an easy death.

40. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in "If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death. The words "invisible" and "prayers" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

41. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Connect this passage from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1498–1501 to the story's treatment of death and blessing: "Nay, that rests with fate, Whether I live or die; but for you both I pray to heaven ye may escape all ill; For ye are blameless in the eyes of all." Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1498–1501) develops death and blessing: the story keeps returning to death and blessing. Its words "blameless" and "heaven" carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in "All this too late I learn, wretch that I am, Alas!" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1498–1501), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating death and blessing as central.

42. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), lines 1308–1309: "Father, methinks I see the stranger coming, Alone he comes and weeping _____ tears."
    Word bank: children, primogeniture, plenteous, undertake
    Key: plenteous

43. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1614–1615. The evidence is "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death. The words "oppressed" and "blessed" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

44. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), lines 1555–1556: "Thou com'st much _____ for, Prince, and sure some god Hath bid good luck attend thee on thy way." Word bank: without, heavenly, thunder, wished

    Key: wished

45. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? A prayer for an easy death.

    A. Curse and mercy

    B. Guilt and intent

    C. Law against force

    D. Refuge and hospitality

    Key: D (Refuge and hospitality)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 9, inference 4, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 17, 5, 4, 18, 19, 8, 20, 21, 11, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27	recall 8, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	17, 28, 5, 6, 29, 30, 21, 31, 11, 10, 13, 32, 25, 14, 33, 16	recall 6, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	28, 4, 19, 9, 30, 21, 11, 10, 12, 13, 24, 34, 14, 35, 36, 27	recall 5, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	28, 18, 5, 30, 37, 20, 11, 22, 13, 34, 32, 25, 35, 33, 38, 39	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	1, 3, 17, 9, 20, 30, 11, 24, 32, 15, 35, 40, 33, 41, 38, 16	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Freshman	2, 4, 20, 9, 30, 8, 13, 32, 25, 24, 35, 14, 33, 38, 39, 16	recall 6, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	28, 42, 9, 20, 30, 8, 25, 34, 24, 35, 14, 36, 27, 43, 16, 39	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
College Junior	44, 29, 9, 20, 30, 32, 24, 14, 35, 45, 33, 41, 36, 38, 16, 39	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	17, 9, 20, 30, 8, 29, 24, 14, 40, 41, 33, 36, 38, 39, 43, 16	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	42, 5, 9, 20, 30, 25, 35, 26, 41, 36, 33, 38, 27, 43, 16, 39	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 3, synthesis 8

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)," how does Sophocles show a prayer for an easy death? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): In Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), how does Sophocles develop the idea of a prayer for an easy death? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) develops the idea of a prayer for an easy death. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of a prayer for an easy death. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) suggests about a prayer for an easy death. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's allusion and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses allusion in Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) to complicate the reader's understanding of a prayer for an easy death. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of a prayer for an easy death responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of a prayer for an easy death follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–

1625) and its treatment of a prayer for an easy death. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's allusion and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) as evidence for a larger claim about a prayer for an easy death in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of a prayer for an easy death. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe If mortal prayers are heard in hell, Hear, Goddess dread, invisible! Monarch of the regions drear, Aidoneus, hear, O hear! By a gentle, tearless doom Speed this stranger to the gloom, Let him enter without pain The all-shrouding Stygian plain. Wrongfully in life oppressed, Be he now by Justice blessed. Antistrophe Queen infernal, and thou fell Watch-dog of the gates of hell, Who, as legends tell, dost glare, Gnarling in thy cavernous lair At all comers, let him go Scathless to the fields below. For thy master orders thus, The son of earth and Tartarus; In his den the monster keep, Giver of eternal sleep.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”?

   A. Creon seizes the daughters

   B. A prayer for an easy death

   C. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

   D. The beggar at the sacred grove

SAT key: 1. B (A prayer for an easy death)

Lesson 13: Exodos (lines 1626–1831)

Focus: the mysterious passing

Objective: Students will analyze how plot develops in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: Common Core RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1; L.9-10.4

Content note (suicide or self-harm (reported or spoken of)): Teacher note: some schools' guidelines may treat this passage differently. Cite method lines by number only.
Student preview: This section returns to grief and despair in the play.
Suggested language: "How do the others respond to this loss?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Background: The play ends where Antigone begins: Antigone returns to Thebes (line 1822).

Significance: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661).

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How can grief and love be present at the same time? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to refuge and hospitality because.... Content note before we start: This section returns to grief and despair in the play.
Prompt: How can grief and love be present at the same time?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to refuge and hospitality because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the mysterious passing.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · We do (10 min)
One key word in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tribulations — great troubles or suffering.
Words: tribulations: great troubles or suffering

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The play ends where Antigone begins: Antigone returns to Thebes (line 1822). The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Look closely: Teacher erratum note: line 1705 in the Standard Ebooks text reads and end; the app text now reads an end most marvellous, as in Storr's 1912 edition. Give the one-line reminder for the daughters' grief (lines 1734–1737, 1778–1782).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days." slowly and put it in my own words: The Messenger repeats Oedipus' farewell: his daughters will lose their father today, their long care for him is over, and one word, love, outweighs all their burdens. Next, craft. I notice the heavy load is set against a single word placed at the end of the line, love, which is then repeated. The strongest word is "love": his last word to his daughters. Then, effect. Why does Oedipus end his farewell with the word love? My answer: Oedipus ends his farewell with the word love because it is the one thing that repays his daughters' long service; the cursed king's last gift is not power or a curse but love.

> *My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days.* *(Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days." slowly and put it in my own words: The Messenger repeats Oedipus' farewell: his daughters will lose their father today, their long care for him is over, and one word, love, outweighs all their burdens. Next, craft. I notice the heavy load is set against a single word placed at the end of the line, love, which is then repeated. The strongest word is "love": his last word to his daughters. Then, effect. Why does Oedipus end his farewell with the word love? My answer: Oedipus ends his farewell with the word love because it is the one thing that repays his daughters' long service; the cursed king's last gift is not power or a curse but love.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The play ends where Antigone begins: Antigone returns to Thebes (line 1822). Read closely: "It was a messenger from heaven, or else Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; For without wailing or disease or pain He passed away—an end most marvellous." (Messenger, lines 1702–1705). Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality? Expected: The mysterious passing. (Messenger, lines 1702–1705.)

> *It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The play ends where Antigone begins: Antigone returns to Thebes (line 1822). Read closely: "It was a messenger from heaven, or else Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; For without wailing or disease or pain He passed away—an end most marvellous." (Messenger, lines 1702–1705).
Ask: How does this line connect to refuge and hospitality?
Expected answer: The mysterious passing. (Messenger, lines 1702–1705.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the scene for plot, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1626–1831) develops the idea of the mysterious passing. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). When the text says "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger), it shows this directly. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Task: Annotate the scene for plot, theme (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Exodos (lines 1626–1831) develops the idea of the mysterious passing. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). When the text says "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger), it shows this directly. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How can grief and love be present at the same time? Ask: How can grief and love be present at the same time?

Anchor question: How can grief and love be present at the same time?

Facilitation: Ask: How can grief and love be present at the same time?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Scene quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Scene quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). (“My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet”, Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this scene suggest about the mysterious passing? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). (“My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet”, Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the scene; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes the mysterious passing. Key takeaway: the mysterious passing.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.
- **Theme:** A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.
- **Characterization:** A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Themes and how they develop

- **refuge and hospitality:** the mysterious passing.

Symbols and motifs

- **the sacred grove and the hidden grave:** The section adds to the play's pattern of the sacred grove and the hidden grave: the mysterious passing.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) Messenger, lines 1657–1663.
- "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) Messenger, lines 1702–1705.
- "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone) Antigone, lines 1742–1743.
- "Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is ordered for the best" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Chorus) Chorus, lines 1830–1831.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661).
Evidence: "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger)
Reasoning: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

Passages referenced in this lesson (full text)

Lines 1610–1613
1610 **Chorus:** By a gentle, tearless doom
1611 **Chorus:** Speed this stranger to the gloom,
1612 **Chorus:** Let him enter without pain
1613 **Chorus:** The all-shrouding Stygian plain.

Lines 1626–1628
1626 **Messenger:** Friends, countrymen, my tidings are in sum
1627 **Messenger:** That Oedipus is gone, but the event
1628 **Messenger:** Was not so brief, nor can the tale be brief.

Lines 1657–1663
1657 **Messenger:** "My children, ye will lose your sire today,
1658 **Messenger:** For all of me has perished, and no more
1659 **Messenger:** Have ye to bear your long, long ministry;
1660 **Messenger:** A heavy load, I know, and yet one word
1661 **Messenger:** Wipes out all score of tribulations—love.
1662 **Messenger:** And love from me ye had—from no man more;
1663 **Messenger:** But now must live without me all your days."

Lines 1702–1705

1702 **Messenger:** It was a messenger from heaven, or else
1703 **Messenger:** Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base;
1704 **Messenger:** For without wailing or disease or pain
1705 **Messenger:** He passed away—an end most marvellous.

Line 1705

1705 **Messenger:** He passed away—an end most marvellous.

Lines 1711–1721

1711 **Antigone:** Woe, woe! on this sad day
1712 **Antigone:** We sisters of one blasted stock
1713 **Antigone:** Must bow beneath the shock,
1714 **Antigone:** Must weep and weep the curse that lay
1715 **Antigone:** On him our sire, for whom
1716 **Antigone:** In life, a life-long world of care
1717 **Antigone:** 'Twas ours to bear,
1718 **Antigone:** In death must face the gloom
1719 **Antigone:** That wraps his tomb.
1720 **Antigone:** What tongue can tell
1721 **Antigone:** That sight ineffable?

Lines 1725–1733

1725 **Antigone:** Gone as ye most might wish.
1726 **Antigone:** Not in battle or sea storm,
1727 **Antigone:** But reft from sight,
1728 **Antigone:** By hands invisible borne
1729 **Antigone:** To viewless fields of night.
1730 **Antigone:** Ah me! on us too night has come,
1731 **Antigone:** The night of mourning. Whither roam
1732 **Antigone:** O'er land or sea in our distress
1733 **Antigone:** Eating the bread of bitterness?

Lines 1730–1731

1730 **Antigone:** Ah me! on us too night has come,
1731 **Antigone:** The night of mourning. Whither roam

Lines 1742–1743

1742 **Antigone:** Love can turn past pain to bliss,
1743 **Antigone:** What seemed bitter now is sweet.

Line 1753

1753 **Antigone:** He died, so willed he, in a foreign land.

Lines 1753–1759

1753 **Antigone:** He died, so willed he, in a foreign land.

1754 **Antigone:** Lapped in kind earth he sleeps his long last sleep,
1755 **Antigone:** And o'er his grave friends weep.
1756 **Antigone:** How great our loss these streaming eyes can tell,
1757 **Antigone:** This sorrow naught can quell.
1758 **Antigone:** Thou hadst thy wish 'mid strangers thus to die,
1759 **Antigone:** But I, ah me, not by.

Lines 1779–1781
1779 **Ismene:** How shall I unhappy fare,
1780 **Ismene:** Friendless, helpless, how drag on
1781 **Ismene:** A life of misery alone?

Lines 1807–1808
1807 **Antigone:** With our own eyes we fain would see
1808 **Antigone:** Our father's tomb.

Lines 1811–1818
1811 **Theseus:** My children, he
1812 **Theseus:** Charged me straitly that no mortal
1813 **Theseus:** Should approach the sacred portal,
1814 **Theseus:** Or greet with funeral litanies
1815 **Theseus:** The hidden tomb wherein he lies;
1816 **Theseus:** Saying, "If thou keep'st my hest
1817 **Theseus:** Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest."
1818 **Theseus:** The God of Oaths this promise heard,

Lines 1811–1819
1811 **Theseus:** My children, he
1812 **Theseus:** Charged me straitly that no mortal
1813 **Theseus:** Should approach the sacred portal,
1814 **Theseus:** Or greet with funeral litanies
1815 **Theseus:** The hidden tomb wherein he lies;
1816 **Theseus:** Saying, "If thou keep'st my hest
1817 **Theseus:** Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest."
1818 **Theseus:** The God of Oaths this promise heard,
1819 **Theseus:** And to Zeus I pledged my word.

Lines 1830–1831
1830 **Chorus:** Wail no more, let sorrow rest,
1831 **Chorus:** All is ordered for the best.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

tribulations (noun)	great troubles or suffering	*A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love.*	

Discussion questions

1. How can grief and love be present at the same time?
2. Where does plot appear in this scene, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this scene connect to the book's larger concern with guilt and intent?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the Chorus say in the final lines? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Wail no more; all is ordered for the best.
2. Who alone saw Oedipus' passing? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Theseus
3. What one word, Oedipus says, wipes out his daughters' burdens? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Love
4. How does the messenger describe the end? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Without pain, most marvellous
5. What does Theseus refuse the daughters? [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: To show them the grave
6. Where does Antigone decide to go? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Back to Thebes
7. Retell the three most important events of "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.
8. Who is on stage in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)", and who speaks the most? Name two characters and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · Cold call with support: call on a student by name, offering a sentence starter or rephrasing if needed · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the scene; check against the teacher summary.
9. Where and when does "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the scene.

10. Reread: “A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love.” What does “tribulations” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · Turn and Talk: students discuss briefly with a neighbor before answering · wait 3 s · RL.9-10.1, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.1] Look for: tribulations: great troubles or suffering.

Inferential / analytical

1. Why does Theseus keep the grave secret? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: He promised Oedipus; the secret protects Athens.
2. What does “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)” suggest about the mysterious passing? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661).
3. Find one example of plot in this scene. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
4. How does the theme in this scene shape what we understand about the mysterious passing? [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribu” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1657–1663. On theme: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. In the passage that begins “Strophe 1 Woe, woe!”, why might Sophocles have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.4, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
6. What causes the main turn in “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.
7. How does “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)” build on “Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous scene.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: “It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth’s base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1702–1705. Theme link: the mysterious passing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say on stage here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: “Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1742–1743. On characterization: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. The bell-ringer asked: “How can grief and love be present at the same time?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 5 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
10. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this scene to the larger concern with guilt and intent? [DOK 3 · Follow-up: ask a probing question that builds on the previous answer · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: “Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is ordered for the best” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1830–1831. On characterization: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. Open question: is the ending happy, sad, or both? Defend any position. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Any defended position.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribu” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1657–1663. On theme: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. A critic might argue: “The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661).” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the scene. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: “It was a messenger from heaven, or else /

Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1702–1705. On theme: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Which character in this scene acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1742–1743. On characterization: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. You are directing "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)". Make two staging choices (a line delivery, a movement, a light or sound cue) and explain how each shapes the audience's view of the mysterious passing. [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is ordered for the best" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1830–1831. Theme link: the mysterious passing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Write three questions of your own about "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · Student-generated: students write and pose their own questions · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribu" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1657–1663. On theme: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Connect this scene to curse and mercy: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Sophocles need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—

an end most marvellous" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1702–1705. On theme: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Is the plot in this scene effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · Four Corners: students move to the corner that matches their position and explain why · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.3, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone): Antigone, lines 1742–1743. On plot: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Compare how "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)" treats the mysterious passing with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Oedipus at Colonus see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · Socratic circle: an inner circle discusses while the outer circle listens and takes notes, then they switch · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is ordered for the best" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Chorus): Chorus, lines 1830–1831. On theme: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. As the final scene, does this ending resolve guilt and intent? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.5, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribu" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1657–1663. Theme link: the mysterious passing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this scene (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the mysterious passing? [DOK 4 · Think-Pair-Share: students think alone, discuss with a partner, then share with the class · wait 8 s · RL.9-10.2, SL.9-10.1, RL.11-12.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Useful evidence: "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger): Messenger, lines 1702–1705. On theme: A

messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who alone saw Oedipus' passing?

   A. Ismene
   B. Antigone
   C. The messenger
   D. Theseus

   Key: D (Theseus)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What one word, Oedipus says, wipes out his daughters' burdens?

   A. Love
   B. Fate
   C. Duty
   D. Honour

   Key: A (Love)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Chorus: "Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is _____ for the best"

   Key: ordered

4. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger: "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most _____"

   Key: marvellous

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of _____—love." Word bank: tribulations

   Key: tribulations

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone: "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What _____ bitter now is sweet"

   Key: seemed

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Where does Antigone decide to go?

   A. To Corinth
   B. Back to Thebes
   C. To Delphi
   D. To stay in Athens forever

Key: B (Back to Thebes)

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does the messenger describe the end?
   A. Violent and cruel
   B. Unknown even to Theseus
   C. Without pain, most marvellous
   D. In battle

   Key: C (Without pain, most marvellous)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus refuse the daughters?
   A. His protection
   B. A guard
   C. To show them the grave
   D. Food and shelter

   Key: C (To show them the grave)

10. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does the Chorus say in the final lines?
    Sample answer: Wail no more; all is ordered for the best.

11. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Theseus keep the grave secret?
    Sample answer: He promised Oedipus; the secret protects Athens. The evidence is "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) — Messenger, lines 1702–1705.

12. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)"?
    A. The mysterious passing
    B. The daughters return; a suppliant son
    C. The rescue imagined
    D. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

    Key: A (The mysterious passing)

13. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The mysterious passing.
    A. Curse and mercy
    B. Refuge and hospitality
    C. Guilt and intent
    D. Law against force

    Key: B (Refuge and hospitality)

14. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Open question: is the ending happy, sad, or both? Defend any position.
    Sample answer: Any defended position: Chorus, lines 1830–1831. The evidence is "Wail no more, let sorrow rest, / All is ordered for the best" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

15. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Messenger, lines 1657–1663. The evidence is "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger). This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing. The words "tribulations" and "ministry" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is 'love' (line 1661)." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) supports it: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. But "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous." (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) complicates it: the line (Messenger, lines 1702–1705) shows the same issue from another side, and its "without" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger: "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of _____ —love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days"
    Key: tribulations
18. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)"? A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.
    A. Irony
    B. Hyperbole
    C. Personification
    D. Plot

    Key: D (Plot)
19. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
    Sample answer: Messenger, lines 1702–1705. The evidence is "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger).

This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing. The words “marvellous” and “messenger” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Which word completes this sentence from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1807–1808? “With our own eyes we fain would see Our _____’s tomb.”

    A. father

    B. friends

    C. daughters

    D. countrymen

    Key: A (father)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1753–1759: “Thou hadst thy wish ’mid _____ thus to die, But I, ah me, not by.” Word bank: desperate, strangers, attendant, countrymen

    Key: strangers

22. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which of these passages comes earliest in Exodos (lines 1626–1831)?

    A. “Not in battle or sea storm, But reft from sight, By hands invisible borne To viewless fields of night.”

    B. “Whither roam O’er land or sea in our distress Eating the bread of bitterness?”

    C. “O that Death Might nip my breath, And let me share my aged father’s fate.”

    D. “Ah me! on us too night has come, The night of mourning.”

    Key: A (“Not in battle or sea storm, But reft from sight, By hands invisible borne To viewless fields of night.”)

23. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What does this passage from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), line 1753 reveal about the character or situation? “He died, so willed he, in a foreign land.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), line 1753) shows the situation turning on refuge and hospitality: the story keeps returning to refuge and hospitality. The words “foreign” and “willed” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

24. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1779–1781 shapes its tone: “How shall I unhappy fare, Friendless, helpless, how drag on A life of misery alone?” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “helpless” and “unhappy” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1779–1781) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to law against force: the story keeps returning to law against force. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Connect this passage from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1730–1731 to the story's treatment of curse and mercy: “Strophe 1 Woe, woe! on this sad day We sisters of one blasted stock Must bow beneath the shock, Must weep and weep the curse that lay On him our sire, for whom In life, a life-long world of care ’Twas ours to bear, In death must face the…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1730–1731) develops curse and mercy: the story keeps returning to curse and mercy. Its words “sisters” and “beneath” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns

in “Ah me! on us too night has come, The night of mourning.” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1730–1731), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating curse and mercy as central.

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1626–1628: “Friends, _____, my tidings are in sum That Oedipus is gone, but the event Was not so brief, nor can the tale be brief.” Word bank: countrymen, desperate, strangers, bitterness

    Key: countrymen

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.11-12.4] Which word completes this sentence from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1725–1733? “Whither roam O’er land or sea in our distress Eating the bread of _____?”

    A. daughters

    B. bitterness

    C. therefore

    D. brothers

    Key: B (bitterness)

28. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1811–1818 shapes its tone: “My children, he Charged me straitly that no mortal Should approach the sacred portal, Or greet with funeral litanies The hidden tomb wherein he lies; Saying, ‘If thou keep’st my hest Thou shalt hold thy realm at rest.’ The God of Oaths…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “straitly” and “children” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), lines 1811–1818) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to guilt and intent: the story keeps returning to guilt and intent. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

29. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger).

    Sample answer: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. The evidence is “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) — Messenger, lines 1657–1663. This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing.

30. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625) to Exodos (lines 1626–1831). Use one quotation from each.

    Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus, the text reads “By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain” — Chorus, lines 1610–1613. In Exodos (lines 1626–1831), “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) — Messenger, lines 1657–1663. The mysterious passing.

31. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth’s base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Messenger, lines 1702–1705. The evidence is "It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger).

32. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Antigone, lines 1742–1743. The evidence is "Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone). This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing. The words "bitter" and "seemed" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

33. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] In the line "A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love.", what does "tribulations" most nearly mean?

    A. able to be touched or felt

    B. great troubles or suffering

    C. (concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers

    D. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

    Key: B (great troubles or suffering)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 1, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	2, 3, 17, 7, 1, 5, 6, 8, 10, 9, 11, 18, 13, 14, 19, 16	recall 10, inference 1, analysis 2, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	20, 4, 17, 10, 9, 21, 5, 8, 22, 23, 11, 13, 24, 18, 16, 25	recall 8, inference 3, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	26, 9, 21, 27, 8, 6, 1, 11, 23, 22, 24, 28, 18, 29, 16, 14	recall 7, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	27, 1, 26, 21, 2, 6, 22, 11, 23, 28, 13, 18, 24, 25, 16, 30	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	17, 7, 27, 26, 31, 11, 23, 22, 12, 28, 13, 24, 16, 14, 30, 25	recall 4, inference 5, analysis 3, synthesis 4
College Freshman	5, 3, 1, 31, 23, 12, 22, 11, 24, 28, 32, 13, 14, 16, 30, 25	recall 3, inference 5, analysis 4, synthesis 4
College Sophomore	5, 9, 3, 23, 11, 22, 12, 24, 28, 13, 29, 32, 30, 14, 16, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 5, synthesis 4
College Junior	1, 5, 3, 22, 11, 28, 18, 32, 13, 24, 16, 30, 25, 14, 19, 15	recall 3, inference 2, analysis 5, synthesis 6
College Senior	5, 20, 21, 12, 22, 23, 11, 28, 24, 13, 32, 16, 30, 14, 19, 25	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 4, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	3, 17, 9, 33, 23, 22, 11, 24, 28, 13, 18, 32, 25, 30, 16, 14	recall 4, inference 3, analysis 5, synthesis 4

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)," how does Sophocles show the mysterious passing?

Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): In Exodos (lines 1626–1831), how does Sophocles develop the idea of the mysterious passing? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the scene helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3; W.9-10.1): Analyze how Exodos (lines 1626–1831) develops the idea of the mysterious passing. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5; RL.11-12.1; W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Exodos (lines 1626–1831) (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of the mysterious passing. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Exodos (lines 1626–1831) suggests about the mysterious passing. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the scene's plot and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3; W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Sophocles uses plot in Exodos (lines 1626–1831) to complicate the reader's understanding of the mysterious passing. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Situate Exodos (lines 1626–1831) within its historical and literary context and argue how the scene's treatment of the mysterious passing responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Read Exodos (lines 1626–1831) alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the scene's handling of the mysterious passing follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Exodos (lines 1626–1831) and its treatment of the mysterious passing. State your method, show what it reveals in the scene's plot and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop a research argument that reads Exodos (lines 1626–1831) as evidence for a larger claim about the mysterious passing in Oedipus at Colonus. Connect close reading of the scene to the whole play, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Develop an original argument that reads Exodos (lines 1626–1831) as a hinge in the play's larger treatment of the mysterious passing. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Oedipus at Colonus.

SAT-style questions

1. *Strophe 1 Woe, woe! on this sad day We sisters of one blasted stock Must bow beneath the shock, Must weep and weep the curse that lay On him our sire, for whom In life, a life-long world of care 'Twas ours to bear, In death must face the gloom That wraps his tomb. What tongue can tell That sight ineffable?*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)"?

   A. The mysterious passing

   B. The elders' fear

   C. "Not to be born"

   D. The beggar at the sacred grove

SAT key: 1. A (The mysterious passing)

Unit test

Oedipus at Colonus: unit test · 90 minutes · 50 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Then may they show their suppliant grace, for I From this your sanctuary will ne’er depart.”, what does “suppliant” most nearly mean?
   A. able to be touched or felt
   B. speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority
   C. a disaster causing great distress
   D. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

   Key: D (a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar)
2. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus: “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we _____”

   Key: reached
3. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus: “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A _____ to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse”

   Key: blessing
4. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line “Who will provide today with scanted dole / This wanderer? ’Tis little that he craves,”, what does “wanderer” most nearly mean?
   A. great troubles or suffering
   B. a disaster causing great distress
   C. able to be touched or felt
   D. a person who travels without a settled home

   Key: D (a person who travels without a settled home)
5. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why do the elders fear Oedipus?
   A. He is a spy
   B. He is armed
   C. His name and story are known and feared
   D. He carries plague

   Key: C (His name and story are known and feared)

6. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Heaven's justice never smites Him who ill with ill _____." Word bank: perdition, requites

   Key: requites

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, Who 'scapes _____ if a god impel!" Word bank: requites, perdition

   Key: perdition

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "The State around An all unwitting bridegroom bound An impious marriage chain; That was my bane.", what does "impious" most nearly mean?

   A. lacking respect for the gods or for duty

   B. (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force

   C. ruin; in religion, eternal punishment

   D. followers who obey a leader without question

   Key: A (lacking respect for the gods or for duty)

9. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What can neither youth nor age destroy?

   Sample answer: The olive tree.

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What tree does the ode celebrate?

    A. The oak

    B. The laurel

    C. The cypress

    D. The olive

    Key: D (The olive)

11. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off", what does "freebooter" most nearly mean?

    A. ruin; in religion, eternal punishment

    B. a person who humbly begs for help, especially at an altar

    C. a pirate or plunderer

    D. speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority

    Key: C (a pirate or plunderer)

12. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon: "Command your _____; I am not your slave"

    Key: minions

13. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Secrecy's golden key / By their own acolytes,", what does "acolytes" most nearly mean?

    A. a pirate or plunderer

    B. lacking respect for the gods or for duty

    C. assistants in religious rites

    D. a person who travels without a settled home

    Key: C (assistants in religious rites)

14. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Which troubles does the ode list?

    A. Love and marriage

B. Envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war

C. Feasts and dances

D. Wealth and fame

Key: B (Envy, sedition, strife, carnage and war)

15. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus: "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear _____'s whelming tide, / By every wind of heaven o'erborne / Some from the sunset, some from orient…"
Key: misfortune

16. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some _____ on an iron-bound shore," Word bank: headland, sedition
Key: headland

17. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What stage of life does the ode call the worst?

A. Childhood

B. Old age

C. Youth

D. Marriage

Key: B (Old age)

18. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who sings this ode?

A. Oedipus

B. Theseus

C. The elders of Colonus

D. Antigone

Key: C (The elders of Colonus)

19. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] To what is Oedipus compared?

A. A hunted bull

B. A tree in flood

C. A ship at harbour

D. A headland battered by storms

Key: D (A headland battered by storms)

20. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "Envy, sedition, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life.", what does "sedition" most nearly mean?

A. able to be touched or felt

B. a pirate or plunderer

C. speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority

D. repays, especially a wrong with a wrong

Key: C (speech or action that stirs rebellion against authority)

21. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices: "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy,

father, also sit _____ / In thy heart likewise"

Key: enthroned

22. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus: "O light, no light to me, but mine _____, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades"

Key: erewhile

23. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders pray for?

A. Victory in war

B. Creon's death

C. A gentle passing for Oedipus

D. Rain

Key: C (A gentle passing for Oedipus)

24. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What do the elders ask Justice to do?

Sample answer: Bless Oedipus now.

25. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How have the elders changed since the Parodos?

A. From fear to anger

B. From praise to blame

C. They have not changed

D. From driving him away to praying for him

Key: D (From driving him away to praying for him)

26. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus: "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-_____ Stygian plain"

Key: shrouding

27. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How do the elders now describe Oedipus' life?

A. Lucky

B. Royal

C. Wicked

D. Wrongfully oppressed

Key: D (Wrongfully oppressed)

28. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love.", what does "tribulations" most nearly mean?

A. a disaster causing great distress

B. able to be touched or felt

C. great troubles or suffering

D. ruin; in religion, eternal punishment

Key: C (great troubles or suffering)

29. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger: "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of _____

—love. / And love from me ye had—from no man more; / But now must live without me all your days"

Key: tribulations

30. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus)

    A. Her judgment follows her feelings.

    B. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    C. The quiet opening after the storm.

    D. The chant; trochaic rhythm.

    Key: B (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

31. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Parodos (lines 115–248)"?

    A. The rescue imagined

    B. The elders' fear

    C. The Colonus ode

    D. A prayer for an easy death

    Key: B (The elders' fear)

32. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; / Nor youth nor…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 720–728. The evidence is "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, /…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus).

33. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 816–818. The evidence is "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus).

34. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)"?

    A. "Not to be born"

    B. Creon seizes the daughters

    C. The beggar at the sacred grove

    D. The elders' fear

    Key: B (Creon seizes the daughters)

35. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? "O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus)

    A. The opening question: a world of storm and repetition.

    B. The scene opens with the letter she asked for.

    C. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    D. He shuts her out.

Key: C (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

36. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “A wise man heeds all matters great or small” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Theseus, lines 1210. The evidence is “A wise man heeds all matters great or small” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] What does this passage most clearly show? “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus)

    A. His education; each book shapes him.

    B. Her vanity in the title.

    C. The play's best-known statement on hypocrisy.

    D. Chorus, in this part of the section.

    Key: D (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

38. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”?

    A. The Colonus ode

    B. Polyneices and the father's curse

    C. The elders' fear

    D. "Not to be born"

    Key: D ("Not to be born")

39. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1508–1511. The evidence is “Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus).

40. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)”?

    A. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

    B. The daughters return; a suppliant son

    C. "Not to be born"

    D. The summons

    Key: D (The summons)

41. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth’s base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Messenger, lines 1702–1705. The evidence is “It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth’s base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger).

42. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The elders' fear.

    A. Curse and mercy

B. Law against force

C. Refuge and hospitality

D. Guilt and intent

Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

43. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus).

Sample answer: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. The evidence is “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 261–263. This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

44. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state "that champions right" (line 957). Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou…” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus).

Sample answer: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. The evidence is “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land,…” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus) — Theseus, lines 956–963. This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters.

45. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? ‘Not to be born’.

A. Refuge and hospitality

B. Guilt and intent

C. Law against force

D. Curse and mercy

Key: A (Refuge and hospitality)

46. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Polyneices, lines 1479–1480. The evidence is “I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports successes and conceals mishaps” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices). This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse. The words “successes” and “conceals” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

47. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? A prayer for an easy death.

A. Curse and mercy

B. Guilt and intent

C. Law against force

D. Refuge and hospitality

Key: D (Refuge and hospitality)

48. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from the opening of "Prologue (lines 1–114)" to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.
Sample answer: Near the start, "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–2. Later, "There,' said he, 'shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth,…" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 91–93. The beggar at the sacred grove.

49. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269) to Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307). Use one quotation from each.
Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus, the text reads "They only who have known calamity / Can share it" — Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. In Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1284–1287. "Not to be born".

50. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Is Oedipus just or cruel to Polyneices? Defend your view with evidence.
Sample answer: A defended position: Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. The evidence is "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

51. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What will Oedipus be to the land that cast him out?

A. A king

B. A curse

C. A guest

D. A blessing

Key: B (A curse)

52. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Who will provide today with scanted dole / This _____? 'Tis little that he craves," Word bank: wanderer, suppliant, hospitality
Key: wanderer

53. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who guides the blind Oedipus?

A. Creon

B. Antigone

C. Theseus

D. Ismene

Key: B (Antigone)

54. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] In the line "He appeals to the world-famed hospitality of Athens and hints at the blessings that his coming will confer on the State.", what does "hospitality" most nearly mean?

    A. repays, especially a wrong with a wrong

    B. (concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers

    C. a pirate or plunderer

    D. (archaic) one who carries off or assaults a woman by force

    Key: B ((concept) welcome and care given to guests and strangers)

55. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Who pleads for Oedipus?

    A. Polyneices

    B. Theseus

    C. Ismene

    D. Antigone

    Key: D (Antigone)

56. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus send his men to do?

    A. Arrest Oedipus

    B. Burn the grove

    C. Rescue the daughters

    D. Attack Thebes

    Key: C (Rescue the daughters)

57. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "Envy, _____, strife, Carnage and war, make up the tale of life." Word bank: headland, sedition

    Key: sedition

58. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus: "Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the _____ way"

    Key: backward

59. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] According to the lesson, how should the ode be read?

    A. As a prophecy

    B. As a joke

    C. As a song of grief from old men, open to debate against the ending

    D. As advice for living

    Key: C (As a song of grief from old men, open to debate against the ending)

60. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, Now the last time I feel thee _____, For I am drawing near the final gloom Of Hades." Word bank: palpable

    Key: palpable

61. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is the tone of the prayer?

    A. Angry

    B. Comic

C. Gentle and reverent

D. Fearful

Key: C (Gentle and reverent)

62. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus: “Wrongfully in life _____, / Be he now by Justice blessed”

Key: oppressed

63. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus: “If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, _____”

Key: invisible

64. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why does Creon pretend friendship at first?

Sample answer: He hopes to persuade Oedipus before using force. The evidence is “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 816–818.

65. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1106–1111. The evidence is “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus).

66. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. The evidence is “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices).

67. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. The evidence is “They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus).

68. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. The evidence is “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons.

69. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Why do the elders call Oedipus "wrongfully" oppressed?

Sample answer: They now accept that he acted unknowingly. The evidence is “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1614–1615.

70. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Prologue (lines 1–114)”? Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts…

A. Symbolism

B. Tone / mood

C. Imagery

D. Characterization

Key: D (Characterization)

71. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

A. Law against force

B. Curse and mercy

C. Refuge and hospitality

D. Guilt and intent

Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

72. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Creon seizes the daughters.

A. Guilt and intent

B. Refuge and hospitality

C. Curse and mercy

D. Law against force

Key: B (Refuge and hospitality)

73. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] Which literary element does this describe in “Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)”? Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls…

A. Characterization

B. Metaphor

C. Simile

D. Imagery

Key: A (Characterization)

74. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “Who craves excess of days, / Scorning the common span” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The words “craves” and “common” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

75. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in “Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Antigone, lines 1742–1743. The evidence is “Love can turn past pain to bliss, / What seemed bitter now is sweet” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Antigone). This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing. The words “bitter” and “seemed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

76. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 74. The evidence is “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. The words “instinct” and “sight” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

77. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Open question: does the play agree with this ode? Defend any position with evidence.

    Sample answer: Any defended position: Chorus, lines 1284–1287. The evidence is “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

78. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1614–1615. The evidence is “Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death. The words “oppressed” and “blessed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

79. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: L.9-10.4] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “Then may they show their _____ grace, for I From this your sanctuary will ne’er depart.” Word bank: suppliant, hospitality, wanderer

    Key: suppliant

80. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What is ironic about "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight"?

    A. The blind man claims a kind of sight the seeing lack

    B. He is not really blind

    C. He is quoting Teiresias by mistake

    D. He is joking about his eyes

    Key: A (The blind man claims a kind of sight the seeing lack)

81. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why must Oedipus leave his seat, according to the stranger?

    A. It is a market

    B. It is holy ground

    C. It belongs to Creon

    D. It is a battlefield

    Key: B (It is holy ground)

82. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Theseus call Creon's behaviour?

    A. Like a fair trade

    B. Like a king's duty

C. Like a priest's rite

D. Like a freebooter carrying off plunder

Key: D (Like a freebooter carrying off plunder)

83. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] From which directions do the winds strike the headland?

Sample answer: From every side: sunset, morning, noon and the north.

84. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus: "Who _____ excess of days, / Scorning the common span"

Key: craves

85. [short · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Whom does Polyneices say sits beside Zeus' throne?

Sample answer: Mercy.

86. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Why will Polyneices not tell his army of the curse?

A. He has forgotten it

B. A good general hides mishaps

C. Theseus forbade him

D. He does not believe in curses

Key: B (A good general hides mishaps)

87. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Polyneices ask of his father?

A. Pardon and help in his war on Thebes

B. Antigone's hand in marriage

C. Money for the journey

D. A place to live in Athens

Key: A (Pardon and help in his war on Thebes)

88. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What does Polyneices ask his sisters?

A. To kill Creon

B. To bury him if the curse comes true

C. To forget him

D. To come to Argos

Key: B (To bury him if the curse comes true)

89. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus: "They tend me, they _____ me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine"

Key: preserve

90. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Antigone: "Misguided youth, thy _____ then stands fast"

Key: purpose

91. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] How does Oedipus answer?

A. He sends Theseus

B. He blesses him

C. He joins his army

D. He curses him

Key: D (He curses him)

92. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.9-10.1] What will protect Athens, according to Oedipus?

    A. A wall

    B. The secret of his resting place, passed to Theseus' heir

    C. A new temple

    D. An alliance with Thebes

    Key: B (The secret of his resting place, passed to Theseus' heir)

93. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Creon, lines 869. The evidence is "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters.

94. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1614–1615. The evidence is "Wrongfully in life oppressed, / Be he now by Justice blessed" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death.

95. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.3] What can you infer from this line? "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Messenger, lines 1657–1663. The evidence is "My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy…" (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger).

96. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Exodos (lines 1626–1831)"?

    A. The mysterious passing

    B. The daughters return; a suppliant son

    C. The rescue imagined

    D. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

    Key: A (The mysterious passing)

97. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is "Ha! Where is he? Look around! / Every nook and corner scan" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear. The words "corner" and "around" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

98. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Analyze the word choice in "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some freebooter art carrying off / What plunder pleases thee, as if forsooth / Thou…" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

    Sample answer: Theseus, lines 956–963. The evidence is "Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land,…" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus). This

develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters. The words “freebooter” and “thoughtest” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

99. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)”? The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

    A. Simile

    B. Allusion

    C. Tone / mood

    D. Alliteration

    Key: C (Tone / mood)

100. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Claim: The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices).

    Sample answer: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. The evidence is “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) — Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse.

101. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.9-10.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)”? Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

    A. Alliteration

    B. Point of view

    C. Irony

    D. Tone / mood

    Key: C (Irony)

102. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) supports it: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. But “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 91–93) shows the same issue from another side, and its “But” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

103. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1284–1287. The evidence is “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best,

when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The words "backward" and "befall" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

104. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1298–1306. The evidence is "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born". The words "misfortune" and "headland" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

105. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1419–1421. The evidence is "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Polyneices and the father's curse. The words "bastards" and "preserve" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone.

106. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.9-10.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The curse makes a family's past its future. Polyneices' burial request is the seed of Antigone." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

    Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) supports it: Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true, which sets up Antigone. But "They tend me, they preserve me, they are men / Not women in true service to their sire; / But ye are bastards, and no sons of mine" (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 1419–1421) shows the same issue from another side, and its "Not" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

107. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] What did Apollo foretell about this place?

    A. Thebes would be destroyed tomorrow

    B. Oedipus would become king of Athens

    C. Oedipus would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts

    D. Oedipus would regain his sight

    Key: C (Oedipus would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts)

108. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices: "I shall not tell it; a good general / Reports _____ and conceals mishaps"
Key: successes

109. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus: "Time with never _____ eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate"
Key: sleeping

110. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 695–698. The evidence is "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus).

111. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why place a hymn of praise right after Theseus' welcome?
Sample answer: It celebrates the city that has just shown hospitality. The evidence is "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 695–698.

112. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)"?

A. The rescue imagined
B. The daughters return; a suppliant son
C. The beggar at the sacred grove
D. Polyneices and the father's curse

Key: B (The daughters return; a suppliant son)

113. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge's roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune's whelming tide, / By every wind…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1298–1306. The evidence is "Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E'en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and…" (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus).

114. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The Colonus ode.

A. Curse and mercy
B. Law against force
C. Refuge and hospitality
D. Guilt and intent

Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

115. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The rescue imagined.

A. Curse and mercy
B. Guilt and intent
C. Refuge and hospitality

D. Law against force

Key: C (Refuge and hospitality)

116. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The daughters return; a suppliant son.

A. Curse and mercy

B. Law against force

C. Guilt and intent

D. Refuge and hospitality

Key: D (Refuge and hospitality)

117. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: The blind man leads the seeing. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus).

Sample answer: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. The evidence is "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1508–1511. This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons.

118. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Which literary element does this describe in "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)"? The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

A. Characterization

B. Point of view

C. Structure

D. Tone / mood

Key: D (Tone / mood)

119. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The mysterious passing.

A. Curse and mercy

B. Refuge and hospitality

C. Guilt and intent

D. Law against force

Key: B (Refuge and hospitality)

120. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Oedipus a helpless beggar or a man in control in the Prologue? Defend your view.

Sample answer: A defended position: Oedipus, lines 74. The evidence is "The blind man's words will be instinct with sight" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

121. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The rule of law against force: Theseus defends Athens as a state 'that champions right' (line 957)." Is it fully persuasive?

Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Having come / Unto a State that champions right and asks / For every action warranty of law, / Thou hast set aside the custom of the land, / And like some…” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Theseus) supports it: Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly. But “Howbeit, I know I waste my words— begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 816–818) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. The claim is therefore a strong reading, not a complete one, and a careful answer says where it stops applying.

122. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307) to Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus, the text reads “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” — Chorus, lines 1284–1287. In Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) — Polyneices, lines 1324–1327. Polyneices and the father's curse.

123. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Complete the quotation from Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus: “The blind man’s words will be _____ with sight”

Key: instinct

124. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Common Core: RL.11-12.1] Which play continues this story?

A. Oedipus Rex

B. The Odyssey

C. Medea

D. Antigone

Key: D (Antigone)

125. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 261–263. The evidence is “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus).

126. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth, a curse” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 91–93. The evidence is “There,’ said he, ‘shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell’st, / But to the land that cast thee forth,…” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. The words “blessing” and “wherein” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

127. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The

words “nightingale” and “voiced” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

128. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “O when the flying foe, / Turning at last to bay” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The words “flying” and “last” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

129. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: They see it all with their minds, like the blind Oedipus. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus).

Sample answer: The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory. The evidence is “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1106–1111. This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined.

130. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? Polyneices and the father's curse.

A. Death and blessing

B. Refuge and hospitality

C. Law against force

D. Guilt and intent

Key: B (Refuge and hospitality)

131. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Are the elders right to fear Oedipus? Defend your view with evidence.

Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 222–223. The evidence is “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

132. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Parodos (lines 115–248) to Episode 1 (lines 249–694). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus, the text reads “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” — Chorus, lines 222–223. In Episode 1 (lines 249–694), “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 261–263. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

133. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739) to Episode 2 (lines 740–1091). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus, the text reads “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening…” — Chorus, lines 695–698. In Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content” (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 816–818. Creon seizes the daughters.

134. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Theseus, lines 1210. The evidence is "A wise man heeds all matters great or small" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Theseus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son. The words "matters" and "small" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

135. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Open question: is Oedipus' passing a reward, a mystery, or both? Defend any position.

Sample answer: Any defended position: Chorus, lines 1508–1511. The evidence is "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

136. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] What can you infer from this line? "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–2. The evidence is "Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove.

137. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.3] Why does Oedipus refuse to leave the grove?

Sample answer: He recognizes it as the resting place Apollo foretold. The evidence is "There,' said he, 'shalt thou round thy weary life, / A blessing to the land wherein thou dwell'st, / But to the land that cast thee forth,…" (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 91–93.

138. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which choice best states a central concern of "Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)"?

A. A prayer for an easy death

B. The summons

C. Creon seizes the daughters

D. "Not to be born"

Key: A (A prayer for an easy death)

139. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] In this scene, which theme does the following most directly develop? The beggar at the sacred grove.

A. Guilt and intent

B. Curse and mercy

C. Law against force

D. Refuge and hospitality

Key: D (Refuge and hospitality)

140. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: A name alone condemns him: his story travels ahead of him. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: "Where will you find one, search ye ne'er so well, / Who 'scapes perdition if a god impel" (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone).

Sample answer: The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone

pleads for him. The evidence is “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone) — Antigone, lines 243–244. This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear.

141. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Analyze the word choice in “The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Ismene, lines 394. The evidence is “The gods, who once abased, uplift thee now” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Ismene). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. The words “uplift” and “abased” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

142. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Claim: Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus).
Sample answer: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. The evidence is “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1195–1196. This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son.

143. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Which literary element does this describe in “Exodos (lines 1626–1831)”? A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

A. Structure

B. Foreshadowing

C. Theme

D. Personification

Key: C (Theme)

144. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Chorus, lines 222–223. The evidence is “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear. The words “requites” and “justice” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

145. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The outcast becomes a treasure. Theseus' welcome reverses the expulsion from Thebes.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.
Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) supports it: Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection. But “I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in foreign lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus) complicates it: the line (Theseus, lines 583–585) shows the same issue from another side, and its “no” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

146. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 695–698. The evidence is "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The words "glistening" and "goodliest" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

147. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, / Self-nurtured year by year; / 'Tis the grey-leaved olive that feeds our boys; / Nor youth nor…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 720–728. The evidence is "And here there grows, unpruned, untamed, / Terror to foemen's spear, / A tree in Asian soil unnamed, / By Pelops' Dorian isle unclaimed, /…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The words "unclaimed" and "withering" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

148. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 816–818. The evidence is "Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate'er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters. The words "content" and "withal" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

149. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1134–1137. The evidence is "O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The words "upwards" and "clouds" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

150. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Does the ode make Theseus a hero? Defend your view.

Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 1106–1111. The evidence is "There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…" (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–

1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

151. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Is Antigone right that a father cannot repay a son in kind? Defend your view.

Sample answer: A defended position: Antigone, lines 1248–1249. The evidence is "Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son's most impious outrages" (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone). This develops refuge and hospitality: the daughters return; a suppliant son. Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen.

152. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1508–1511. The evidence is "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. The words "sleeping" and "estate" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

153. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.2] Evaluate this claim about the scene: "The blind man leads the seeing." Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. "Time with never sleeping eye / Watches what is writ on high, / Overthrowing now the great, / Raising now from low estate" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Chorus) supports it: Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens. But "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) complicates it: the line (Oedipus, lines 1599–1602) shows the same issue from another side, and its "no" marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. A fair verdict is that the claim is mostly right but overstated; it needs a limiting clause to cover that passage.

154. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Common Core: RL.11-12.4] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1610–1613. The evidence is "By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death. The words "shrouding" and "tearless" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain.

155. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which choice best states a central concern of "Prologue (lines 1–114)"?

A. Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome

B. The mysterious passing

C. The beggar at the sacred grove

D. Polyneices and the father's curse

Key: C (The beggar at the sacred grove)

156. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 222–223. The evidence is “Heaven’s justice never smites / Him who ill with ill requites” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear.

157. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from the clouds above” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1134–1137. The evidence is “O for the wings, the wings of a dove, / To be borne with the speed of the gale, / Up and still upwards to sail / And gaze on the fray from…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus).

158. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] What can you infer from this line? “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1284–1287. The evidence is “Not to be born at all / Is best, far best that can befall, / Next best, when born, with least delay / To trace the backward way” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus).

159. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Which literary element does this describe in “Parodos (lines 115–248)”? The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

A. Allusion

B. Conflict

C. Diction / vocabulary

D. Simile

Key: B (Conflict)

160. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Howbeit, I know I waste my words—begone, / And leave me here; whate’er may be my lot, / He lives not ill who lives withal content”

A. Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)

B. Prologue (lines 1–114)

C. Episode 2 (lines 740–1091)

D. Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)

Key: C (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091))

161. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “They only who have known calamity / Can share it”

A. Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269)

B. Prologue (lines 1–114)

C. Episode 1 (lines 249–694)

D. Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)

Key: A (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269))

162. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Claim: The most famous expression of despair in Greek tragedy, framed by a play that does not end in despair. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and surge’s roar, / So is he buffeted on every side / By drear misfortune’s whelming tide, / By every wind…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus).
Sample answer: The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side. The evidence is “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1298–1306. This develops refuge and hospitality: "Not to be born".

163. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Analyze the word choice in “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1599–1602. The evidence is “O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. The words “palpable” and “erewhile” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

164. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1–2. The evidence is “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove. The words “reached” and “region” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out.

165. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Antigone, lines 243–244. The evidence is “Where will you find one, search ye ne’er so well, / Who ’scapes perdition if a god impel” (Parodos (lines 115–248), Antigone). This develops refuge and hospitality: the elders' fear. The words “perdition” and “search” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders of Colonus search for the trespasser. When they learn his name, they order him out. Antigone pleads for him.

166. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.
Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 261–263. The evidence is “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. The words “because” and “defence” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so

Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

167. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Is Oedipus innocent? Evaluate his argument in lines 261–263 against the play's other evidence.

Sample answer: A defended position: Oedipus, lines 261–263. The evidence is “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

168. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Synthesis: trace how refuge and hospitality develops from Episode 1 (lines 249–694) to Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739). Use one quotation from each.

Sample answer: Earlier, in Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus, the text reads “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again” — Oedipus, lines 261–263. In Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 695–698. The Colonus ode.

169. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “The undying olive stands for a city that endures.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening soil” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) supports it: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar. But “Dear son of Aegeus, to the gods alone / Is given immunity from eld and death; / But nothing else escapes all-ruinous time.” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) complicates it: in lines 629–631 Oedipus tells Theseus that only the gods escape age and death, and that nothing else escapes all-ruinous time. Cities and friendships change; the olive's endurance is a hope, not a certainty, so the claim is a strong reading, not a complete one.

170. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and main / Maidens, the captives twain” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Chorus, lines 1106–1111. The evidence is “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the rescue imagined. The words “captives” and “captain” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. The elders imagine the chase and the battle and pray to Zeus and Athena for victory.

171. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He passed away—an end most marvellous” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Messenger, lines 1702–1705. The evidence is “It was a messenger from heaven, or else / Some gentle, painless cleaving of earth's base; / For without wailing or disease or pain / He…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger). This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing. The words “marvellous” and “messenger” carry that meaning:

they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

172. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “The State around An all unwitting bridegroom bound An _____ marriage chain; That was my bane.” Word bank: impious

Key: impious

173. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] What does "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" mean?

Sample answer: His grave will be valuable after his death. The evidence is “So, when I cease to be, my worth begins” (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 393. This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome.

174. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why compare Oedipus to a headland rather than a ship?

Sample answer: He stands fixed and endures; he is battered but not sunk. The evidence is “Such ills not I alone, / He too our guest hath known, / E’en as some headland on an iron-bound shore, / Lashed by the wintry blasts and…” (Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1298–1306.

175. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Why is Polyneices' plea for mercy unsuccessful?

Sample answer: His father cannot forgive his abandonment; the curse is already set. The evidence is “But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart…” (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501), Polyneices) — Polyneices, lines 1324–1327.

176. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus).

Sample answer: Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. The evidence is “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1–2. This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove.

177. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? “Yet am I then / A villain born because in self-defence, / Stricken, I struck the striker back again”

A. Episode 1 (lines 249–694)

B. Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152)

C. Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)

D. Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)

Key: A (Episode 1 (lines 249–694))

178. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: The undying olive stands for a city that endures. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening soil” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus).

Sample answer: The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's

gifts of the horse and the oar. The evidence is “Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus’ glistening…” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 695–698. This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode.

179. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 3 (lines 1270–1307)”? The elders lament old age and life's troubles and compare Oedipus to a headland battered by storms from every side.

A. Characterization

B. Imagery

C. Alliteration

D. Irony

Key: B (Imagery)

180. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Analyze the word choice in “If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.

Sample answer: Chorus, in this part of the section. The evidence is “If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death. The words “invisible” and “prayers” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.

181. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Claim: The elders who first drove him away now pray for his peace. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus).

Sample answer: The elders pray to the powers of the underworld to let Oedipus pass gently and without pain. The evidence is “By a gentle, tearless doom / Speed this stranger to the gloom, / Let him enter without pain / The all-shrouding Stygian plain” (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1610–1613. This develops refuge and hospitality: a prayer for an easy death.

182. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Messenger, lines 1657–1663. The evidence is “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger). This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing. The words “tribulations” and “ministry” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes.

183. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? “Tis the haunt of the clear-voiced nightingale, / Who hid in her bower, among” (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus)

A. The title character, who will die halfway through.

B. Chorus, in this part of the section.

C. The wasteland that wealth leaves behind.

D. The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

Key: B (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

184. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Why does Oedipus no longer need a guide?

Sample answer: He is led by the god; his inner sight guides him. The evidence is "O light, no light to me, but mine erewhile, / Now the last time I feel thee palpable, / For I am drawing near the final gloom / Of Hades" (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) — Oedipus, lines 1599–1602.

185. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] What does this passage most clearly show? "If mortal prayers are heard in hell, / Hear, Goddess dread, invisible" (Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625), Chorus)

A. The inner voice that makes him a ferryman.

B. The lines describe a sea voyage to Troy.

C. The scene opens with the letter she asked for.

D. Chorus, in this part of the section.

Key: D (Chorus, in this part of the section.)

186. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Quote identification: in which section does this passage appear? "But as almighty Zeus in all he doth / Hath Mercy for co-partner of his throne, / Let Mercy, father, also sit enthroned / In thy heart likewise"

A. Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605)

B. Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)

C. Episode 1 (lines 249–694)

D. Stasimon 4 (lines 1606–1625)

Key: B (Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501))

187. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 393. The evidence is "So, when I cease to be, my worth begins" (Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: Ismene's news; Theseus' welcome. The words "begins" and "cease" carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Oedipus defends himself: he acted in self-defence and without knowledge. Ismene brings news that his sons are fighting over Thebes and that an oracle says whoever holds Oedipus' grave will prosper, so Creon is coming for him. Oedipus curses his sons, purifies the grove through Ismene, and answers the elders' questions about the incest and the killing. Theseus arrives, recalls that he too was an exile, and grants Oedipus protection.

188. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Is the ode about Oedipus, Athens, or both? Defend your reading.

Sample answer: A defended position: Chorus, lines 695–698. The evidence is "Thou hast come to a steed-famed land for rest, / O stranger worn with toil, / To a land of all lands the goodliest / Colonus' glistening…" (Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739), Chorus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the Colonus ode. The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

189. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2 (lines 740–1091), Creon) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Creon, lines 869. The evidence is "Command your minions; I am not your slave" (Episode 2 (lines 740–

1091), Creon). This develops refuge and hospitality: Creon seizes the daughters. The words “minions” and “slave” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Creon arrives with smooth words. When Oedipus refuses him, Creon reveals that his men have seized Ismene and drags off Antigone. Theseus arrives, rebukes Creon for breaking Athenian law, and sends men to rescue the girls. Creon calls Oedipus polluted; Oedipus answers that he acted unknowingly.

190. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Parodos (lines 115–248), Chorus: “Ha! Where is he? Look _____! / Every nook and corner scan”

Key: around

191. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] What can you infer from this line? “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 74. The evidence is “The blind man’s words will be instinct with sight” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the beggar at the sacred grove.

192. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Stasimon 1 (lines 695–739)”? The elders praise Colonus and Athens: the nightingale, the river Cephisus, Athena's olive, and Poseidon's gifts of the horse and the oar.

A. Imagery

B. Irony

C. Alliteration

D. Conflict

Key: A (Imagery)

193. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “Episode 4 (lines 1308–1501)”? Polyneices asks his father's pardon and help in the war on Thebes. Oedipus curses him: the brothers will die by each other's hands. Antigone begs Polyneices to turn back; he refuses and asks his sisters to bury him if the curse comes true,…

A. Conflict

B. Setting

C. Tone / mood

D. Allusion

Key: A (Conflict)

194. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Claim: The cursed man becomes a protector of the city. His last word to his daughters is "love" (line 1661). Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy load, I know, and yet one word / Wipes out all score of tribulations—love. / And love from me ye…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger).

Sample answer: A messenger reports Oedipus' last farewell and his mysterious passing, seen only by Theseus. The daughters mourn. Theseus keeps his promise not to reveal the grave and promises them his care. Antigone resolves to return to Thebes. The evidence is “My children, ye will lose your sire today, / For all of me has perished, and no more / Have ye to bear your long, long ministry; / A heavy…” (Exodos (lines 1626–1831), Messenger) — Messenger, lines 1657–1663. This develops refuge and hospitality: the mysterious passing.

195. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Evaluate this claim about the scene: “Antigone is the voice of mercy, as she will be the voice of conscience in Antigone.” Is it fully persuasive? Argue with

evidence, including a passage that complicates it.

Sample answer: The claim is persuasive in part. “They only who have known calamity / Can share it” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Oedipus) supports it: Theseus brings the daughters back. Oedipus thanks him but will not touch him, believing himself still polluted. Theseus reports that a kinsman has taken sanctuary at Poseidon's altar: Polyneices. Oedipus refuses to see him; Antigone persuades him to listen. But “Thou art his father, therefore canst not pay / In kind a son’s most impious outrages” (Episode 3 (lines 1153–1269), Antigone) complicates it: the line (Antigone, lines 1248–1249) shows the same issue from another side, and its “not” marks a limit or reversal the claim passes over. So the claim stands only in a qualified form: true of the scene's main pattern, but not of every moment in it.

196. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C4-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Oedipus, lines 1592–1593. The evidence is “Strange that I / Whom ye have led so long should lead you now” (Thunder scene (lines 1502–1605), Oedipus). This develops refuge and hospitality: the summons. The words “should” and “lead” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Thunder sounds. Oedipus knows his end has come and calls for Theseus. Without a guide, he leads Theseus and his daughters toward the place of his passing, and tells Theseus that the secret, passed from ruler to heir, will protect Athens.

197. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] Complete the quotation from Episode 1 (lines 249–694), Theseus: “I too was reared, / Like thee, in exile, and in _____ lands / Wrestled with many perils, no man more”

Key: foreign

198. [short · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-GR-LIT-1] How is the ode like Oedipus' blindness?

Sample answer: The elders must imagine what they cannot see. The evidence is “There I might chance behold / Theseus our captain bold / Meet with the robber band, / Ere they have fled the land, / Rescue by might and…” (Stasimon 2 (lines 1092–1152), Chorus) — Chorus, lines 1106–1111.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33, 34, 35, 36, 37, 38, 39, 40, 41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48, 49, 50	recall 29, inference 12, analysis 6, synthesis 3
HS Freshman	51, 2, 52, 53, 3, 54, 1, 55, 7, 56, 57, 15, 18, 16, 58, 17, 20, 59, 60, 25, 26, 61, 27, 24, 62, 63, 30, 31, 64, 35, 65, 38, 66, 67, 40, 68, 39, 69, 70, 42, 71, 72, 73, 74, 46, 47, 75, 76, 77, 78	recall 26, inference 12, analysis 9, synthesis 3
HS Sophomore	79, 2, 80, 81, 54, 3, 4, 6, 7, 82, 20, 83, 57, 18, 84, 16, 14, 85, 86, 87, 88, 89, 90, 91, 92, 31, 32, 93, 34, 35, 68, 94, 95, 96, 41, 97, 71, 43, 98, 99, 74, 46, 100, 101, 76, 102, 103, 104, 105, 106	recall 25, inference 10, analysis 9, synthesis 6
HS Junior	2, 54, 51, 4, 1, 3, 107, 17, 58, 84, 83, 16, 14, 20, 108, 87, 91, 88, 89, 109, 31, 30, 110, 111, 93, 35, 36, 112, 37, 113, 40, 96, 71, 43, 114, 115, 116, 45, 100, 117, 47, 118, 119, 75, 120, 48, 121, 77, 122, 106	recall 20, inference 12, analysis 12, synthesis 6
HS Senior	80, 2, 79, 107, 123, 51, 58, 15, 16, 14, 20, 17, 90, 86, 85, 124, 21, 89, 30, 31, 125, 110, 111, 93, 34, 37, 39, 40, 96, 126, 71, 127, 114, 44, 128, 129, 45, 130, 46, 47, 75, 48, 131, 132, 133, 134, 49, 106, 105, 135	recall 18, inference 11, analysis 12, synthesis 9

AP	3, 51, 54, 84, 20, 83, 85, 91, 88, 136, 137, 30, 31, 34, 93, 37, 113, 40, 68, 138, 69, 70, 139, 140, 141, 44, 129, 142, 100, 47, 75, 143, 76, 144, 145, 132, 146, 147, 148, 149, 150, 151, 103, 106, 122, 105, 152, 153, 78, 154	recall 9, inference 12, analysis 11, synthesis 18
College Freshman	107, 79, 84, 20, 19, 88, 85, 124, 155, 137, 156, 93, 34, 157, 158, 38, 67, 40, 39, 68, 159, 71, 114, 44, 160, 128, 161, 162, 74, 130, 100, 163, 47, 143, 164, 76, 165, 166, 167, 168, 169, 146, 121, 170, 134, 151, 50, 106, 154, 171	recall 8, inference 12, analysis 14, synthesis 16
College Sophomore	3, 1, 172, 59, 85, 124, 137, 156, 30, 173, 93, 64, 36, 174, 175, 66, 68, 94, 176, 159, 177, 71, 127, 114, 178, 44, 160, 73, 129, 74, 179, 46, 101, 163, 47, 180, 181, 76, 48, 165, 147, 168, 121, 149, 104, 103, 105, 50, 152, 182	recall 6, inference 12, analysis 19, synthesis 13
College Junior	15, 59, 88, 85, 137, 31, 30, 173, 183, 34, 64, 33, 158, 37, 174, 175, 67, 184, 69, 185, 95, 96, 41, 114, 44, 128, 161, 179, 186, 163, 101, 181, 76, 164, 48, 165, 144, 166, 187, 146, 168, 188, 189, 121, 149, 170, 134, 122, 152, 78	recall 4, inference 19, analysis 9, synthesis 18
College Senior	190, 124, 191, 137, 31, 173, 111, 110, 93, 64, 157, 158, 174, 37, 175, 67, 184, 69, 94, 41, 97, 71, 43, 127, 192, 98, 128, 162, 100, 193, 101, 117, 181, 47, 143, 194, 164, 48, 144, 165, 187, 132, 147, 168, 188, 169, 148, 170, 195, 196	recall 2, inference 18, analysis 16, synthesis 14
Graduate / PhD	197, 86, 125, 173, 111, 183, 64, 198, 35, 112, 174, 158, 66, 175, 40, 184, 68, 69, 94, 126, 97, 159, 141, 114, 192, 160, 98, 129, 162, 74, 46, 117, 163, 47, 180, 181, 164, 48, 76, 165, 144, 187, 146, 147, 188, 189, 149, 134, 105, 182	recall 2, inference 17, analysis 17, synthesis 14

Final paper

Oedipus at Colonus: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how Sophocles develops refuge and hospitality across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in Oedipus at Colonus and argue how its meaning changes over the play and why that change matters to guilt and intent.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in Oedipus at Colonus. Argue whether the play judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether Oedipus at Colonus finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of curse and mercy. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 6 quotations from at least three sections, from the beginning, middle and end. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the act, scene and line (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: The king who once solved riddles must now ask where he is. The forbidden grove of the Furies becomes his place of rest. The text makes this visible when it says “Child of an old blind sire, Antigone, / What region, say, whose city have we reached” (Prologue (lines 1–114), Oedipus). Blind and old, Oedipus arrives with Antigone at a grove near Athens. A local man tells him it is holy ground of the Eumenides and that he must leave. Oedipus refuses: Apollo foretold that he would end his days here, a blessing to his hosts and a curse to the land that cast him out. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Refuge and hospitality

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus at Colonus teaches about refuge and hospitality. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops refuge and hospitality in Oedipus at Colonus. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops refuge and hospitality across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of refuge and hospitality. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of refuge and hospitality in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of refuge and hospitality, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus at Colonus's treatment of refuge and hospitality in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on refuge and hospitality in Oedipus at Colonus that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on refuge and hospitality in Oedipus at Colonus. Name your critical method, apply

it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about refuge and hospitality in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on refuge and hospitality in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Guilt and intent

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus at Colonus teaches about guilt and intent. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops guilt and intent in Oedipus at Colonus. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops guilt and intent across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of guilt and intent. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of guilt and intent in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of guilt and intent, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched

essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus at Colonus's treatment of guilt and intent in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on guilt and intent in Oedipus at Colonus that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on guilt and intent in Oedipus at Colonus. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about guilt and intent in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on guilt and intent in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Curse and mercy

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus at Colonus teaches about curse and mercy. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops curse and mercy in Oedipus at Colonus. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops curse and mercy across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of curse and mercy. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of curse and mercy in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of curse and mercy, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus at Colonus's treatment of curse and mercy in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on curse and mercy in Oedipus at Colonus that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on curse and mercy in Oedipus at Colonus. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about curse and mercy in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on curse and mercy in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Law against force

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus at Colonus teaches about law against force. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops law against force in Oedipus at Colonus. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops law against force across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of law against force. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of law against force in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of law against force, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus at Colonus's treatment of law against force in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on law against force in Oedipus at Colonus that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on law against force in Oedipus at Colonus. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about law against force in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper

(15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on law against force in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Death and blessing

Scaffolded support (600 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Oedipus at Colonus teaches about death and blessing. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Sophocles develops death and blessing in Oedipus at Colonus. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Sophocles develops death and blessing across Oedipus at Colonus. Trace the idea through at least three scenes and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Oedipus at Colonus (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of death and blessing. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of death and blessing in Oedipus at Colonus. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Sophocles's choices in Oedipus at Colonus (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of death and blessing, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Oedipus at Colonus's treatment of death and blessing in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on death and blessing in Oedipus at Colonus that reads the play against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a theoretically

informed essay (8–10 pages) on death and blessing in Oedipus at Colonus. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about death and blessing in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.1; RL.9-10.2; RL.9-10.3; RL.9-10.4; RL.9-10.5; RL.11-12.1; RL.11-12.2; RL.11-12.4; RL.11-12.5; W.9-10.1; W.11-12.1; L.9-10.4; L.11-12.4): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on death and blessing in Oedipus at Colonus, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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